

al-Shama'il al-Muhammadiyyah

A Commentary on the Depiction of

Prophet

MUHAMMAD

صَلَّى
عَلَيْهِ
وَالْحَمْدُ

Imām al-Tirmidhī

دارالرقم
DAR AL-AHQAM

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“The house of al-Arqam is the house of Islam”

Al-Hakim (d. 403 AH) in al-Mustadrak ‘Ala al-Sahihayn (6185)

A Commentary on the Depiction of Muhammad

By Imam al-Tirmidhi

With selected commentary from the works of:

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr | Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī | Alī al-Qārī | Al-Bajūrī
| Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī | Abū Bakr ibn al-‘Arabī | Al-Nawawī | Ibn al-
Uthaymīn | Al-Ghazālī | Qadī ‘Iyyād | Ibn Taymiyyah | Ibn al-Qayyim
| Al-Shawkānī | Muhammad Amīn al-Shanqīti | Ibn Abdul Barr | Ibn
Rajab | Al-Qastalanī | Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūrī | Abū Hafs al-
Sūhrawardī | Ibn al-Jawzī | Abdul Muhsin al-Abbad | Al-Suyūtī |
Hafith al-Iraqī | Al-San’anī | Ibn Battal | Nasiruddīn al-Albānī | And
Many Others

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IMĀM AL-TIRMIDHI

His Name and Birth

He is the *imām*, the *hafīdh*, the great *muhaddith*: Abū Īsa, Muhammad ibn Īsa ibn Sawrah ibn Musa ibn al-Dahhaak al-Sulamī al-Būghī al-Tirmidhī, better known as Imām al-Tirmidhi. There are different views regarding the year in which he was born, but the general consensus is that he was born around 210 AH^[u] in the city of Tirmidh.

His Life

Historical works regarding the scholars of hadīth (such as the works of al-Khatīb al-Baghdadī) serve as witnesses that the area of Khurasan was a centre of the study of hadīth during the time of the early generations. From this area arose the *imāms* of hadīth: Muhammad ibn Isma'īl al-Bukhārī, Muslim ibn al-Hajjaj, Abū Dawūd al-Sijistani, Muhammad ibn Mājah, Ahmed ibn Shu'ayb al-Nasa'i and lastly, Abū Īsa al-Tirmidhi. Imām al-Tirmidhi was considered by the scholars to be a student of Imām al-Bukhari and he also heard hadīth from Imām Muslim and Abū Dawūd. Though he resided in such a hub of knowledge, he followed the Sunnah of the *muhaddiths* by travelling to the other centres of knowledge such as Iraq and the Hijāz to sit and learn from the scholars. Thus, he travelled to hear from giants such as Abū Musab al-Zuhri (the son of Ibn Shihab al-Zuhri) from Madīnah, Muhammad ibn Ma'mar from Basrah and Isma'īl al-Fazarī from Kufah.

Imām al-Tirmidhi was considered to be from Imām al-Bukhārī's most exceptional students and he rose to such a high level that he had the privilege of his teacher hearing hadīths from him. Furthermore, it is narrated that Imām al-Bukhārī said to his student, "I have benefitted from you more than you have benefitted from me." ^[2]

His Works

Imam al-Tirmidhi is most famously known for his vast and highly praised collection of hadīth entitled al-Jami'. Two of the most famous explanations of this are A'ridat-ul-Ahwazi of Abū Bakr ibn al-Arabī and Tuhfat-ul Ahwadhi of Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūri (these are amongst the many commentaries that we have referred to for the explanation of the hadīths of the Shama'il). In Ibn al-Arabi's explanation, he states regarding the Jami', "There is no book that matches the rank of Abū Īsa's with respect to the sweetness of its passages, its excellence and its charm." In Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūri's explanation, he lists his other works as al-'Ilal al-Kabir, a work on tafsir, al-Tarikh, al-Zuhd and al-Asma wa al-Kuna. Furthermore, he states, **"There is also al-Shama'il al-Muhammadiyyah. It is the best of the books written concerning this subject and full of blessings."**

In al-Bajuri's explanation of Shama'il Muhammadiyyah, he states, "His Jami' is sufficient for you in terms of benefits regarding *fiqh* and hadīth and also regarding the knowledge of the way of the *salaf* and the *khalaf*. Thus, it is sufficient for the *mujtahids* and likewise for the laypeople." In Dhayl Tabaqat al-Hanābilah, it is reported that Abū Isma'il al-Ansārī said, "In my opinion, the book of al-Tirmidhi is superior in terms of its benefit than the books of al-Bukhārī and Muslim." When he was asked for the reason regarding this, he replied, "Because only those who are well versed in knowledge will benefit from them. As for this book, he has explained the hadīths therein and thus everyone can benefit from it: the *faqīh*, the *muhaddith* and others [i.e. those lesser in knowledge]."

His Personal Qualities and Praise from Scholars for Him

He possessed a great mind, possessing both excellent memory and a high degree of intelligence. His memory is displayed by the following famous narration. Imām al-Dhahabi reports in his *Siyar A'lam al-Nubala* that al-Tirmidhi said, "Whilst on the route to Makkah I wrote two chapters of hadīth from a shaykh. We met and I requested him to narrate them to me whilst thinking that I had the notes that I previously wrote in my possession. He agreed and began to read whilst I realised that the papers I had were blank. The shaykh realised my papers were devoid of writing and said, 'Have you no shame with me?' I explained to him my circumstances and assured him that I had it all committed to memory. So he asked me to repeat them and I did. However the shaykh was not convinced and he thought that I had reviewed them before our meeting. I asked him to read to me something else and thus he read forty hadīths, then he asked me to repeat them. I did so without error, not even in a single letter."

The praise of the scholars for this great hafidh is vast. What follows are a few examples. In *Tabaqāt al-Huffaz*, al-Idrisī said, "He was one of the imāms and from the role models in the science of hadīth... He is mentioned as an example of great memory." In *al-Thiqāt*, Ibn Hibban said, "He is of those who collected, wrote, took to memory and studied." In *Siyar A'lam al-Nubala*, it is reported that Hakim said, "I heard 'Umar ibn Alak state, 'Upon al-Bukhārī's passing, he did not leave behind any individual in Khurasan of the same calibre of Abū Īsa in regards to knowledge, memory, piety or ascetism."

His Death

He died in Tirmidh in the year 279 AH on the 13th of Rajab according to al-Dhahabi. It is reported that in the latter part of his life, he lost his sight and became blind. May Allāh have mercy upon him.

COMPILER'S FORWARD

All praise is due to Allāh with Whose grace all good deeds are realised and the *Salāh* and *Salām* of Allāh be upon His Messenger, his family, his companions and all of his loyal followers.

The methodology followed in this book is intended to make the book more appealing to all people and so an in-depth research was made to present to the readers selective gems from a wide array of books and references. The diversity of quotes and texts researched and included therein are intended to enrich the content and allow non-Arabic speakers access to classical books and references that are not yet translated. The commentaries used are taken from the works of early and contemporary scholars from the main four schools of thought (i.e. Hanafi, Shafi'i, Maliki and Hanbali). This diversity of scholars is hoped to bring people closer and make them more accepting and respectful to the scholars without whom we could not have access to this knowledge. It is also hoped that this work will unite the hearts of people from different backgrounds and it is from Allāh's favours upon us that He united us upon the love of His Prophet. To this effect, the selection criteria of commentaries used in this book is based on the added value and benefit that will be brought forth. To make the book more interesting, the quotes were researched based on the subject matter of the hadīth and this required researching tens of classical books and references that covered a wide array of areas such as

history, *fiqh*, commentaries, creed, *tazkiyyah* etc. Emphasis was placed upon providing new gems of knowledge (to the English reader) and to present a book with rich content that covers different topics related to *fiqh*, creed, spirituality and hadith so as to make it more interesting and to suit all tastes.

The references of the hadiths of the Shama'il were taken from the book of al-Shaykh Abdul Razzaq but as some hadiths were not referenced in his book, I researched the references and gave the reference based on the text and not the chain of narrators, and in the case where the exact words were not found in other sources, I would use the reference of a similar hadith that has the exact same meaning but may have additions or different wording.

Overall, over forty works were used for the commentary. The commentary was based around the books of four main scholars, two of whom are from the contemporary scholars and the other two from the early scholars: (i) Abdul Razzaq ibn Abdul Muhsin al-Badr, (ii) Ibrahim ibn Muhammad al-Bajūrī al-Shafī'ī, (iii) Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī, (iv) al-Mulla Alī ibn Sultan Muhammad al-Qārī. Below is a list of the main books from which commentaries were selected and translated:

1. Sharh Shama'il al-Nabi, Abdul Razzaq al-Badr (the book consists of the explanation of this book that the Shaykh gave over forty five lessons in the Masjid of the Prophet).
2. Al-Mawahib al-Laduniyyah 'Ala al-Shama'il al-Muhammadiyyah, Ibrahim ibn Muhammad al-Bajūrī al-Shafī'ī (1198 H.-1277 H.), 2nd Edition (2007), Dar al-Minhaj, Jeddah.
3. Ashraf al-Wasā'il Ila Fahm al-Shama'il, Shihab al-Dīn Ahmad Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī (974 H.), 1st Edition (1998), Dār al-Kutub al-'Ilmiyyah, Beirut.
4. Jam' al-Wasā'il Fi Sharh al-Wasā'il, Ali ibn Sultan Muhammad, Abu al-Hasan, Noor al-Dīn al-Mulla al-Qārī (1014 H.), al-Matb'ah al-Sharafiyyah (1901), Egypt.

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5. Fathul Bāri Sharh Sahīh al-Bukhārī, al-Hafidh Ahmad ibn Hali ibn Hajar, Abu al-Fadl al-'Asqalānī (852 H.), Dār al-Salam, al-Riyadh and Dār al-Fayhaa, Damascus, 3rd Edition (2000).
6. Al-Minhāj Bi Sharh Sahīh Muslim ibn al-Hajjāj, Muhiy al-Dīn ibn Yahya ibn Sharaf al-Nawawī (676 H.), Dār Ibn Hazm, Beirut, 1st Edition (2002).
7. Tuhfatul Ahwadhi bi Sharh Jami' al-Tirmidhi, Abu al 'Ula Muhammad 'Abdul Rahman ibn Abd al-Rahīm al-Mubarakfuri (1353 H.), Dār al-Hadīth, Cairo, 1st Edition (2001).
8. Al-Istidhkār al-Jāmi' Li Madhahib Fuqahā al-Amsār wa 'Ulamā' al-Aqtaar, Yūsuf ibn Abdullāh ibn Mohammed ibn Abdul Barr, Abu Umar al-Namari al-Andalusi al-Qurtubi al-Maliki (463 H.), Dār Qutaybah, Damascus, 1st Edition (1993).
9. Zād al-Ma'ād fi Hady Khayril 'Ibād, Muhammad ibn Abi Bakr ibn Ayyob ibn Sa'd Shams al-dīn, Ibn Qayyim al-Jawziyyah (751 H.), Mu'assasatu al-Risalah, Beirut, 27th Edition (1994).
10. Zahratu al-Khama'il 'Ala al-Shama'il, 'Abdul Rahman ibn Abi Bakr, Jalal al-Deen al-Suyūti (911 H.), Maktabatu al-Quran, Cairo, (1988).
11. Sharh Riyād al-Salihīn, Muhammad ibn Salih ibn Muhammad al-'Uthaymīn (1421 H.), Daar al-Watan, al-Riyadh (1426 H.).
12. Sharh Musnad Abu Hanifah, Ali ibn Sultan Muhammad, Abu al-Hasan, Nūr al-Dīn al-Mulla al-Qārī (1014 H.), Dār al-Kutub al-'Ilmiyyah, Beirut, 1st Edition (1985).
13. Subul al-Salām Sharh Bulūgh al-Maram, Muhammad ibn Ismail ibn Salah al-Amīr al-Kahlani al-San'āni (1182 H.), Dār al-Hadīth, Cairo.
14. Sharh Sahih al-Bukhārī, Abu al-Hasan Ali ibn Khalaf ibn 'Abdil Malik, Ibn Battal, (449 H.), Maktabtu al-Rushd, Al-Riyadh, 2nd Edition (2003).
15. Kifayatu al-Hajah fi Sharh Sunan Ibn Majah, Muhammad ibn 'Abd al-Hādi al-Tatawi, Abu al-Hasan Nūr al-Dīn al-Sindi (1138 H.), Dār al-Jīl, Beirut.
16. Faydul Qadīr Sharh al-Jāmi' al-Saghīr, Zain al-Dīn Muhammad, 'Abdil Ra'ūf ibn Tāj al-'Arifyīn ibn 'Ali ibn Zain al-'Abidīn al-

Minnawi (1031 H.), al-Maktabah al-Tijāryyah al-Kubra, Egypt, 1st Edition (1356 H.).

17. Libāb al-Ta'wīl Fi Ma'ani al-Tanzīl, 'Alā al-Dīn Ali ibn Muhammad ibn Ibrahim ibn Umar, Abu al-Hasan, also known as al-Khazin (741 H.), Dār al-Kutub al-'Ilmiyyah, Beirut, 1st Edition (1415 H.).
18. Muntaha al-So'l 'Ala Wasa'il al-Wussul Ila Shama'il al-Rasul, Abdullah ibn Sa'id ibn Muhammad al-Hadrami al-Makki (1410 H.), Dār al-Minhāj, Jeddah, 3rd Edition (2005).
19. Adwā al-Bayān Fi Iydāh al-Quran bil Qurān, Muhammad al-Amīn ibn Muhammad al-Mukhtaar al-Shanqīti (1393 H.), Dār al-Fikr, Beirut (1995).
20. Buhjat al-Mahafil wa Bughyat al-Amāthil Fi Talkhīs al-Mu'jizat wal Siyar wal Shama'il, Yahya ibn Abi Bakr Ibn Muhammad ibn Yahya al'Amri (893 H.), Dār Sādir, Beirut.
21. Latā'if al-Ma'ārif fima lima wasim al-'Aam min al-Wadha'if, Zain al-dīn 'Abdul Rahmān ibn Ahmad ibn Rajab al-Hanbali (795 H.), Dār Ibn Hazm, 1st Edition (2004).
22. Nail al-Awtār, Muhammad ibn Ali ibn Muhammad ibn Abdullah al-Shawkani (1250 H.), Dār al-Hadīth, Egypt, 1st Edition (1993).
23. Ihyā' 'Ulūm al-Dīn, Abu Hamid, Muhammad ibn Muhammad al-Ghazali (505 H.), Dār al-Ma'rifah, Beirut.
24. Madārij al-Salikīn Bayna Manazil Iyyaka Na'bud wa Iyyak Na'sta'in, Muhammad ibn Abi Bakr ibn Ayyūb ibn Sa'd Shams al-Dīn, Ibn Qayyim al-Jawziyyah (751 H.), Dar al-Kitāb al-Arabi, Beirut, 3rd Edition (1996).
25. 'Uyūn al-Athar Fi Funūn al-Maghazi wal Shama'il wal Siyar, Muhammad ibn Muhammad, Ibn Sayyid al-Nās (734 H.), Dār al-Qalam, Beirut, 2nd Edition (1993).
26. Mukhtasar al-Shama'il al-Muhammadiyyah, Nasiruddin al-Albani, Maktabat al-Marif, Riyadh.

INTRODUCTION OF SHAYKH ABDUL MUHSIN AL-ABBAD

The praise is for Allah. May Allah send salutations, peace, and blessings upon our Prophet Muhammad, upon his family, his Companions and whoever was a supporter of his, held to his sunnah, and was guided by his guidance, until the Day of Reward.

The scholars of hadīth define the Sunnah of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to be all that which is attributed to the Prophet (peace be upon him) in the form of statements, actions, approvals, physical attributes, manners or conduct. This makes the authentic statements of the companions regarding his beautiful physical attributes and noble character included in this definition.

These superb character traits and beautiful features are either found scattered in hadīth collections or compiled into dedicated works, the most important of which is “al-Shama’il” by al-Imam al-Tirmidhī, the author of the famous book “al-Jami’”, which is known as Sunan al-Tirmidhī. It is indeed a reference of a great importance.

The benefit of learning the physical features of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is that it helps us to distinguish the truthful dream from the false dream in which he appears and the benefit of knowing his character is to follow his example, which Allah has praised: **{There has certainly been for you in the Messenger of Allah an excellent pattern for anyone whose hope is in Allah and the Last Day and [who] remembers Allah often.}**^[3]

INTRODUCTION OF SHAYKH ABDUL RAZZAQ AL-BADR

In the name of Allah, the most benevolent to mankind, the most Merciful to all believers. All praise is for Allah, Lord of the worlds. Peace and prayers be upon Muhammad, his family, his Companions and all those who follow in their footsteps until the last day.

This book contains a depiction of the physical features and character of the best of mankind and the most beloved and favoured by Allāh the Most High. A depiction of the one who knows his Lord the most and the most capable of mankind at fulfilling the rights of servitude. He was the one chosen to be the link between Allāh and His slaves and chosen to be the messenger who calls towards the good and guidance. Al-Hafith ibn Kathīr commented on the ayah: **{There has certainly been for you in the Messenger of Allah an excellent pattern for anyone whose hope is in Allah and the Last Day and [who] remembers Allah often.}** by saying, “This ayah is a fundamental principle towards following the example of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) in his statements, actions and conditions.”^[4]

The following of his example necessitates learning about his guidance in life, character and physical features. It is for this reason, each Muslim ought to give priority to learning about the life of the Prophet (peace be upon him) before learning anything about anyone else.

The benefits of learning the character and physical features of the Prophet (peace be upon him) are many, some of which are:

1. It is from the pillars of *imān* to believe in the Messenger (peace be upon him) and this cannot happen without acquiring the knowledge about him. That being said, the more a person knows about the Prophet (peace be upon him), the stronger his belief in him becomes.

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2. The love of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is an obligation that Allah has dictated upon His slaves and He made his love take precedence over one's love for his parents, children and all of mankind including one's own self. The more a person remembers his beloved and knows about his beautiful character, the more a person longs to meet him and feels love for him.
3. Allah has set the Prophet (peace be upon him) as the role model that we need to follow. To be able to do this we need to learn about his life and character.
4. The Prophet (peace be upon him) is more worthy of the believers than their own selves. This is because his mercy and efforts to advise and call people to the truth made him more merciful to them than people are merciful to themselves. Also, his favour upon people is incomparable for every good deed that we carry out happens due to his efforts in calling humanity to Islām. Thus, each person should know his great status and this can be achieved through learning about his character and features.
5. Allāh has made an oath in the Qur'ān in which He testifies to the perfect character of the Prophet (peace be upon him). The ayah says: **{And indeed, you are of a great moral character.}**^[5] His sense of morality was based on the guidance of the Qur'ān, thus his character was described by Aisha as a manifestation of the Qur'ān^[6], meaning that he followed all that which is encouraged and made obligatory in the Qur'ān and refrained from all that which is admonished and made forbidden in the Qur'ān.
6. Allāh has ordered us in the Qur'ān to pray to Him to confer His Peace and Blessings upon the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the more we are acquainted with his character and life the more we will be encouraged to do so more often. This is why the people who know the Prophet (peace be upon him) more reflect upon matters differently than those who lack this knowledge, whose prayers are nothing but a sound uttered by their tongues.

7. The description of the characteristics of the Prophet (peace be upon him) provides a lifestyle that should be followed by all Muslims desiring to live the best life in this world and the Hereafter. It is a lifestyle that should be taught to the younger generation so that their upbringing can be sound and to keep them away from deviation, instead of letting their generation aspire to the lifestyles of the low-life ones.

For these reasons, there is only one person whose life should be looked into if one desires to find the perfect manners and best conduct, that is the life of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and this is why it is needed to study and learn more about his manners, conduct and lifestyle. Sufyān ibn 'Uyaynah said, "The Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) is the great balance; whatever complies with his conduct, character and guidance is the truth, otherwise it is falsehood."^[7]

This blessed book is from the best and most beneficial books written about the character and depiction of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and its author made it such an excellent work through his structuring of it and the hadiths he included therein. This is the reason why many scholars praise the book and consider it from the best books authored about this topic.

CHAPTER ONE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE APPEARANCE OF THE PROPHET

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

With no doubt, Allāh lavished our Prophet (peace be upon him) with a perfect appearance and endowed him with the most beautiful physical attributes and characteristics. Shaykh al-Islām Ibn Taymiyyah said, “He [the Prophet] enjoyed the best stature and appearance, indicating his perfection.”^[8]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

You should know that in order to perfect one’s faith, one must believe that there is no human in possession of as good an appearance as the Prophet (peace be upon him); this is because the outward beauty and handsomeness of the Prophet (peace be upon him) indicates the inward beauty and noble manners he possessed, and no person could ever equal or exceed his status neither in respect to physical appearance nor manners.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The Arabic word *bāb* (which translates to chapter in English) means the door through which a person can enter a place and eloquent scholars have understood it to refer to that which leads to one’s purpose. In the context [of its use by al-Tirmidhī], it alludes to: the means by which to become acquainted with the hadīths describing the physical appearance of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

1. Narrated by Rabī'a ibn Abī Abdul Rahman: "I heard Anas ibn Mālik describing the Prophet (peace be upon him) saying, 'He was neither too tall nor short; neither absolutely white nor brown; his hair was neither very curly nor completely straight. The divine revelation was revealed to him when he was forty years old. He stayed ten years in Makkah, and stayed in Madīnah for ten more years. When he died, he was sixty years old and had [approximately] twenty grey hairs in his head and beard.'" [9]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

"He was neither too tall nor short": The Prophet (peace be upon him) was more apt to be described as tall than short, as it has been explicitly stated in other [authentic] hadīths. This is noted in the choice of words that Anas ibn Mālik used to describe the height of the Prophet (peace be upon him) i.e. he did not use the equivalent antonym of "short" when he negated both attributes; rather, he used the ascription "too tall" to explain that he (peace be upon him) was tall but not to the point where his height exceeded normal or proper limits.

"He stayed ten years in Makkah": This is to specify the length of the period he stayed after receiving the revelation. However, some other hadīths stated that he stayed in Makkah for thirteen years. To reconcile between the two statements, it can be asserted that the mention of ten years refers to the period after the public proclamation of his Message, and the other three years refer to the period he kept this news hidden from others. Another reconciliation to present is that, the ten years refer to the period he stayed in Makkah from the day that Sūrah al-Muddathir was revealed to him wherein he was commanded to warn people, and the other three years refer to the years preceding the aforesaid command. It can even be argued that the narrator counted the age by tens and so he rounded the cardinal number; hence he also omitted the numbers above

sixty from the age of the Prophet (peace be upon him) [as Arabs customarily do].

“When he died, he was sixty years old”: As it is established in authentic hadīths that the Prophet (peace be upon him) passed away at the age of sixty three, it becomes clear that the narrators chose to count by tens and hence omitted the three years from the earlier part.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The scholars who explained this hadīth stated that the part, “... When he was forty years old” is structured in the Arabic language to mean he had completed the age of forty.

“And had approximately twenty grey hairs in his head and beard”: The wisdom behind the Prophet (peace be upon him) having few grey hairs (though there are many hadīths stating the honour and virtue of grey hair) was so that the affability and love between him and his wives was maintained in a perfect manner [by Allāh], since women are apt to dislike grey hair on men. Further to the point, the statement of al-Hafīth ibn Hajar (see page 1), wherein he mentioned that disliking anything about the Prophet is considered a matter of disbelief, cannot be true in all cases because the type of dislike that is naturally implanted in mankind is irrelevant to that which has been dictated.

2. Anas ibn Mālik related: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) was of medium height; he was neither [too] tall nor short. He had a good physical build, and his hair was neither curly nor completely straight. He had a tanned complexion, and when he walked, he leaned forward slightly.” ^[10]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It is noted that in the previous hadīth, Anas ibn Mālik stated that the skin tone of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was not brown. This caused some scholars to believe that this part (“He

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had a tanned complexion”) is not authentic because it was only reported from one person, while the rest of the narrators who reported this from Anas stated that, “He had a rosy complexion.”

Alī al-Qārī said,

The part where it says, “He had a good physical build” refers to his height, skin tone and weight.

The part stating that, “He had a tanned complexion” is intended to negate that he had a skin tone that was absolutely white, though [al-Hafith] al-Iraqī criticised the authenticity of this part. He mentioned that the number of companions who described the skin tone of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was fifteen, and all of them reported that he had a rosy skin tone; furthermore, this description is only reported by one narrator from Anas.

The part where it says, “When he walked, he leaned forward slightly” indicates that he walked with wide steps, because walking with small steps is the way that arrogant people walk.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Arabs sometimes call the one with a white skin tone that is mixed with some redness a person with a tanned or deep-brown skin colour. This explains the reason why Anas stated in this hadīth that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had a tanned complexion. Overall, the hadīths corroborate this understanding regarding the context of the use of the word tanned.

If one argues that, since the skin colour of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is the most noble and honourable of all colours, and so is the skin colour of the dwellers of Paradise, then why is the skin colour of the latter white with some yellowness as stated by the majority of exegetes? I say, the basis of the skin colour of both is the same and the wisdom behind the aforementioned variation is: the red tone mixed with the white is due to the blood and its characteristics, which flows moderately in the veins and it is produced from the worldly

nutrition. Whereas the yellow colour that makes the whiteness [of the skin] polished and purified only appears in Paradise as it can only be produced by the nutrition of that world.

From this part, we can understand the statement of some of the Shafi'i scholars who said it is better for a woman not to wear white or silver clothes, because these can cause a resemblance of men in their clothing, and the reason she is encouraged to change the white coloured garment by dyeing it with saffron is so that the colour becomes closer to gold as that befits her gender.

3. Al-Barā' ibn 'Āzib related: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) was a man of medium build; he had broad shoulders; he had dense hair which reached his earlobes. [I saw him wearing] a *hulla* (red garment) and I never saw anything more beautiful than him." ^[11]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The description given concerning his height is intended to be approximate and not to offer the exact measurement. This is deduced from the fact that other hadīths stated that he (peace be upon him) was closer to tall than short.

The Arabic word *hulla* is used only when the clothing is comprised of two pieces.

To reconcile between the fact that the Prophet (peace be upon him) wore a red garment and his statement wherein he admonished wearing red clothes, it can be said that the order not to wear red clothing refers to clothes comprised completely of red; hence if the garment has other colours such as white or black besides the red, then it does not fall under the category of the forbidden clothing.

The use of the word "anything" rather than "anybody" in the part, "... Anything more beautiful than him" makes the comparison refer to both the animate and inanimate creation.

Alī al-Qārī said,

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The use of the word “man” is an addition from one of the narrators and not from the words of the companions. However, as all the narrators are trustworthy and creditable we accept this addition, and we understand it to be an adjective that is intended to state that he had all the praised qualities of a man. Alternatively, the use of the word can be understood in the context that it is often used as an introduction to what will come afterwards.

The quality of having broad shoulders is deemed by the Arabs as a sign of one's generosity, profound respect and tolerance.

There are many hadīths about the length of the Prophet's (peace be upon him) hair, some of which indicated that it was up to his ears and some of which indicated that it reached to the middle of his ears. Al-Qadī 'Iyyād explained that the variance of reports regarding this matter is due to the fact that each narrator reported what he saw at a specific time and thus the length of his hair differed.

Al-Nawawī explained that, “*Hulla* refers to clothing that is comprised of two pieces and it often refers to the *izār* (a lower garment wrapped around the waist).” To understand the Prophet's wearing of a red garment in light of the knowledge that there are other hadīths wherein he discouraged people from wearing red clothes, we say either the garment he wore had colours other than red in it (but as red was more prominent, it was identified as a red garment), or it could be that the incident reported was before the admonishment he issued (if the garment was purely red), or that wearing these garments [that are completely red] is one of the exclusive characteristics of the Prophet that others are not allowed to do.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

There are different hadīths that provide different descriptions of the length of his (peace be upon him) hair and this is because each narrator described what he saw [at that specific time], and because when the Prophet would leave his hair uncut, he would

leave it until it reached his shoulders and when he shortened it, he would let it reach the level of his earlobes; sometimes to the middle of his ears and sometimes to the level of his ear lobes.

4. Al-Barā' ibn 'Āzib related: "I have never seen someone with a *limmah* wearing a red garment more handsome than the Prophet (peace be upon him). He had long hair that reached his shoulders. The distance between his two shoulders was wide. He was neither tall nor short." ^[12]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The word "*limmah*" refers to a hairstyle where the length of the hair extends to below the earlobes, whether it reaches the shoulders or not. What follows in this narration comes to state that al-Barā' considered the Prophet (peace be upon him) to be the most handsome person he ever saw with such a description.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth is authentic and it was used by Imām al-Shāfi'ī as evidence that it is permissible to wear red clothing.

5. Alī ibn Abī Tālib narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) was neither extremely tall nor short. He had thickly boned hands and feet and a large head. The joints of his bones were large and he had a line of hair extending from his chest to the navel. When he walked, it appeared as if he was descending from a high place. I have never seen anyone who was comparable to him." ^[13]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The common attribute that all the narrators who described the Prophet (peace be upon him) mentioned was that he was neither tall nor short.

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Having thickly boned fingers does not entail the attribution of rough skin because Anas, as shall be mentioned later, stated that the touch of his hand was softer than silk.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The fact that he had thickly boned fingers and at the same time soft skin (as narrated by Anas ibn Mālīk in other authentic hadīths) shows that he combined strength with fine-spun skin.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The last statement of Alī ibn Abī Tālib is a statement that is used (in Arabic) to negate the existence of anything that is similar to the described. It is to show that if there is none like him, then evidently there will be no one who is better than him.

6. Sufyān ibn Wakī' narrated to us that his father narrated from al-Mas'ūdī through the same chain a similar hadith.

7. Ibrahim ibn Muhammad (who is from the grandchildren of Alī ibn Abī Tālib) reported that whenever Alī used to describe the Prophet (peace be upon him), he would say: "The Messenger of Allāh was neither very tall nor very short, but of a medium stature amongst the people. His hair was neither very curly nor completely straight; rather it was in between these two descriptions.

He did not have a fleshy body or a [fully] round face, his face was slightly round. His skin colour was white with some redness. He had extremely black eyes with long eyelashes. He had large joints and broad shoulders. There was no hair [more than normal] on his body and he had a thin line of hair running from the chest to the navel. He had thick hands and feet. When he walked, he lifted his legs with vigour and his steps were firm and strong as if he was descending down a slope. When he wished to look behind, he would turn his whole body, and not just the face. The seal of prophethood was situated between his shoulders. He was the seal of the Prophets, and he had the

most generous of hearts and the most truthful tongue. He was the most kind-hearted and tolerant person ever. He was the best to spend time with due to his awe-inspiring character and kind treatment; anyone who came across him unexpectedly would become awestruck; and whoever came in close contact with him would love him. One who describes him can only state, 'I have never seen anyone comparable to him.'" [14]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The part, "He did not have a fleshy body" indicates that he was not fat.

The seal of prophethood refers to an area of raised skin between his shoulders.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The mention of him not turning the neck only is to show that he did not glance secretly or act as the reckless people do whenever they want to look at something.

As Muhammad (peace be upon him) is the last Prophet, when ʿĪsā descends during the end times, he will rule by and abide to the laws of Islām; he will spread justice, pray towards Makkah and take his judgements from the Qurʾān and Sunnah.

The parts that describe his kind-hearted and merciful nature as well as his excellent qualities conform to the event when Jibraʿīl split his chest and removed the share of the devil from his heart and then washed it with the water of Zamzam.

The part, "... the most truthful tongue" means that he used to utter the letters perfectly, beautifully and eloquently.

Alī al-Qārī said,

In another version of this hadīth, the part, "He was the most kind-hearted and tolerant person ever" was narrated as, "He is from the most noble tribe" and both versions truly describe him.

8. Al-Hasan ibn Alī reported: “I inquired from my maternal uncle, Hind ibn Abī Hālah about the awe-inspiring characteristics and features of the Prophet as he was known for doing so, as I desired to become well acquainted with and memorise his description.”

The uncle described the Prophet (peace be upon him) by saying: “His qualities and attributes were the acme of beauty, and his companions and whoever saw him held him in high esteem. His face used to shine like the full moon. He was of a medium height but closer to tall than average and shorter than a lanky person. His head was [moderately] large and his hair was slightly waved. If his hair could [naturally] be parted, he would have it so; otherwise he would make no efforts to part it and his hair would not go beyond his ear lobes. He had a skin tone that was white with a tinge of red and a wide forehead with perfect and complete eyebrows, consisting of hair that reached to the end of the line of his eyes. His eyebrows were separate and did not meet each other in the middle. There was a vein between them that used to expand whenever he became angry. His nose was prominent and was wrapped with a light that shines out. If one did not look at him closely, it would seem as if he had a large nasal bridge. His beard was full and dense and his cheek bones were not high. His mouth was [moderately] wide and he had a space between his teeth.

He had a thin line of hair from the chest to the navel and his neck was as beautiful as the neck of a doll made of ivory. All the parts of his body were of moderate size and fully fleshed. His body was proportionately jointed. His chest and stomach were in line, but his chest was broad and wide. He had a well-built body and the level of his chest and stomach was straight (i.e. he had no extra weight or fat). The space between his shoulders was wide and the bones of his joints were strong and large. His body parts had a brightness that shined whenever he removed his clothing. Between the upper point of the chest and navel he had a thin line of hair while the rest of the area had no

hair on it. His forearms were long and his palms were wide. The fingers and toes were moderately thick, and both his hands and legs were moderately long.

The soles of his feet were somewhat high from the ground. His feet were smooth [i.e. had no holes or cracks], such that water would not remain there and flow away quickly. When he walked, he lifted his legs with strength as if he was uprooting a plant; he leaned slightly forward and placed his feet softly on the ground. He walked at a moderate pace and naturally walked with long steps. When he walked it seemed as if he was descending to a lower place. When he wanted to look at something behind him, he would turn his whole body towards it. His gaze would often face down towards the earth; he looked more to the ground than towards the sky, [it was his habit not to stare] and most of his prolonged glances were thoughtful and intended for contemplating. He would let his companions walk in front whilst he himself walked behind, and he always hastened to greet whomsoever he met.” ^[15]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The maternal uncle of al-Hasan ibn ‘Alī was Hind ibn Abī Hālah, the son of the mother of believers, Khadījah bint Khuwailid who was raised by the Prophet (peace be upon him); hence being the stepbrother of Fātimah.

The reason why al-Hasan requested to learn the detailed description of the Prophet (peace be upon him) despite the fact that he had the honour of seeing him in person was because he was very young at that time [when the Prophet (peace be upon him) was alive]. The request of al-Hasan shows that learning the description of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is a knowledge that should be given priority.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

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“His face used to shine like the full moon”: Not only did he possess the most handsome face, but also the best character as reported in the two Saḥīḥ books.

The narrator preferred to use the term “full moon” instead of “the sun” when describing the brightness of the Prophet’s (peace be upon him) face. This is because, contrary to the sun, the moon can be looked at without causing the eye any harm.

It is reported in Saḥīḥ Muslim that the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to let his hair hang down while the idolaters used to part their hair, and the People of the Book used to let their hair hang down. He liked to be in harmony with the People of the Book in matters of which he had not received any command. Then later in his life he would part his hair. Though both practices are permissible, parting the hair is preferable since it was the practice that the Prophet (peace be upon him) settled with.

The part of this hadīth that describes the manner in which he would look is intended to mean that he would not glance sneakily when wanting to look at something. “He looked more to the ground than towards the sky,” due to his mindfulness of Allāh, his humility and shyness of Him.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The way the Prophet (peace be upon him) walked (i.e. walking with wide steps) is the praised walk for men as walking with short steps is a characteristic of women.

He used to look down to the earth when his glance was not focused on anything because he used to spend the time contemplating and pondering, and it was also his habit due to the humbleness he possessed. Likewise, he used to ask his companions to walk in front of him out of humbleness and also out of his consideration for the weak and wanting to look after them, as they are normally the ones who fall to the back of the group. Furthermore, it was proven in an authentic hadīth that he

told his companions, “The angels guard my back, so leave it for them.”

The wisdom behind why he used to hasten to greet others (give *salām*) is because this is the nature of the humble and also when one initiates the greeting, his initiation becomes a cause for the one being greeted to reciprocate and attain a reward.

9. Jābir ibn Samurah narrated: “The mouth of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was wide and there was some redness in the whites of his eyes, and he had only a small amount of flesh on his heels.” ^{[16] [17]}

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The quality of having white eyes with a hint of redness is a praised physical appearance amongst the Arabs.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Some scholars interpreted the part “wide mouth” to refer to his teeth but the majority understood this part as referring to the mouth.

10. Jābir ibn ‘Abdillāh said: “I saw Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) during a night where the moon was full. On that night, he wore a red garment and when I looked at the full moon and compared it with him, by Allāh, he was in my eyes better and more beautiful than the full moon.” ^[18]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The mention of a “full moon” was intended to show that it was a clear night that was neither dark nor cloudy, having a full moon from its beginning to its end.

The part of the hadīth, “... in my eyes” is to indicate the state he experienced personally and it is not intended to state that it could be otherwise in the eyes of another person.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

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There are a number of hadīths wherein the face of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was likened to the moon, and this is only to explain his beauty because Allāh, the Most High, lavished him with a beauty that is far beyond the beauty of the moon.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The part mentioning the red garment indicates that it made his beauty increase, thereby attracting one's eyes and attention.

The part where the narrator mentioned that he found him more beautiful than the moon in his eyes is not intended to state that others may not have considered such, rather the intention was to show his happiness at what he saw as every believing person would see him as such.

11. Abū Ishāq related: "A person asked al-Barā' ibn 'Āzib, 'Was the face of Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) like a sword?' He replied, 'No, it was like the moon.'" [19]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Al-Hafith ibn Hajar commented on this hadīth in Fathul Bārī saying, "It appears as if the questioner intended to ask if his face was long like how a sword is; hence the answer gave the example of the moon to show that his face was more rounded, and it is possible that he intended to ask if his face was as bright and refined as a sword, so the answer was the moon to show that the brightness of his face surpassed that of the sword and so selecting the moon was to combine both qualities."

12. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The skin tone of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was white to a degree that it seemed as if he was moulded from silver, and his hair was slightly curled." [20]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The expression of "... moulded in silver" refers to the brightness and light shining from his skin. It will come under the chapter of the recitation of the Prophet (peace be upon him) that he said, "Allāh has not sent a Prophet except that he has a beautiful face and a beautiful voice, and your Prophet (i.e. Muhammad) has the most beautiful face and most beautiful voice among them." This indicates that he was more handsome than Prophet Yusuf.

13. Jābir ibn 'Abdullāh narrated that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said: "The Prophets were shown to me. I saw Mūsa and his build and height were medium as if he was from the tribe of Shanū'ah. I saw Īsa and from among all those whom I have seen, 'Urwah ibn Mas'ūd resembled him the most. I saw Ibrahīm and from among all those that I have seen, I resembled him the most. I saw Angel Jibra'īl and from among all those I have seen, Dihyyah resembled him the most." ^[21]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It is possible that they were shown to him in a dream or when he ascended to the heavens. The tribe of Shanū'ah is from Yemen and were known for having strong bodies and good physical stature.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Dihyyah was one of the companions and he was considered to be from amongst the most handsome and good looking men. It happened in many cases that Jibra'īl used to appear in the form of this companion.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī stated that this event took place during the night the Prophet (peace be upon him) ascended to the sky as explained in many other authentic hadiths while some other hadiths state that this event happened in different incidents. However, the most correct view, as it appears to be, is that he

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(peace be upon him) met them in the heavens after he ascended and then when he descended he gathered with them in Bayt al-Maqdis where he led them in prayers.

Perhaps, the reason why the names of only these three prophets were mentioned is because Ibrahīm (peace be upon him) is the forefather of the Arabs and he is accepted by all faiths, while Mūsa and Īsa are Prophets of the people of the book.

14. Sa'īd al-Jarīrī narrated: "I heard Abū al-Tufayl say, 'I am the last of the companions who is still alive and saw the Prophet (peace be upon him).' I asked him to describe him to me and so he said, 'He (peace be upon him) was a handsome man with a white complexion and his body was moderate.'" ^[22]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Abū al-Tufayl was the last surviving companion of the Prophet (peace be upon him). He passed away in 110 after Hijrah.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Abū Tufayl is 'Amir ibn Wathilah al-Laythī and he saw the Prophet (peace be upon him) during the last eight years of his life.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

"His body was moderate" means that he was moderate in all physical aspects, whether in terms of height, skin tone, build and hair type etc.

15. 'Abdullāh ibn 'Abbās narrated: "There was a space between the front teeth of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). Whenever he talked, light could be seen emitting from his mouth." ^[23]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

There are many hadīths describing the Prophet (peace be upon him) having light emitting from between his teeth and that his face was as bright as the moon and so forth. This has caused some to err as they have understood this literally, as in actual light that shines and enlightens all that surrounds him. In fact, some went to such extremes that they claimed that he did not possess a shadow due to this light. This understanding is obviously fallacious and there are many hadīths that prove it to be untenable, one of which is the report of Aisha, which is documented in Sahīh Muslim, wherein she narrated that she woke up in the night and did not find the Prophet (peace be upon him) in bed, so she began to search for him in the dark using her hands until they landed on his feet while he was saying, *“O Allāh! I seek refuge in Your pleasure from Your anger, and in Your forgiveness from Your punishment. I seek refuge with You from You. I cannot count Your praises. You are as You have praised Yourself.”* If the light referred to in these hadīths was an actual light, she would not have needed to search for him in the dark using her hands.

CHAPTER TWO

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE SEAL OF PROPHETHOOD

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This is a sub-chapter of the previous one as it is still detailing the physical appearance of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

Alī al-Qārī said,

The title of this chapter entails that it will describe the colour, shape and location of the seal.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason it was called a seal was to indicate the authenticity of his prophethood just like how a seal is used to certify the authenticity of documents. It could also be to signify that he is the last prophet as the term “seal” is often used in reference to the end of something.

16. Al-Sā'ib ibn Yazīd narrated: “My maternal aunt took me to the Prophet (peace be upon him) and said to him, ‘O Messenger of Allāh, this nephew of mine is ill.’ The Prophet (peace be upon him) then wiped his hand over my head and supplicated to Allāh to bless me. Then he (peace be upon him) performed ablution and I drank from the water of his ablution. I saw the seal of prophethood between his shoulders; it was similar to the egg of a partridge.” ^[24]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

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“This nephew of mine is ill”: In other hadīths, it was mentioned that she said to the Prophet (peace be upon him) that her nephew fell down. This made scholars conclude that the injury was to his foot, and this is what al-Hafith ibn Hajar confirmed after he acknowledged the other hadīths.

“Wiped his hand over my head”: The Prophet (peace be upon him) rubbed the head instead of the injured area as this is a more kind and sympathetic gesture and through it he could examine the companion’s heartbeat and body temperature.

“I drank from the water of his ablution”: The use of the remnants of water that the Prophet (peace be upon him) made ablution with for remedy and treatment was practiced by his companions. However, this attribute is exclusive to him and thus no one should seek remedy or blessing through anyone else’s spit, sweat or leftovers etc., regardless of their high status and virtue.

“Between his shoulders”: Some scholars said that the wisdom of the seal being placed closer to the left side was because that location is closer to the heart.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Al-Bayhaqī and others reported that the touch of the Prophet (peace be upon him) on the hair of al-Sā’ib caused his hair to stay black until he died, though grey hairs appeared on his other body parts. The supplication of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was answered and so al-Sā’ib died at the age of ninety six whilst enjoying a very healthy body.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“This nephew of mine is ill”: The boy had pain in his feet and the reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) wiped his head instead, was either because the boy felt pain in his head as well or because wiping the head is a more noble action than wiping the feet.

17. Jābir ibn Samurah related: “I saw the seal of the prophethood of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) between his two shoulders. It was red raised flesh that appeared like a pigeon’s egg.” ^[25]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“Between his two shoulders”: This gives the approximate location only and it is not intended to identify the exact location of the seal. This is because the seal was positioned closer to the left shoulder.

The colour of the seal has been established to be red, just like the colour of the rest of his body.

Alī al-Qārī said,

“Like a pigeon’s egg”: This shows the similarity between the size, colour and shape of the pigeon’s egg and the seal. Though this comparison entails that the colour of the seal is white, it does not contradict the fact that the skin tone of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was white with some redness. Also, it is possible that the [comparison with something of] white colour was intended to indicate pureness.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“It was red raised flesh”: This indicates that its colour was the same as his skin.

18. Rumaythah said: “I heard the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) - and at that time the distance between us was very small, such that if I wanted to, I could have kissed the seal of prophethood – saying after the death of Sā’d ibn Mu’ādh, ‘The Throne of Allāh shook [because of his death].’” ^[26]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“The distance between us was very small”: This is to confirm that she heard him.

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“The Throne of Allāh shook [because of his death]”: This shows the great virtue and status of the companion Sā'd ibn Mu'ādh.

Alī al-Qārī said,

“The death of Sā'd ibn Mu'ādh”: He was the master of the tribe of the Ansār and he died at the age of thirty seven due to an injury he sustained during the Battle of the Trench.

When the hypocrites joked that his coffin was light, the Prophet (peace be upon him) said that he was carried by seventy thousand angels.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“The Throne of Allāh shook [because of his death]”: It shook literally because it was happy that his soul had ascended above and also to make the angels aware of his virtues and his death. In another interpretation, it was argued that the word “shook” was used metaphorically to mean rejoicing at his arrival.

19. Ibrahīm ibn Muhammad, the grandson of Alī ibn Abī Tālib said: “Whenever Alī used to describe the Prophet (peace be upon him), he would narrate the complete hadīth and then add, ‘The seal of prophethood was between his shoulders, and he was the seal of all Prophets.’”^[27] ^[28]

20. Ilyā' ibn Ahmar al-Yashkurī narrated that Abū Zayd, 'Amro ibn Akhtab al-Ansārī said: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said to me, ‘O Abū Zayd, come closer to me and rub my back.’ I began rubbing his back and I felt the seal of prophethood.” Ilyā' asked Amro (peace be upon him), “What is the seal of prophethood?” He replied, “It was a collection of a few hairs.”^[29]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Rub my back”: This indicates that it is permissible for one person to touch the body of another person provided that both

are from the same gender and the area touched is not from the *'awrah*.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“O Abū Zayd”: This shows the kindness and politeness of the Prophet (peace be upon him) when dealing with his companions i.e. he called his companion using his *kunya* and not his actual name.

“It was a collection of a few hairs”: However, the seal was not just a collection of hairs. It was a piece of flesh the size of an egg and it was surrounded by a few hairs.

In a different version of this hadīth documented in the Musnad of Imām Ahmad, the Prophet (peace be upon him) wiped his hand over his beard and hair and said, “O Allāh, beautify him and make his beauty last.” The supplication was answered and this companion lived over one hundred years, having hardly any grey hairs and skin without wrinkles.

We can also benefit from the supplication of the Prophet (peace be upon him) if we look after his Sunnah because he said, “May Allāh enlighten the face of a person who heard my words, understood them and delivered them to others as he heard from me.”^[30] This is why Sufyān ibn ‘Uyayna said, “No one seeks the knowledge of hadīth except that his face is bright.”

Alī al-Qārī said,

‘Amro ibn Zayd al-Ansārī was one of the four companions who memorised the entire Qur’ān at that time.

“Rub my back”: he was asked to do so either because the Prophet (peace be upon him) needed to scratch his back, or to check if there was something harmful there, or to receive the honour of touching his noble body.

21. Buraydah narrated: “When Salmān al-Fārisī came to Madīnah, he visited the Prophet (peace be upon him) and brought a tray on which there were some dates that he placed

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before the hands of the Prophet (peace be upon him). The Prophet (peace be upon him) asked, 'What are these?' He replied, 'This is an almsgiving to you and your companions.' Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) replied, 'We do not eat from charity; take it away from me.' And so Salmān complied and removed them. On the next day he brought some dates and placed them in front of the Prophet (peace be upon him) who asked him, 'O Salmān, what are these?' To which he replied, 'O Messenger of Allāh, it is a present for you.' The Prophet (peace be upon him) invited his companions to eat from these dates. He then saw the seal of prophethood on the back of Allāh's Messenger and embraced Islām.

At that time, he was a slave to a Jew so the Prophet made an agreement with his master to grant Salmān his freedom in return of a sum of money and after the planting of [a particular number of] date palms for the Jew that Salmān would tend to until they produced dates. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) planted all the date palms except one that 'Umar planted. On the same year, all the date palms produced dates except one. So the Prophet (peace be upon him) inquired about it and 'Umar replied that he planted that palm tree. The Prophet then uprooted it and planted it again. Thereafter the palm tree produced dates in the same year."^[31]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The reason why Salmān (peace be upon him) presented the dates to the Prophet (peace be upon him) as a charity on the first occasion and as a gift on the second was because he sought to find the last prophet. He was aware that from the signs of this prophet was that he does not eat from charity but he accepts that which is gifted to him. The other sign that he looked for was the seal which he saw on his back.

“All the date palms produced dates except one”: The wisdom behind this was so that the miracle of the Prophet (peace be upon him) could be displayed to the people.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“We do not eat from charity”: This includes both the obligatory and voluntary charity as well as all that which is deemed obligatory in religion such as compensation and vows.

“The Prophet (peace be upon him) agreed with his master to free him... In return of”: It can be concluded from this that it is recommended to help slaves free themselves.

Alī al-Qārī said,

“This is an almsgiving to you and your companions”: One of the commentators said that charity is something that the superior gives to the inferior, seeking the reward in the Hereafter and it entails that the receiver is pitiable. In contrast, a gift is a means to seek closeness to the recipient and it does not entail any sense of pity towards the recipient.

“We do not eat from charity”: The pronoun refers to the prophets as well as his relatives from the tribe of Banī Hashim and al-Muttalib. It does not include the Companions.

“O Salmān, what are these?": The Prophet (peace be upon him) addressed him on the first occasion without mentioning his name but on the second occasion he mentioned his name to show more kindness as he felt he was about to embrace Islām.

22. Abū Nadrah al-‘Awaqī related: “I asked Abū Sa’īd al-Khudarī about the seal of prophethood of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him). He said, ‘It was a raised piece of flesh on his back.’” ^[32]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“... On his back”: As other hadīths show, the seal was located on his back between the two shoulders and it was closer to the left one.

23. ‘Abdullāh ibn Sarjas narrated: “I came to Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) while he was sitting with some of his companions. I went to stand behind him – like this – and so the Prophet (peace be upon him) understood my purpose. So, he dropped the cloak he was wearing on his back and then I saw the place of the seal of prophethood on his shoulders. It was like a clenched fist surrounded by beauty spots. I then walked and stood in front of him and said, ‘O Messenger of Allāh, may Allāh forgive you.’ To that he replied, ‘May Allāh forgive you too.’ The people said to me, ‘Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) has asked Allāh to forgive you?’ I replied, ‘Yes, and he asked Him to forgive you too.’ Then, he recited, {[O Muhammad] seek forgiveness for yourself and the believing males and females.}” ^[33]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Understood my purpose”: He understood that the companion wanted to see the seal.

“O Messenger of Allāh, may Allāh forgive you”: He said it to show his gratitude for allowing him to see the seal.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“It was like a clenched fist”: All the hadīths describing the size of the seal are similar though each narrator used different examples i.e. some said it was the size of an egg, and some said it was like a piece of flesh, and some said it was like a clenched fist.

“Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) has asked Allāh to forgive you”: This was a statement they said to express the greatness of the supplication of the Prophet (peace be upon him). Some people err and misunderstand the statement of Allāh, the Exalted, wherein He said, **{And if, when they**

wronged themselves, they had come to you, [O Muhammad], and asked forgiveness of Allāh and the Messenger had asked forgiveness for them, they would have found Allāh Accepting of repentance and Merciful.}^[34], thinking that he (peace be upon him) would still ask Allāh to forgive people even after his death. The correct view is that he could ask Allāh to forgive people only during his lifetime as proven in the authentic hadīth in Sahīh al-Bukhārī when Aisha said, “O my head!” Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) said, “If that (your death) should happen while I am still alive, I would ask Allāh to forgive you and would invoke Allāh for you.”

The inquiry and surprise of the people who asked whether the Prophet (peace be upon him) asked Allāh to forgive the narrator is another proof because if he could do so after his death they would have not showed such surprise and wishful thinking.

Alī al-Qārī said,

It is a matter of fact that the Prophet (peace be upon him) was infallible; hence the issue of him seeking Allāh's forgiveness is understood to mean either to forgive him for any thought that crossed his mind unwillingly (as it is the nature of mankind), or to mean that he asked Allāh to maintain his infallibility (though the fact that he was granted it shows his ultimate submission to Allāh), or it can mean that he asked Allāh to forgive his use of lawful matters and his inability to worship Allāh enough to fulfil His due rights.

CHAPTER THREE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE HAIR OF THE PROPHET

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This title is given to show that the subsequent section will include hadīths describing the hair of the Prophet (peace be upon him); its length, style, and how he used to look after it.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) never shaved his head except in the year in which the treaty of Hdaybiyah took place, the Umrah al-Qadā (i.e. the Umrah he performed in order to make up for the one he missed during the year of Hdaybiyah), the farewell Hajj. And he only cut his hair short once as reported in Sahīh al-Bukhārī and Sahīh Muslim.

24. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The hair of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) reached to the mid-portion of his ears.” ^[35]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

In other hadīths, the narrators stated that the length of the hair of the Prophet (peace be upon him) reached to his shoulders; hence some scholars explained that this is because the length of his hair differed from one time to another and so each narrator described what he saw.

Al-Suyūtī said,

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Al-Hafith al-Iraqī said, “The hadīths have provided three different descriptions of the hair of the Prophet (peace be upon him), namely:

Wafrah: It refers to having hair that reaches the earlobe.

Lummah: It refers to having hair that reaches below the earlobe

Jumma: It refers to shoulder length hair.

Alī al-Qārī said,

There are eight hadīths that describe the length of the hair of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

25. Aisha narrated: “I used to bathe with the Prophet (peace be upon him) in one utensil, and his hair was below his earlobes but above his shoulders.” ^[36]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth is evidence that the water remaining from the bath of women is ritually pure.

26. Al-Barā ibn ‘Āzib narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was of average height, and the distance between his two shoulders was wide. His hair would fall to his earlobes.” ^[37]

27. Qatādah narrated: “I asked Anas ibn Mālik, ‘How was the hair of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him)?’ He replied, ‘It was neither very curly nor very straight; it reached his earlobes.’” ^[38]

28. Umm Hanī’ bint Abī Tālib said: “Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) entered Makkah and he had four plaits.” ^[39]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Umm Hanī’ is the sister of Alī ibn Abī Tālib.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It appears that she saw him on the day of the conquest of Makkah because he prayed the *Duha* prayer in her house.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) came to Makkah four times [after the Hijrah]: (i) 'Umrah al-Qadā, (ii) the conquest of Makkah, (iii) 'Umrah al-Ja'ranah, (iv) the farewell Hajj.

29. Ma'mar reported that Anas ibn Mālik said that: "The hair of Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) reached the mid-portion of his ears." ^[40]

30. 'Abdullāh ibn 'Abbās narrated: "The hairstyle of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was *sadl* and the polytheists used to part their hair while the hairstyle of the People of the Book was *sadl*. He preferred not to oppose the People of the Book unless he was ordered otherwise." ^[41]

The meaning of *sadl* is disputed over among scholars, some of them (such as Al-Bajūrī) stated that it means he let his hair hang down freely around the head, and some (such as al-Nawawī, al-Suyūṭī and Alī al-Qārī) were of the view that it means he let his hair fall on his forehead.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Ibn Hajar said that the last practice of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was to part his hair.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to keep a hairstyle similar to that of the People of the Book because he preferred their way over the way of the polytheists, unless he was ordered to oppose them. This is because either they (Christians and Jews) have celestial religions, divine books and prophets, or because they are closer to the truth than the polytheists, since they followed some of the original teachings of their religion

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during that time (as the known scholar Mirak al-Hanafī explained); hence they deserved better treatment than the polytheists.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“He preferred not to oppose the People of the Book unless he was ordered otherwise”: He liked to do so in matters where he was not ordered, regardless whether the divine order entailed an obligation or recommendation. Al-Qurtubī said, “This was only at the beginning when he arrived at Madīnah, during the time he used to pray towards their *qiblah*. The reason behind this was that he wanted to soften their hearts towards Islām but when this approach did not show any benefit and their hearts remained hard, he ordered the Muslims to oppose them in many affairs.

31. Umm Hanī' bint Abī Tālib said: “I saw Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) having four plaits.”^[42]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Shaykh ibn ‘Uthaymīn was asked, “Is it from the Sunnah to prolong the hair?” To which he replied, “No, it is not from the Sunnah because the Prophet (peace be upon him) lengthened his hair in a time in which that was the custom of people. This is why he ordered the young boy who shaved part of his head, ‘Shave it all or leave it all.’ If the hair is supposed to be left to grow long he would have ordered the boy to leave it all only... With that being said, if you live in a place where the custom of the people is to grow their hair long, then do so. Otherwise do not.”

However, it is worthy to mention that one must not imitate women or disbelievers. This is important to mention as we see some youth prolonging their hair and having their hair fashioned in the style of women, to the point they may use the accessories of women to hold their hair, and even worse, their

faces are also clean shaved. Likewise some may simulate the disbelievers in their hairstyles or hair dyes, and some of them may argue that prolonging the hair is Sunnah when all the while they do not even commit to praying the obligatory prayers.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This shows that it is permissible for men to plait their hair and that it is not limited to women, even if it is often the practice of women to plait their hair in this era.

CHAPTER FOUR

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE HAIR CARE OF THE PROPHET

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The author dedicated this chapter to listing the hadīths that describe the combing and the hair care of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

The Prophet (peace be upon him) was moderate and balanced about his hair; neither was he obsessed about his hair or negligent regarding it.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The hair care is part of the cleanliness and personal hygiene that the legislator encouraged and recommended. The Prophet (peace be upon him) said, “Cleanliness is from *imān*”^[43] and, “Whoever has hair should honour it.”^[44]

32. Aisha related: “I used to comb the hair of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) even whilst I was in the state of menstruation.”^[45]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This is evidence that it is permissible for the wife to comb the hair of her husband and touch him while she is menstruating, and that the body of a menstruating woman is not deemed ritually impure.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

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This is evidence that it is only the menstrual blood of the woman that is ritually impure while the rest of her body is pure. It also shows that the wife should look after her husband in all cases, and that she can still spend time with her husband during menses as avoiding the wife during her menses is the way of the Jews.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth shows that it is recommended to comb the hair, and to comb the beard as well, based on analogy.

33. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to frequently oil his hair and comb his beard. He would often wear a cloth around his head, which would eventually appear to look like the cloth of an oilman.” ^[46]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“Used to frequently oil his hair”: It means that he would often use oil whenever he combed his hair.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Would wear a cloth”: This is a cloth that is put over the head to protect the turban from the stains of oil.

Alī al-Qārī said,

“And comb his beard”: This indicates that he used to oil his beard when combing it.

“Which would eventually appear to look like the cloth of an oilman”: This refers only to the hair-cover. This meaning is the most suitable and it befits the state of the Prophet (peace be upon him) whose clothes were evidently always clean, not to mention the many hadīths wherein he encouraged people to keep their clothes clean. This meaning is also proven from other hadīths that explicitly clarified that it refers to the hair-cover.

Al-Suyūṭī said,

“He would often wear a cloth around his head”: He (peace be upon him) also used to cover his head during intercourse often and this was done due to his shyness.

34. Aisha narrated: “Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) used to like to start with the right side when engaging in his ritual purification, combing his hair, and putting on his sandals.” ^[47]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It is recommended to start with the right side in all that which is deemed good such as entering the *masjid*, eating, drinking, shaking the hands, exchanging money or items between people and wearing clothes etc. The opposite should be observed – that is to say – to start with the left side in opposite activities such as entering the toilet, leaving the *masjid*, [taking off shoes and socks] etc.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Used to like to start with the right side”: Imām al-Bukhārī documented another version that has the addition, “as long as he was able to”, which indicates that one should observe this behaviour unless there is something that prevents us from that. The reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) liked to start with the right side is because the dwellers of Paradise are the people of the right.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Engaging in his ritual purification”: He liked to start with the right side in ablution when washing the hands and the feet, but did not follow the same manner when washing the cheeks and ears.

Alī al-Qārī said,

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“Engaging in his ritual purification”: The purification mentioned in this hadīth includes *wudū*, *ghusl* and *tayammum* but it does not include purifying oneself from physical impurity (*istinjah* and *istijmār*).

Al-Nawawī said,

All scholars are in agreement that starting with the right side in ablution is a Sunnah and whoever opposes it misses its reward but their ablution is valid.

35. ‘Abdullāh ibn Mughaffal narrated: “Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) prohibited the combing of hair unless it is done occasionally.” ^[48]

Abdul Razzaq al Badr said,

This means that one must not let his haircare occupy all of his time and so one should be neither negligent nor indulgent.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason behind this prohibition was because it gives the impression that one is indulging in luxury and adornment, which is the habit of women.

Abū Bakr ibn al-‘Arabī said,

Taking care of the hair constantly is showing off, neglecting it is foulness and looking after it occasionally is the Sunnah.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This prohibition applies to oiling the hair too.

Alī al-Qārī said,

‘Abdullāh ibn Mughaffal was one of the companions who witnessed the Pledge of the Tree.

36. Humayd ibn Abdul Rahman narrated from one of the companions that it was the habit of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to comb his hair occasionally. ^[49]

CHAPTER FIVE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE WHITE HAIRS OF THE PROPHET

Al-Bajūrī said,

The author dedicated this chapter to listing the hadīths wherein the white hairs of the Prophet (peace be upon him) are mentioned. This chapter was placed after the chapter of the haircare of the Prophet because the latter includes actions (combing, oiling and styling the hair) that we can take as examples to follow.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter will clarify whether the Prophet (peace be upon him) had any white hairs or not on his head or beard, and how many there were.

37. Qatādah related: “I asked Anas ibn Mālik, ‘Did the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) dye his hair?’ He replied, ‘He did not need to for all he had were a few white hairs on his temples. However, Abū Bakr dyed his hair with henna and *katam*.’” ^[50]

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Did the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) dye his hair?": Meaning, did he change the colour of the white hairs in his head and beard using the henna or anything else.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

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“He did not need to for all he had were a few white hairs on his temples”: This indicates that he dyed the few white hairs he had on his temples. The Prophet (peace be upon him) dyed his hair as will be explained in the following chapter.

Abū Bakr dyed his hair using both henna and *katam* at the same time because using *katam* alone would make the hair colour completely black and this is condemned. This is supported by the explicit hadīth found in Saḥīḥ Muslim.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Henna is a reddish brown dye used especially on hair. *Katam* is a plant that makes the hair black.

38. Anas ibn Mālik related: “I did not count more than fourteen white hairs on the head and beard of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).” ^[51]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The number of white hairs that Anas counted in the hair and beard of the Prophet (peace be upon him) explains why he stated that he did not need to dye his hair (see the previous hadīth).

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Fourteen white hairs”: Anas stated in another hadīth that there were seventeen or eighteen white hairs and that could be because he counted them on two different occasions.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Ibn Hajar said, “In Saḥīḥ al-Bukhārī, ‘Abdullāh ibn Busr said that the white hairs of the Prophet did not exceed ten. This could be said in reference to the white hairs he had under his lower lip.”

39. Jābir ibn Samurah was asked about the white hair of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him), and so he replied: “Whenever

he oiled his hair, it (white hair) did not show. However when he did not oil it, it showed.” ^[52]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This corroborates the statement of Anas that the Prophet (peace be upon him) only had a few white hairs.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Whenever he oiled his hair, it (white hair) did not show”: This is because the white hair became mixed with the glittering of the hair after it was oiled.

40. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had about twenty white hairs.” ^[53]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This conforms to the reports of Jābir and Anas since Ibn ‘Umar gave an approximate number.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth does not contradict the previous hadīth of Anas who stated that he had fourteen white hairs. This is because the number fourteen is more than half of twenty and so it can be used to refer to the higher number [i.e. it is to give an approximate number].

41. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Abbās narrated: “Abū Bakr exclaimed, ‘O Messenger of Allāh, you have white hairs!’ The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) replied, ‘Sūrahs Hūd, al-Wāqī‘ah, al-Mursalāt, ‘Amma Yatasā’alūn (an-Nabā’) and Idhā-sh-Shamsu Kuwwirat (at-Takwīr) have turned my hair white.” ^[54]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The exclamation of Abū Bakr was because he was surprised to see white hairs on the Prophet (peace be upon him) due to the

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fact that his nature was balanced and his mood was neutral, and white hairs are unlikely to show on one with such characteristics.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The reason why these sūrahs made his hair turn white is because they talk about the terror of the Day of Judgment. This proves that the white hairs he had were not because of experiencing worldly issues but rather due to his concern and thoughtfulness about the Hereafter.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) mentioned Sūrah al-Hūd before the other sūrahs is because it includes the order to hold-fast to the straight path that only those whom Allāh has engulfed with the garment of His safety can perfect it.

42. Abū Juhaifah narrated: “Some people said to the Prophet (peace be upon him), ‘O Messenger of Allāh! Your hair has turned white!’ He replied, ‘Sūrah Hūd and its sisters have turned my hair white.’” ^[55]

Al-Bajūrī said,

“... Its sisters”: This refers to all the sūrahs that are similar to Sūrah Hūd – that is to say, all the sūrahs that talk about the terror of the Day of Judgment.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The answer of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was an indirect way of stating that he had white hair because of his concern for the Hereafter. It shows the great effect of the Qur’ān and the immense benefits that can be procured when a person contemplates it and understands its meanings and signs. Whoever ponders upon the Qur’ān in the way it should be, they will be focused on the Hereafter without neglecting the

necessary affairs in this worldly life. This is why the Prophet (peace be upon him) said, “O Allāh, do not let this worldly life be our biggest concern,”^[56] which entails that it is fine for us to look after our worldly affairs but it should not preoccupy us and distract us from the purpose for which we were created – that is: worshipping Allāh alone and preparing to meet Him on the Last Day.

43. Abū Rimtha al-Taymī related: “I went with my son to see the Prophet (peace be upon him). When they showed him to me, I said immediately, ‘This is the Prophet of Allāh!’ He was wearing two pieces of green clothing, and there were some whites in his hair, which were dyed red in colour.”^[57]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“When they showed him to me”: It appears as if this was his first time seeing the Prophet (peace be upon him) as someone pointed him out to him.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“This is the Prophet of Allāh!”: He said it to affirm to the one who led him to see the Prophet (peace be upon him) that he believed that the one whom he was shown was truly the Prophet i.e. it is like saying, “I believe you, O you who showed me the Prophet because I am now confident that he is the Prophet of Allāh after seeing the light of his prophethood and aura of his high-esteem.” It is also possible that he said that to his son i.e. “O son, this is the Prophet of Allāh!”

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Which were red in colour”: This conforms to the hadīth of Ibn ‘Umar who said that the colour of the edges of his white hair was red; they were dyed.

44. Jābir ibn Samurah was asked: “Were there any white hairs on the head of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him)?” He

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replied, “He only had a few on the middle parting, but whenever he applied oil to his hair, they did not show.” ^[58]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This description of the companions regarding the white hair of the Prophet (peace be upon him) shows that he used to uncover his head sometimes.

Al-Bajūrī said,

It is disliked to pluck the white hair according to the majority of scholars based on the hadīth, “Do not pluck out white-hairs, for they are the light of the Muslim.” ^[59]

Alī al-Qārī said,

As the white hairs did not show when he (peace be upon him) oiled his hair, this indicates that they were few.

CHAPTER SIX

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE USAGE OF DYE BY THE PROPHET

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The author included this chapter in his book to show whether the Prophet (peace be upon him) dyed his hair or not. In summary, the companions differed in opinion about it as mentioned by Ibn al-Qayyim who quoted the statements of many companions such as Anas ibn Mālik who denied that the Prophet ever dyed his hair and Abū Hurairah who affirmed that the Prophet dyed his hair. Some other companions said that he used to perfume his hair abundantly, which made his hair appear reddish and that made people think his hair was dyed when it was not.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Dye refers to colouring the hair with henna or any other dyestuff. According to us – Shāfi'ī scholars, it is the Sunnah to dye the hair with any colour except black and it is forbidden to dye the hair with black.

45. Abū Rimthah related: “I went with my son to visit the Prophet (peace be upon him). [When he saw me], he asked, ‘Is this your son?’ I replied, ‘Yes, this is my son. I testify to that.’ Then he said, ‘You are not held accountable for his crimes, nor is he held accountable for your crimes.’” Abū Rimthah then remarked, “I noticed that the white hairs of the Prophet (peace be upon him) had been dyed red.”

Al-Tirmidhī commented: “This hadīth is the most correct and explanatory report on the subject of using a dye. This is because the authentic hadīths state that he did not have many white hairs. The name of Abū Rimthah is Rifā’ah ibn Yathrabī al-Taymī” ^[60]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth shows that if it is possible for parents to take their children to the gatherings of good such as lectures and visiting scholars etc., then they should do so. This will cause the children to grow up loving the people of knowledge and the circles of knowledge. This should be more emphasised in the current era, as the fruits of deviation and misguidance are everywhere and desires and whims are playing with the Muslim youth. Thus, parents should take their children to the places of knowledge with encouragement and kindness so that the love of these places is instilled into them.

“I noticed that the white hairs of the Prophet (peace be upon him) had been dyed red”: This could have been because of dye being applied or due to the effect of the oil that he used to use. The people of knowledge differed on this; some of them such as Umm Salamah said it was because of dye, and some said it was because of oil and that he never used dye as affirmed by Anas ibn Mālik.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“I testify to that”: [The Arabic words used for this part] could also mean, “[O Prophet of Allāh] be a witness that he is my son” and so the statement is an affirmation of his answer, “Yes, he is my son.” It could also mean, “I testify to that [i.e. I testify and acknowledge that he is my son]” to advise the Prophet (peace be upon him) that he will take the consequences of the actions of his son as this was the norm during the times of *jahiliyyah*.

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“This hadīth is the most correct and explanatory report”: This statement does not necessitate that the hadīth is authentic because scholars use it even if the hadīth is weak i.e. they intend to mean with that statement that it is the least weak hadīth.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“You are not held accountable for his crime”: This response was to show Abū Rimtha that he will not be held accountable or take the burden of his son’s sins and mistakes, and that his son will not be held accountable for his father’s mistakes and sins. From this, our renowned [Shāfi’ī] scholars concluded that the father and the children of the killer are not liable to contribute in the blood-money.

46. Abū Hurairah was asked: “Did the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) dye his hair?” He replied, “Yes.” ^[61]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This conforms to the statement of Ibn ‘Umar which is documented in Sahīh al-Bukhārī and Sahīh Muslim i.e. he narrated that he saw the Prophet (peace be upon him) use a yellow dye. This is our evidence that using a dye colour other than black [i.e. it is not allowed to use black dye] is an act of Sunnah. Other hadīths that are documented by Abū Dawūd also support this.

Al-Nawawī said,

The view that we adopt is that it is recommended for both men and women to use reddish-brown or yellow dye, and that it is forbidden for them to dye the hair black except in the case where men do this for the purpose of *jihad*.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth confirms the other hadīths that the Prophet (peace be upon him) did dye his hair. To reconcile between these

hadīths and those hadīths that negate his use of dye, we say that he used to dye his hair at one point, then he stopped doing that most of the time or did it very infrequently; hence each narrator reported what they saw.

47. Al-Jahdamah (the wife of Bashir ibn al-Khasāsiyah) related: “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) coming out of his house; after taking a bath, shaking [water from] his hair. I saw on his head the remnants of henna (or saffron).” [The doubt of whether henna or saffron was seen is from Ibrahīm ibn Harūn.] ^[62]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“I saw on his head the remnants of henna”: Some hadīth commentators stated that this part does not necessitate that he dyed his hair. Rather, it is possible that he used the henna for medical purposes or to reduce heat from his head (cool down) or for any other similar purposes.

48. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “I saw the hair of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) dyed.” ^[63]

Alī al-Qārī said,

It has been stated in other authentic hadīths that Anas ibn Mālik denied that the Prophet (peace be upon him) dyed his hair. With that said, it is possible that he intended to say that he did not use dye most of the time, and that he used dye infrequently.

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

You should know that it is proven in many hadīths documented in the two Sahīh books and other books of hadīth that Anas held the view that the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not dye his hair or that he did not possess enough white hairs to warrant the use of dye on them. This hadīth, however, is the only report from him that states otherwise; hence either this hadīth is

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classified as odd or it refers to when he saw him after his death. This is because it was reported by al-Daraqutnī that Abū Hurairah said, “After the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him), everyone who had some of the hairs of the Prophet (peace be upon him) dyed them in order to preserve them.” Hence it is possible that Anas saw his dyed hair in the possession of one of his companions.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The conclusion is that all the authentic hadīths indicate that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had few white hairs, so he had no need to dye them as reported by Anas ibn Mālik (peace be upon him) and others. As for the reddish colour that was noticed in his hair, which was thought to be because of dye, it was most probably due to the use of oil or perfume.

CHAPTER SEVEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE KOHL OF THE PROPHET

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Kohl is a well known stone that is easy to disintegrate and it is used to darken the edges of the eyelids. To produce it [for cosmetic use], it is crushed until it becomes smooth and then it is applied to the eyelids. It comes in two colours, black and red.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The author listed the chapter of kohl right after the chapter of dye due to the similarity between the two since both are means of adornment.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

Applying the kohl to the eyelid is a Sunnah according to all Shāfi'ī scholars, based on the hadīths that talk about it.

Abū Bakr ibn al-Arabī said,

There are two benefits of the application of kohl: (i) adornment, which religion did not put a restriction on; thus it is used as needed, (ii) medicine, because it improves the sight and helps eyelashes grow, and it has been religiously prescribed to be done every night so that this benefit can be attained.

49. 'Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said: "Apply the *ithmid* (kohl) on the eye; it strengthens the eyesight, and facilitates the growth of the

eyelashes.” He also asserted that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had a small container for keeping kohl, from which he applied it on each eyelid three times every night. ^[64]

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

“Apply the *ithmid*”: It is intended to mean use it frequently.

“...Every night”: Meaning he did it every night before sleeping.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“Facilitates the growth of the eyelashes”: Not only do long eyelashes protect the eyes from dust, but they also increase the eyes in beauty.

“On each eyelid three times”: Applying it in an odd number is encouraged because he (peace be upon him) said in another hadīth, “When anyone of you applies kohl on their eyes, do it in an odd number.” ^[65] There are two methods that scholars have mentioned based on the different hadīths about this topic: (1) Apply kohl on the right eyelid three times, then apply it on the left eyelid three times. (2) Apply kohl on the right eyelid one time then apply it on the left eyelid one time, then apply it on the right eyelid and then on the left eyelid, and then apply it on the right eyelid. This way, the total number is odd and the right eyelid is preferred over the left eyelid with three things: (i) it was the first to start with, (ii) it was the last to end with, (iii) the kohl is applied on it more than the left eyelid.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Three times every night”: He preferred three times because it is an odd number, and it is moderate, neither excessive nor little.

50. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said: “Apply the *ithmid* on the eyelids before sleeping. It clears the eyesight and increases the growth of the eyelashes.” ^[66]

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Apply the *ithmid*”: Those being addressed regarding this issue are those whose eyes are healthy, because if the eye has a problem then *ithmid* may aggravate it.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

Applying the kohl on the eyes maintains their healthiness, improves and clears the eyesight, removes the bad elements and it is an adornment in the case of some types of kohl. It is even more beneficial when the *ithmid* is used before sleeping.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The order in this hadīth is understood to mean that it is recommended, as agreed upon by all scholars.

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

“It clears the eyesight and increases the growth of the eyelashes”: Mentioning the worldly benefits of kohl does not negate the fact that it is an act of Sunnah since he (peace be upon him) practiced it and encouraged it. In fact, these worldly benefits are means towards learning the religious acts, such as how to perform purification, assessing the direction of the *qiblah* and other matters that require the use of the eyes. If a person wants to get the reward of following the Sunnah in this matter, they should establish the intention that it is intended for use as a medicine and not just for adornment. This is why Imām Mālik stated that it is disliked for men to apply kohl unless it is for treatment purposes only.

51. Jābir ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, “The best from among all the kohl used by you is the *ithmid*. It gives strength to the eyesight and increases the growth of the eyelashes.” ^[67]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“The best from among all the kohl used by you is the *ithmid*”: This indicates that there are many materials that can be used for kohl, the best of which is *ithmid*.

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

“The best from among all the kohl used by you is the *ithmid*”: This indicates that *ithmid* is a special type of kohl. It is said that the meaning is that *ithmid* is the best kohl for protecting the eye when it is healthy as kohl is harmful in the case of ophthalmia (inflamed eyes).

52. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās reported: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘You should use *ithmid* because it strengthens the eyesight and facilitates the growth of the eyelashes.’” ^[68]

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

The purpose of repeating this hadīth with different chains is to emphasise its content and to strengthen its classification.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) had a set that included: a mirror that was called “*al-madalla*”, a comb made of ivory, a kohl container, a clipper and a *miswāk*.

53. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar reported: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Apply *ithmid*, for verily it strengthens the eyesight and facilitates the growth of the eyelashes.’” ^[69]

CHAPTER EIGHT

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE CLOTHING OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It should be noted that the general rule is that all types of clothing are lawful except that which is forbidden in religion. Al-Bukhārī documented two hadīths establishing this general rule, the first of which is that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said, “Eat, drink, wear clothes and give charity without showing off and being extravagant.”^[70] The other one is that which Ibn Abbās said, “Eat all that you wish and wear all that you like, so long as you are neither showing off nor being extravagant.”^[71]

The Prophet (peace be upon him) pointed out a number of issues to be avoided in clothing, some of which are:

- *Isbāl*: It is letting the garment come below the ankles and according to some scholars it is considered from the major sins.
- Men wearing clothes made of natural silk.
- Wearing something that makes the person distinguished from others. It is for this reason that one should wear the clothes that are the norm in the society where they live, provided that such clothes are lawful.
- Wearing clothes that are known to be worn only by disbelievers and by which a disbeliever is recognised.

Al-Bajūrī said,

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Clothes are subject to five rulings: (i) Clothing that covers the *'awrah* from being shown in the presence of others is obligatory, (ii) It is preferable to wear one's best clothes on Eid and white clothes on Friday, (iii) It is forbidden for men to wear silk clothes, (iv) It is disliked for the rich to wear old clothes constantly and (v) It is lawful to wear anything else.

54. Umm Salamah said: "In regards to clothing, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) liked wearing the *qamīs* the most." ^[72]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Qamīs refers to the well known long robe with sleeves i.e. the *thoub*.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It was his preference as this kind of garment is more concealing than the *izār* (lower wrap) and *ridā'* (upper garment). Al-Hafidh al-Dumyatī narrated a hadīth stating that the *qamīs* of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was made of cotton, short in length and had short sleeves. This hadīth indicates that he preferred the one made of cotton because the one made of wool harms the body, makes one sweat and it has a smell that harms others.

Alī al-Qārī said,

It was said that the Prophet (peace be upon him) liked wearing the *qamīs* because it is lighter than other types of clothing, it conceals more of the body than other clothes and thus the one who wears it is displaying humility.

55. The same report from Umm Salamah through a different chain of narrators.

56. The same report from Umm Salamah through a different chain of narrators.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The same hadīth from Umm Salamah has been reported three times but the last of them has the chain of narrators that al-Tirmidhī believed to be the most authentic. This is why he mentioned the three different routes for the same text.

57. Asmā bint Yazīd narrated: “The sleeves of the *qamīs* of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) would reach his wrists.” ^[73]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows that his sleeves did not exceed his wrists.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason behind the sleeves not exceeding the wrists is because if they do exceed them, they hinder the movement of the hands, and if they are too short, they expose the arms to heat and coldness. Therefore, the Prophet (peace be upon him) preferred to be moderate in the length of his sleeves, and moderation is indeed the best of all things.

Al-Jizrī said,

This hadīth is evidence that the Sunnah is that the sleeves of the *qamīs* do not exceed the wrists. As for other clothes, they (the scholars) said that the Sunnah is that the sleeves should not exceed the tips of the fingers.

58. Qurrah ibn Iyyas related: “I came with a group from the tribe of Muzainah to give the pledge to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). As I noticed the button of his *qamīs* was open, I inserted my hand into the collar of his *qamīs* and I touched the seal.” ^[74]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

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The general rule is that one should keep the buttons of the collar fastened unless there is a need to unbutton them. That being said, one should not think that unbuttoning the *qamīs* is a Sunnah because this hadīth does not indicate so in any form. This is because the reason why his (peace be upon him) collar was open was not specified and so it could have been for any reason such as attempting to cool down due to excessive heat. In fact, it is most likely that this is not an act of Sunnah. If the Sunnah was to keep the buttons of the collar unbuttoned, there would have been no use for having them.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The *fiqh* of this hadīth is:

- It is lawful to wear the *qamīs*.
- It is lawful to have buttons on it.
- It is lawful to unbutton them.
- It is lawful to have a wide collar that is enough for the hand to be inserted into it.
- The Prophet (peace be upon him) allowed others to enter their hands through his collar and touch his skin to seek *barakah*.
- It indicates the humbleness of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

59. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) came out of his house reclining on Usāmah ibn Zayd. He was wearing a *qitrī* wrap and proceeded to lead the prayer.”

[75]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“He was wearing a *qitrī* wrap”: It was placed on his shoulders.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The *qitrī* wrap is a Yemenī sheet with printed columns, made of cotton and it has some redness in its colour.

60. Abū Sa'īd al-Khudarī narrated: "When the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) would put on a new garment, he would recite the following supplication whilst also identifying the garment (be it a turban, a sheet or a wrap etc.), 'Oh Allāh, all praise is due to You for clothing me with this [garment]. I ask You for the good of it and the good of what it was made for, and I ask Your protection from the evil of it and the evil of what it was made for.'" [76]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This supplication reminds us that it is Allāh who blessed us with a new garment, and that we did not come to possess it due to our own efforts and power. In other words, it is to direct us to remember the grace of Allāh as was stated in the divine hadīth wherein Allāh says, "O My slaves! All of you are naked except those who I clothe them. Ask me to clothe you and I will clothe you." [77]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The purpose of mentioning the name of the garment is to show the praise to Allāh for the particular grace that He has bestowed.

The supplication is recited after saying *bismillah* because saying it is an act of Sunnah before wearing the clothes.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This is to say: "O Allāh you clothed us because of our poverty and need to You and not because You are in need of clothing us; therefore we praise You not because of what You have blessed us with but rather because You deserve it."

61. A similar report was narrated from a different route from Abū Sa'īd al-Khudarī.

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62. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The most beloved garment to the Prophet (peace be upon him), that he would wear, was the *hibarah*.” ^[78]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

A *hibarah* is a kind of cloth made of cotton or linen with patterns to make it more beautiful.

Al-Bajūrī said,

It seems that he liked this type of clothing due to its softness and nice design. Also, the fabric complimented his body as he possessed very soft skin and due to the softness of the fabric, it suited him perfectly.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It has printed patterns on it and although it is disliked to wear a garment with patterns printed on it, the fact that he (peace be upon him) wore it shows that it is permissible to wear them.

63. Abū Juhayfah related: “I saw Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) wearing a red *hulla*. I can see the radiance of his shins as if they are still before me.” Sufyān said, “I think it (his garment) was a *hibarah*.” ^[79]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“I can see the radiance of his shins as if they are still before me”: This indicates that the lower wrap of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was to the half point of his shins.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“I saw Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him)”: This was during the farewell Hajj as stated in the hadīth documented in Sahīh al-Bukhārī.

“I can see the radiance of his shins as if they are still before me”: This indicates that it is permissible for the man to look at another man’s legs as there is no temptation in it. It indicates that it is recommended to shorten the robe or the *izār* to the mid-point of the shin, though it is permissible to keep its length to the ankles.

“Sufyān said, ‘I think it [his garment] was a *hibarah*’: As Sufyān (who is the one narrating this hadīth from the companion) holds the view that completely red garments are forbidden, he made the remark that he believes it was a *hibarah* as this would mean it had a pattern with another colour.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“I can see the radiance of his shins as if they are still before me”: While it is recommended for the man to shorten his garment to reach the mid-point of his shin, and it is permissible to make its length reach the ankle, it is recommended for the woman to wear that which covers her and it is allowed to make it long to the point it is dragged on the floor. However, if what she intends with that is showing off then she will be sinful just like if they (men) drag their garments to show off.

64. Al-Barā ibn ‘Āzib narrated: “I have never seen anybody appear more handsome in red clothing than the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). At that time, his hair reached his shoulders.” ^[80]

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

Scholars differed on the permissibility of wearing fully red clothes; some scholars allowed it in all cases, some scholars forbade it in all cases. Some scholars disliked the wearing of clothes which have red prevailing over the other colours, and some scholars said it is disliked in all cases if it is worn for the purpose of adornment and to be known, but it is allowed to be worn inside the house and while working. Some scholars said it

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is not allowed if it is dyed with red after it was woven, and some scholars said only that which is tanned with safflower is forbidden. Some scholars said only that which is dyed red completely is forbidden, and so any garment with additional colours besides red is permissible.

65. Abū Rimthah Taymī said, “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and he was dressed in two green coloured *burdahs*.” ^[81]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The colour of the garment was not plain green because a *burdah* always has multiple colours in its pattern design.

66. Qaylah bint Makhramah narrated: “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) wearing two well worn wraps that had been dyed with saffron yet there was no trace of saffron left upon them.” ^[82]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The fact that the Prophet (peace be upon him) wore something dyed with saffron does not contradict his order not to wear such garments. This is because his order is related to the case when the colour of saffron is evident and it prevails over other colours.

Alī al-Qārī said,

It is established that the Prophet (peace be upon him) wore nice clothes but he preferred to wear that which manifested his humility and humbleness before his Lord. The *salaf* followed his way in the type of clothes to wear i.e. wearing clothing that manifests humbleness. This is because they saw people showing off with their fancy garments and adornments; therefore they wanted to remind them of the triviality of what they were proud of. However, later on the heedless started wearing very old

clothes as a means to receive worldly pleasures and to make the people like them; thus the Sunnah became to oppose them by wearing nice clothes. It was reported that a man who was wearing old clothes criticized Abū al-Hasan al-Shadhilī for wearing nice garments. To that Abū al-Hasan replied, “The clothes I wear reflect my state praising Allāh, whereas your clothes reflect your state asking people to give you some of their worldly pleasures.” In all cases, one must rectify their intention and avoid showing off whilst not refraining from wearing nice clothes due to stinginess, for indeed the beauty lies in the heart but still the body should reflect the beauty of the heart.

67. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās related: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) said, ‘Wear garments of white colours. Let the living among you wear them and enshroud the dead therewith, for it is the best of your clothes.’” ^[83]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This is to encourage wearing white clothes as it is recommended to wear them when attending the Friday prayer, attending the masjid, events and sittings that the angels witness such as gatherings to recite the Qur’ān or to remember Allāh. As for Eid, it is recommended to wear the best and pricey clothes, even if the colour is not white, because the day is intended to manifest adornment and display Allāh’s grace upon us.

The best colours are in the following order: The white, the green and then the yellow colours.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is the preferred colour for the shroud because the dead is about to meet the angels. This is why it is recommended, it is also why we are directed to perfume the dead.

Alī al-Qārī said,

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In order for the garment to deserve being called the best of clothes in its absolute form, it has to be (besides being white in colour) pure, neat and not accompanied by pride, showing off etc.

68. Samurah ibn Jundub narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Wear white clothing for it is the purest and most beautiful of your clothing, and also enshroud your dead with it.’” ^[84]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“It is the purest”: It is described as such because dirt or impurity can easily be identified [when wearing a white garment] unlike other colours that may have unseen dirt or impurity. This is why the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to supplicate, “O Allāh, purify me from my sins just like how a white garment is purified from dirt.”

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

“Most beautiful”: It is described as such because white clothing indicates the humility of the one wearing it and negates the qualities of pride and showing off.

69. Aisha narrated: “One day, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) left the house early in the morning, wearing a long black garment made of hair.” ^[85]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The way of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was that he did not prefer wearing a particular type of clothing nor did he have an interest in wearing fancy and expensive clothing. This is because showing off with fancy clothes is from the qualities of women. However, the quality that is praised in men is to ensure that their clothes are clean, modest and decent; therefore he (peace

be upon him) preferred wearing the type of clothing that he needed and encouraged others to wear the other types.

70. Al-Mughīrah ibn Shu'bah narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) wore a Romanic *jubbah* which had tight sleeves." ^[86]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The *jubbah* is an outer garment that is worn over the *qamīs* (*thawb*).

The hadīths that the author included in this chapter show the variety of clothes that the Prophet (peace be upon him) wore, which indicates that clothing is not a restricted avenue, but rather all garments are lawful except that which is forbidden by evidence.

Al-Bajūrī said,

He wore it whilst travelling and it is reported that this was in the battle of Tabūk.

The fact that the garment was made by the Romans shows that the general rule is that all clothes are pure, even those made by disbelievers.

"Tight sleeves": This means that when he wanted to pull his arms out of the sleeves it was difficult. Some scholars said it is recommended to wear narrow sleeved garments whilst travelling only. The sleeves of the companions were wide.

The beautification of appearance in terms of clothing is praised if it is done to help one in the worship of Allāh such as how the Prophet (peace be upon him) took care of his appearance and clothes when welcoming the delegates and it is dispraised when it is done for worldly benefits or to show off.

CHAPTER NINE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE LIVING CONDITIONS OF THE PROPHET

Alī al-Qārī said,

There is another chapter towards the end of this book that talks about the food and drink of the Prophet (peace be upon him). However, it seems that this short chapter is intended to highlight the poverty faced by the Prophet and some of his companions while the other long chapter highlights the poverty faced by the Prophet and his family. The other possible explanation is that this short chapter is dedicated to detailing the hardship he experienced at the beginning [of his prophethood] and the long chapter highlights that which he experienced at the end of his life.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It appears as if this chapter is repeated at the end of the book but this chapter is intended to indicate the poverty of the Prophet (peace be upon him) while the other one is to indicate the type of food and drink he used to consume.

71. Muhammad ibn Sirīn narrated: “We were with Abū Hurayrah while he was wearing two linen garments dyed with red clay. He cleaned his nose with his garment upon which he said, ‘Well done! Well done! Abū Hurairah is cleaning his nose with linen! There came a time when I would fall unconscious between the pulpit of Allāh’s Messenger and Aisha’s dwelling whereupon a passer-by would come and put his foot on my

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neck, thinking I suffer from epilepsy, while in fact, I suffered nothing but hunger.” ^[87]

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Well done! Well done!”: This is often said to express one’s pleasure and joy but it could be used in the context of condemnation in the case of this hadīth.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“Abū Hurairah is cleaning his nose with linen”: This is an expression of the change he experienced in terms of wealth as he was very poor and then later, he was cleaning his nose with a linen garment.

Alī al-Qārī said,

“A passer-by would come and put his foot on my neck”: The habit of people when seeing a person suffering an epileptic seizure was to keep their feet on the neck to hold the person still until the seizure ended.

This hadīth was included in this chapter as it indicates the poverty of the Prophet (peace be upon him) at that time. This is because if he had any food he would have shared it with his companions, particularly due to the fact that he used to look after them and treated them as his guests.

72. Mālik ibn Dinār narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never reached the state of being satisfactorily full, neither from bread nor meat, except when he used to eat with people.” ^[88]

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Except when he used to eat with people”: This refers to filling two thirds of his stomach, as in feasts he would stay to show courtesy to the people and to show them that he loves the food. With that said, it is an obvious error on the part of those who

claimed that he (peace be upon him) used to reach the state of satiety [or overeat] in feasts. This is because it does not befit his noble status and it would be insulting even if it was said regarding one of us!

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Imām Ahmad said, “Four qualities in food will make it perfect: if the name of Allāh is mentioned on it in the beginning, Allāh is praised for it at the end, many hands are eating from it, and it is lawful.”

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Neither from bread nor meat”: This indicates that he (peace be upon him) never ate bread and meat together except with people. The state of fullness referred to here is interpreted to mean that he would eat until two thirds of his stomach were full or that he would not be full from meat and bread together, or from either of them.

CHAPTER TEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE KHUFF OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Khuff is a well known type of socks. It is made of leather and it covers the entire foot.

73. Buraydah narrated: “Al-Najāshī sent two plain black coloured *khuffs* as a gift to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). As soon as he received them, he tried them on, performed ablution and then wiped over them.” ^[89]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“Al-Najāshī” was the title given to the kings of Ethiopia and the name of this particular king was As-Hamah; he embraced Islām and died upon it. When he died, the Prophet (peace be upon him) prayed the absentee funeral prayer on him.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“As soon as he received them, he tried them on”: This indicates that when a person receives a gift from someone, using it immediately shows one’s acceptance of the gift and it also indicates the continuous signals of love between the one receiving the gift and the sender of gift. This hadīth also indicates that one should accept gifts even if they come from the people of the book because at that time al-Najāshī was still a disbeliever, as stated by Abū Bakr ibn al-Arabī.

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Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“Performed ablution and then wiped over them”: This indicates that when an object’s purity cannot be ascertained, it is deemed to be pure. It also indicates the permissibility of wiping over the *khuff*.

74. Al-Mughīrah ibn Shu’bah narrated: “Dhihiyyah gifted the Prophet (peace be upon him) with a pair of *khuffs* that he wore right away and he kept wearing them until they became torn. The Prophet (peace be upon him) did not know whether the skin of the *khuffs* was from an animal that was slaughtered properly or not.”

From another route, it adds, “He was also gifted a robe that he wore until it became torn.” ^[90]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

“That he wore right away”: This teaches us to hasten in accepting the gift and to use it right away so as to make the one who gave the gift happy and pleased.

Alī al-Qārī said,

“The Prophet (peace be upon him) did not know whether the skin of the *khuffs* was from an animal that was slaughtered properly or not”: [The companion reported this] because either he (peace be upon him) stated it, or the companion determined this because the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not inquire about it.

Al-Bajūrī said,

“Until they became torn”: This indicates that the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to keep wearing the clothes he had until they became worn out, as this is from humility.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE NA'L (SANDALS) OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to describing the shoes of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and his guidance in this regard. However, it is noteworthy to mention that it is permissible to wear anything we want, so long as what we wear is not forbidden in the religion. This is because the shoes that people wear in each era and in each culture are different. The general rule regarding clothes is that everything is permissible until there is evidence to prove it is forbidden.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Na'l refers to footwear that keeps the feet away from the floor and when the term is used it does not normally include the *khuff*.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) had three different types of footwear, as Ibn Sa'd narrated in his work *Tabaqat al-Kubra*:

- Footwear that was narrow in the middle.
- Footwear with a leather piece in the back to support the ankle.
- Footwear with a long front part, that took the shape of a tongue. It was designed this way to fit his second toe, which was the tallest of his toes.

He (peace be upon him) used to walk barefoot sometimes out of humility, especially when he would go to visit an ill person.

75. Qatādah narrated: “I asked Anas ibn Mālik to describe the sandals of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him). He replied, ‘Each sandal had two *qibālān*.’” ^[91]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Qibālān are two ribbons fastened to the sole of the sandal. The joining point of the ribbons separates the middle toe from the next toe (i.e. the fourth toe).

76. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Abbās related: “The sandal of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had two ribbons and two upper straps.” ^[92]

Abdul Muhsin al-Abbad said,

The ribbon refers to that which separates the toes, whereas the upper straps are that which secure the sandal to the upper part of the feet.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This means that each sandal had two ribbons and two straps were connected with each ribbon.

77. Īsa ibn Tahmān narrated: “Anas ibn Mālik showed us a pair of sandals that had two straps and were hairless. Later on, Thābit told me that these were the sandals of the Prophet (peace be upon him).” ^[93]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This indicates that Anas kept the sandals of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in his house.

78. Ubayd ibn Jurayj asked Ibn ‘Umar: “Why do you [prefer] wearing the *sibtī* type of sandals?” He replied, “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) wearing sandals that

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did not have hair on them, performing ablution while he had them on. This is why I like wearing them.” ^[94]

Al-Bajūrī and Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Sibti sandals refer to the sandals made of tanned cow leather and they are called *sibti* because the hair falls off when the leather is dyed.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The answer of Ibn ‘Umar was to show that he prefers wearing this type of sandal to follow the guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and not because of personal preference.

79. Abū Hurairah related: “The sandals of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) had two upper straps.” ^[95]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Alī ibn Abī Tālib and Ibn Abbās encouraged wearing yellow sandals. It is because yellow is from the colours that indicate happiness.

80. ‘Amr ibn Huraith narrated: “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) praying while wearing a pair of sandals that had new soles sewn onto them.” ^[96]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to sew the leather sole into his sandals by himself as reported in the hadīth that Imām Ahmad documented in his Musnad^[97].

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) had sandals that had one sole and sandals that had more than one sole.

81. Abū Hurairah narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said: “One should not wear one shoe and walk. Either wear them both or remove them both.” ^[98]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Al-Khattabī said that [it is disliked] because it would be difficult to walk whilst wearing one shoe, not to mention that it does not look good. Others said, it is [disliked] because it would make the person unjust between their own limbs, or because it would make people question their intellect and sensibility. Abū Bakr ibn al-Arabī said, “It is disliked because it makes the person walk the walk of the Shaytan. And it is said that it is disliked because it is immodest.” Al-Bayhaqī said, “It is disliked because it makes the person known and famous and we are ordered not to attract the attention of others through our clothing or anything that may make us gain notoriety.”

Some scholars applied the same ruling on sleeves i.e. it is disliked to wear a shirt whilst having one arm in a sleeve and the other one bare.

82. Abū Zinād reports the same.

83. Jābir ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) prohibited people from eating with the left hand and from wearing one sandal only.” ^[99]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The prohibition of eating with the left hand applies to drinking as well.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The ruling on eating with the left hand without a necessity is that it is disliked according to the Shāfi‘ī scholars and it is forbidden according to many Hanbalī and Mālikī scholars.

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84. Abū Hurairah narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said: “Whenever one amongst you puts on their sandals, he should begin with the right, and when one of you removes them, the left one should be removed first. Let the right side be the first when putting them on and the last when removing them.” ^[100]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows the virtue of the right over the left in wearing shoes. It was the guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to start with the right in all that which is honoured and considered a matter of adornment and beauty such as wearing the shoes, clothes, combing the hair etc. Whereas the left side is used to commence anything contrary to that such as removing the shoes, entering the toilet, and leaving the masjid etc.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The right side is honoured and therefore it comes first in every matter that is intended to be perfect and good, whilst the left side is used in matters that imperfect the status. The right side is honoured because it is what Allāh prefers and likes in everything i.e. the dwellers of Paradise stand on the right side of the Throne on the Day of Judgement and receive their books with their right hands, the angel recording the good deeds is on the right side, the scale of good deeds are placed on the right side etc.

85. Aisha narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) liked to begin with the right side as much as possible; he began with his right side when he combed his hair, wore his shoes and washed his limbs when performing ablution.” ^[101]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This emphasises the meaning of the previous hadīth.

86. Abū Hurairah narrated: “The sandals of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had two upper straps, and so did the sandals of Abū Bakr and Umar. However, ‘Uthmān ibn ‘Affan was the first one to use one strap.” ^[102]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This action of ‘Uthmān ibn Affan shows that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had two straps due to his personal preference and not with the intention to draw closer to Allāh. This is because if it was done for this reason, ‘Uthmān would not have left it.

Al-Bajūrī said,

‘Uthmān using one strap shows that the two straps were used because that was the custom and not because using one strap is disliked. This illustrates that it is permissible to wear any type of shoes, because wearing sandals at that time was just the custom of people.

Alī al-Qārī said,

If ‘Uthmān did not use the one strap it would have been assumed that using one strap is disliked. Thus, it shows that not wearing sandals and instead wearing anything else is permissible and not disliked.

CHAPTER TWELVE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE RING (SEAL) OF THE PROPHET

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used the seal in the latter part of the sixth year of Hijrah when he started writing letters to the kings and leaders in which he called them to the religion of Allāh. This is because when he wanted to write to the Romans, he was advised that they do not read letters without seals on them. For that reason, he made a seal.

87. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The ring (i.e. seal) of Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) was made of silver and its gem stone was Abyssinian.” ^[103]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This indicates that it is permissible for men to wear silver rings.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) had two seals that the reader of this book needs to distinguish; the seal of prophethood, which is the area of raised skin between his shoulders and the seal of the Prophet, which is the seal he used to stamp his letters.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is permissible for men to wear rings; but it is disliked to wear more than two rings as stated by al-Daramī, but the latter view is disputed over.

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The gem stone was described as Abyssinian because it was agate, and it was said that its colour was black, or that the one who made it was an Abyssinian.

The preference of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to wear rings made of silver made some of the renowned Shāfi'ī scholars deduce that it is disliked to wear rings made of iron or copper and they relied on many hadīths, one of which is the hadīth wherein the Prophet (peace be upon him) saw a man wearing a ring made of iron and said to him, "Why do you wear the jewellery of the people of Hell?" So the man removed it and then he came wearing a ring made of copper so he said to him, "Why do I smell the scent of idols coming from you?!" Upon which the man removed it.^[104]

Al-Bayhaqī said, after narrating the hadīths that talk about the gem stone of the Prophet (peace be upon him) wherein some hadīths show that it was made of agate and others show that it was made of silver just like the ring, "These hadīths indicate that he had two rings, one of which the gem stone was agate and another of which the gem stone was silver."

88. 'Abdullāh ibn 'Umar narrated: "Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) possessed a ring made of silver. He used it to stamp [his letters etc.], and did not wear it."^[105]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The last part of this hadīth opposes the many hadīths that state the Prophet (peace be upon him) wore the seal. However, some scholars reconciled this hadīth with the other hadīths by saying that the ring referred to in this hadīth was not made of silver only but rather had other materials that are not permissible to wear such as iron. Imām Ahmad reported that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had a ring made of iron that had some silver on it that he threw away afterwards. Al-Hafith ibn Rajab commented on this hadīth by saying, "Perhaps, this was the ring that he used for stamping and sealing the letters but he never

wore it.” In any case, if this addition (the last part of the hadīth) is proven to be authentic, then it is understood to refer to a particular case. Some other scholars considered the addition odd and rejected it.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The last part of this hadīth opposes the other hadīths which indicate that the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to wear the ring on his right hand. However, this contradiction can be reconciled because [it appears] that he had two rings; one that had a gemstone with engraved words to stamp his letters, and this ring he did not wear, and another ring that he wore so that people follow his example. It is also possible that he did not wear it all the time or that he did not wear it at the beginning, and then wore it later to show the people that it is not intended for adornment.

89. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) had a ring made of silver and its stone was also of silver.”

[106]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The ring that had a gem stone made of silver was the ring that the Prophet (peace be upon him) ordered to be made for him. Al-Daraqutnī reported that Ya’la ibn Umayyah said, “I myself made for the Prophet (peace be upon him) a ring that no one else helped me with. I engraved on it, ‘Muhammad is the Messenger of Allāh.’”

Al-Bajūrī said,

The meaning of the last part of the hadīth is that the gemstone was part of the ring and not something external added to it.

90. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “When the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) intended to write letters to the leaders of the non-Arabs [to invite them to Islām], he was advised that

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they do not accept letters without a seal (stamp) on them. For that reason, he had a ring made for himself. It is as if the brightness of [the ring] which was on his hand is still before my eyes.” ^[107]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth shows the reason behind the Prophet (peace be upon him) wanting to have a ring (i.e. seal).

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This incident took place after he (peace be upon him) returned from Hudaybiyyah. It is said that the person who advised the Prophet about the seal was a non-Arab or a person from the Quraysh.

The reason they did not accept unstamped letters was because it made them doubt the content or because the stamp indicated that the sender respected them, or that the stamp indicated that access to the contents of the letter was limited to certain people.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth indicates the permissibility of communication through letters. The first person reported to send a letter was Prophet Sulaymān when he sent the hoopoe to deliver his letter to Balqīs, the queen of Saba'. The act of the Prophet (peace be upon him) teaches us to do what people like and leave that which they dislike.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The part regarding the brightness of the ring indicates that it was made of silver, and it was said that it refers to the perfection of the ring.

91. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The inscription engraved on the ring of Allāh’s Messenger was ‘Muhammad’ on one line, ‘Messenger’ on the next, and ‘Allāh’ on the last.” ^[108]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows that the inscription engraved on the ring consisted of three words, each written on a separate line.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The word “Muhammad” was written on the first line at the top and the other words were written below. This is supported by another narration reported by al-Isma‘īlī that explicitly stated the order of the lines, and it is also the apparent meaning of the narration reported by al-Bukhārī.

92. Anas ibn Mālīk related: “Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) [intended to] write letters to Kisra [of the Persians], Caesar (of the Romans) and al-Najāshī (of the Abyssinians). The Prophet (peace be upon him) was advised that they do not accept letters without a stamp. For this reason, he (peace be upon him) had a ring made of silver, and had ‘Muhammad is the Messenger of Allāh’ engraved upon it.” ^[109]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Kisra was the title given to the kings of Persia. Caesar was the title given to the kings of the Romans. Al-Najāshī was the title given to the kings of Abyssinia. Pharaoh was the title given to the kings of the region of Copt in Egypt. Al-‘Azīz was the title given to the kings of Egypt. Tubba’ was the title given to the kings of the tribe of Himyar. Khaqan was the title given to the kings of the Turks.

93. Anas ibn Mālīk related: “Whenever the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) entered the place where he relieved himself, he would remove his ring.” ^[110]

Alī al-Qārī said,

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He (peace be upon him) used to remove his ring before entering the place where he relieved himself because the ring had the name of Allāh engraved on it.

Before gold was made forbidden for men to wear, the Prophet (peace be upon him) had a ring made of gold and so the people began to wear golden rings in imitation of him. When he became aware of this, he removed it and said that he would not wear a golden ring again and so the people followed suit. Then he wore a ring made of silver as an adornment, so people followed him in that. However, he saw that this may lead to arrogance and pride so he removed it and so did the people. Later on, he needed to wear a ring for the purpose of stamping letters so he wore it but he said to the people, "I have made myself a ring and engraved on it some words; so do not engrave on your rings [the same words I have used]."

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is disliked to keep the Name of Allāh in ones possession whilst being in the place where people relieve themselves, and it was said that this is forbidden. The same ruling applies to anything that is glorified in religion such as the Qur'ān, the name of a prophet or an angel. As for names that people use that are also the names of prophets [or angels etc.] such as Muhammad, then the ruling is based on the intention of the person. If the intention is that it is a normal person's name then it is permissible but if it is intended to refer to one who is glorified in the religion, then it is disliked.

94. 'Abdullāh ibn 'Umar narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had a ring made of silver that he wore on his hand. Then, [after the death of the Prophet], Abū Bakr wore it on his hand, and then [after the death of Abū Bakr] 'Umar ibn al-Khattab kept it and wore it on his hand. Then [after the death of 'Umar], 'Uthmān ibn 'Affan kept it and wore it until it

fell into the well of Arīs. The inscription on the ring was ‘Muhammad is the Messenger of Allāh.’” ^[111]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The well of Arīs is a well in a garden located near the Masjid al-Qubā'. The ring fell when 'Uthmān was moving the ring on his finger while standing at the edge of the well. He spent three days, along with his companions, searching for it but they could not find it. Thus, the claim that the ring was found is a baseless claim and to prove something is from the belongings of the Prophet (peace be upon him) requires authentic evidence.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth shows that it is permissible to use a seal that has the name of someone else engraved on it after their death.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The seal of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was not from his heritance because it was treated like his weapons that were allocated as a charity for the Muslims that the ruler would utilise in the way that serves their best interest. This is why Abū Bakr, Umar and Uthmān used it as it was from the tools that the Caliphate needed.

None of our fellow Shāfi'ī scholars discussed the weight of the ring, but some later scholars such as al-Adhra'ī stated that it is forbidden for it to exceed one *mithqal* (a unit of mass equal to 4.25 grams) whilst other scholars said it is permissible such as al-Hafidh al-'Iraqī who said that it is [not forbidden but rather] disliked for the ring to weigh one *mithqal*. However, the appropriate, permissible weight depends on the norms of the people in their culture as the *mithqal* was the norm of the people at that time.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

THE REPORTS STATING THAT THE PROPHET WORE THE RING ON HIS RIGHT HAND

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The title used for this chapter is intended to show that it is the Sunnah to wear the ring on the right hand. This is the view adopted by the author as he considered the hadīth wherein it states that he (peace be upon him) wore the ring on the left hand to be weak. However, Ibn al-Qayyim said, “There are hadīths indicating that he wore his ring on the right hand and other hadīths stating that he wore it on the left hand, and the chains of all these hadīths are authentic.”

Al-Nawawī said, “The scholars are in agreement that it is permissible to wear the ring on the right hand or the left hand as neither is disliked. However, they differed on what is better. Many of the *salaf* used to wear the ring on the right hand and many of them used to wear the ring on the left hand. Imām Mālik preferred wearing the ring on the left hand and he disliked wearing it on the right hand. In our madhab (Shāfi’ī) there are two views, but the most correct is that wearing the ring on the right hand is better because it is a form of adornment and the right hand is more deserving of being honoured and beautified.”

95. Alī ibn Abī Tālib narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) wore his ring on the right hand.” ^[112]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The author (al-Tirmidhī) quoted al-Bukhārī who said, “The hadīths stating that he (peace be upon him) wore the ring on his left hand are the most authentic hadīths.”

The hadīths can be reconciled i.e. he had two rings, one he wore on his left hand and [on other occasions] he wore his other ring on his right hand, which goes in line with the hadīths that stated he had a ring with a gemstone made of silver and another from Abyssinia.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Imām Ahmad disliked wearing a ring on the index finger or the middle finger.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said, “If the ring is worn as an adornment then wearing it on the right hand is better but if it is worn to use for stamping letters, then wearing it on the left hand is better.”

96. Sharīk ibn ‘Abdullāh ibn Abū Namir reports the same.

97. Hammād ibn Salamah narrated that he saw Abdur Rahmān ibn Abī Rāfi' wearing a ring on his right hand. He inquired regarding the reason behind this and he replied: “I had seen ‘Abdullāh ibn Ja’far wearing a ring on his right hand, and he said that he had seen the Prophet (peace be upon him) wear a ring on his right hand.” ^[113]

98. ‘Abdullāh ibn Ja’far narrates: “The Messenger of Allāh wore a ring on his right hand.” ^[114]

99. Jābir ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) wore the ring on the right hand.” ^[115]

Al-Bajūrī said,

These hadīths did not show what finger he (peace be upon him) used to wear the ring on but the hadīths in the two Sahīh books

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show that he wore his ring on the pinkie. With that said, the Sunnah is to wear the ring on the pinkie only. The wisdom behind this is that the pinkie is far from the actions of the hand and [due to it being the farthest finger from the thumb] it does not hinder the work of the hand unlike if it was worn on the index finger.

100. Salt ibn 'Abdullāh narrated: "Ibn Abbās wore a ring on the right hand, and as far as I can recall he used to say that the Prophet (peace be upon him) wore it on the right hand." ^[116]

101. 'Abdullāh ibn 'Umar related: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) had a ring made of silver which had its gemstone facing his palm. He [ordered] the words, 'Muhammad is the Messenger of Allāh' to be engraved on it and prohibited people from putting the same inscription on their rings. This is the same ring that fell from the hands of Mu'ayyib into the well of Arīs." ^[117]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) positioned its gemstone facing towards his palm so that it would not show, which indicates that the ring was for the purpose of stamping letters and not for adornment.

This hadīth can be reconciled with the other hadīth where it stated that the ring fell from the hand of 'Uthmān: It is possible that 'Uthmān gave Mu'ayyib the ring to use and then when he wanted to give it back to 'Uthmān, it fell from his hand. This is why both were referred to as the one from whom the ring fell down.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Al-Nawawī said that the reason for keeping the gemstone of the ring towards the palm was because that would protect the

inscription and because keeping it away from the eye would prevent showing off and pride.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) prohibited people from making this inscription on their rings to avert confusion and corruption. However, al-Zain al-'Iraqī stated that this prohibition was only applicable during his life.

102. Muhammad al-Baqir related: “Al-Hasan and al-Hussain wore their rings on their left hands.” ^[118]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

They wore their rings on the left hand to follow the example of the Prophet (peace be upon him) who wore it on the left hand often. The reason the author included this hadīth though it opposes the title of the chapter is because he wanted to explain that such hadīths do not negate that wearing it on the right hand is better.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows that it is permissible to wear it on the left hand or the right hand.

103. Anas ibn Mālīk related: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) wore a ring on his right hand.” ^[119]

104. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar related: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) possessed a ring made of gold which he wore on his right hand. To follow the example of the Prophet (peace be upon him), the companions also had gold rings made for themselves. Upon seeing this, the Prophet (peace be upon him) removed the gold ring and said, ‘I will never wear it again.’ Accordingly, the people removed their gold rings too.” ^[120]

Alī al-Qārī said,

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This hadīth refers to the period where gold was not yet made prohibited for men. The Prophet (peace be upon him) removed the ring after it was revealed to him that gold was not allowed for men.

Al-Nawawī said,

The scholars are in agreement that the Sunnah for men is to wear the ring on their pinkie fingers whilst women can wear the ring on the finger of their choosing.

Al-Bajūrī said,

He (peace be upon him) removed it because he saw that people showed off with their gold rings and it coincided that the revelation came down to make gold forbidden for men.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE DESCRIPTION OF THE SWORD OF ALLĀH'S MESSENGER

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter and some subsequent chapters are dedicated to describing the weapons of the Prophet (peace be upon him) that he used in battles and wars. There is a benefit that can be derived from the ordering of the chapters in that the author placed the chapter of the sword after the chapter of the ring. This ordering was deliberate and was to indicate that calling to Allāh using words comes before fighting with the sword. This is because the ring was used to stamp letters that were sent to disbelievers inviting them to Islām and so al-Tirmidhī placed it before the sword to show that preaching and advising people takes priority over calling them to Islām with the sword.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) had many swords; the first sword he ever had was called “al-Ma’thūr” which he inherited from his father. The other swords he had were called: al-Qadīb, al-Qula’i, al-Battār, al-Hatif, al-Mikhdham, al-Rasūb, al-Samsām, al-Lahīf and Dhul-Fiqār.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason why the author started with the sword as the first weapon is because it was the most frequently used and most effective during battles.

105. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The handle of the sword of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was made of silver.” ^[121]

Alī al-Qārī said,

This hadīth proves that it is permissible to adorn the sword and any other weapon with silver. As for adorning them with gold, this is forbidden.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The sword referred to in this hadīth is the sword Dhul-Fiqār, which is the sword that the Prophet (peace be upon him) always carried and had when he conquered Makkah.

106. Sa'īd ibn Abil Hasan related: “The handle of the sword of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was made of silver.” ^[122]

107. The grandfather of Hūd ibn ‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’d narrated: “When the Prophet (peace be upon him) entered Makkah on the day it was conquered, his sword was adorned with gold and silver. Tālib (who is one of the narrators of this hadīth) asked Hūd, ‘On which part of the sword was the silver?’ He replied, ‘The handle was made of silver.’” ^[123]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth is weak insofar as al-Qattan ruled it as a *munkar* hadīth. Hence, it cannot be used as evidence to allow adorning the weapons with gold.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This *hadīth* does not contradict the ruling of prohibition regarding adorning weapons with gold because it is weak. It is incorrect to claim that the incident mentioned in this hadīth was before gold was made forbidden because this ruling occurred before the conquest of Makkah, as has been reported.

108. Ibn Sirīn narrated: "I based [the design of] my sword upon the sword of Samurah ibn Jundub because he said that he had his sword made like the sword of the Prophet (peace be upon him). The sword was the type used by the tribe of Banī Hanīfah." ^[124]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The last part could be from the words of Ibn Sirīn or Samurah and the sword was described as such because the tribe of Banī Hanīfah was known for making exceptional swords or because the one who made the sword was from the tribe of Banī Hanīfah.

109. 'Uthmān ibn Sa'd reports the same.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE DESCRIPTION OF THE ARMOUR OF THE MESSENGER

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) had seven suits of armour, the names of which are: Dhat al-Fudūl, which is the armour that he pawned for a year with a Jewish man for thirty *sā'* (a cubic measure) of barley and it was made of iron, Dhat al-Wishāh, Dhat al-Hawāshi, al-Su'diyyah, Fiddah, al-Batrā' and al-Khirnaq.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This chapter is dedicated to describing the way the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to wear his armour, rather than describing the suits of armour.

110. Al-Zubair ibn Al-'Awwām related: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) wore two suits of armour during the Battle of Uhud. He tried to climb a rock but he could not do so. Thus, he requested Talhah to sit and, with his aid, climbed the rock until he rose on it." Al-Zubair said, "I heard the Prophet (peace be upon him) then say, "Talhah has necessitated Paradise for himself." [125]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The two suits of armour that he (peace be upon him) wore on that day were Dhat al-Fudūl and Fiddah. The scholars concluded that the reality of reliance on Allāh lies in the heart and that a person is required to take the means [of protecting oneself]

whilst the heart is fully dependent on the Causer and not the causes.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) wanted to climb the rock so that his army could see that he was still alive and gather around him^[126].

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

He (peace be upon him) could not climb the rock because of the two suits of armour weighing him down. This (their thickness and weight) indicates how well made they were as it serves the ultimate purpose of wearing a suit of armour i.e. protection. This part [of the hadīth] provides a description of the suit of armour. However, some said that he could not climb the rock because of the wound he received on his noble head which resulted in losing a lot of blood.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Talhah deserved Paradise because he sacrificed his life for the sake of the Prophet (peace be upon him) as he kept protecting his body from arrows with his hand until his hand became paralysed and the rest of his body was wounded.

111. Al-Sāib ibn Yazīd narrated: “In the Battle of Uhud the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) wore two suits of armour. He wore them one over the other.”^[127]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Al-Sāib ibn Yazīd was the last companion who died in al-Madīnah; he died on 91 H.

Al-Bajūrī said,

His wearing of two suits of armour indicates that reliance on Allāh should be accompanied by taking the means of protection.

CHAPTER SIXTEEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE DESCRIPTION OF THE MAIL COIF OF ALLĀH'S MESSENGER

Al-Bajūrī said,

The mail coif is a flexible type of armour made of interlinked metal rings that is made to fit the size of the head and worn underneath the turban. It is considered to be from his weapons because a weapon refers to that which is used to fight and that which is used for protection.

112. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) was wearing a mail coif when he entered Makkah. Someone came to him and said, ‘O Messenger of Allāh, Ibn Khatal is holding the cover (black cloth) of the Ka’bah.’ The Prophet (peace be upon him) replied, ‘Kill him.’” ^[128]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Ibn Khatal was one of those who the Prophet (peace be upon him) ordered to kill wherever and whenever he was found. This was because he embraced Islām and had a Muslim servant but afterwards apostated, killed the servant and started to defame the Prophet with foul language in his poetry and employed two female singers to sing his foul poetry against the Prophet and his companions.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Ibn Khatal was holding the cover of the Ka'bah because it was the habit of the Arabs before Islām to give refuge to anyone who did this, regardless of their crimes.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is reported in Sahīh Muslim that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said, "It is unlawful for anyone to carry a weapon in Makkah."^[129] This appears contradictory to the incident narrated in this hadīth. However, there is no contradiction because it is proven authentic that Allāh made it lawful for the Prophet (peace be upon him) to fight for one hour of a day in Makkah^[130]

Alī al-Qārī said,

There are four persons that the Prophet (peace be upon him) ordered to be killed whenever and wherever they were found: al-Huwairith ibn Nuqayd, Hilal ibn Khatal, Maqīs ibn Subabah and 'Abdullāh ibn Abī Sarh. The companion who killed Ibn Khatal is reported to be Sa'īd ibn Huraith but it was reported in a more authentic hadīth that the one who killed him was Abū Barzah al-Aslamī.

113. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) wore a mail coif on his head when he entered Makkah as a conqueror. After he removed it, a person came and said, 'O Messenger of Allāh, Ibn Khatal is clinging to the cover of the Ka'bah.' The Prophet (peace be upon him) replied, 'Kill him.'"

Ibn Shihāb (the one narrating from Anas) said, "I have been informed that the Prophet (peace be upon him) was not in the state of *ihrām* on that day."^[131]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The statement of Ibn Shihāb al-Zuhrī indicates that if a person is entering Makkah without intending to enter the state of *ihrām*, then he is not required to wear the clothes of *ihrām* as this is only required for the one who wants to perform 'Umrah or Hajj.

CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE HEADDRESS OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) had a turban called “al-Sahāb” that he used to wear underneath a head cap.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The size of the turban of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was neither too large so as to make it a burden on the head nor too small so that it could not protect the head from heat and cold. Rather, it was moderate in size and indeed the best of things are those that are moderate and balanced.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The headdress refers to the clothing of the head and it includes the turban, the head cap, and the mail coif etc. However, in this chapter it excludes the mail coif as it has been addressed in the previous one.

114. Jābir ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “When Makkah was conquered, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) entered the city wearing a black turban.” ^[132]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It was mentioned in the preceding chapter that he (peace be upon him) was wearing a mail coif on his head whereas this hadīth mentions that he was wearing a black turban. There is no

contradiction between the two hadīths as it is possible that he wore the mail coif underneath the turban or that he removed the mail coif and then wore the black turban to deliver his speech.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason why he preferred the black turban over the white colour (though the latter is a praised colour) on that day was because the black colour indicates that Islām has prevailed and that Islām does not change, similar to how the colour black does not change to another colour.

115. Amr ibn Huraith narrated: “I once saw a black turban upon the head of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).”

[133]

116. Amr ibn Huraith narrated: “I had seen the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) address the people from the pulpit whilst wearing a black turban.” [134]

Alī al-Qārī said,

This hadīth proves that he (peace be upon him) wore a black turban more than once because there was no pulpit when he gave his speech in Makkah as he gave it while standing in front of the gate of the Ka’bah. The author of al-Masabīh included this hadīth under the chapter of “Friday Khutbah”.

Al-Nawawī said,

It is permissible to wear black clothing when delivering the Khutbah on Friday but wearing white clothing is better.

117. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar reported: “Whenever Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) wrapped his turban around his head, he made its loose end in the form of a tail that he hung down between his shoulders.”

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Nafi says, "I saw 'Abdullāh ibn Umar do it in the same manner."

Ubaidullah, the student of Nafi, said, "In my time, al-Qasim ibn Muhammad and Salim did the same." ^[135]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

He (peace be upon him) used to keep the loose end of the turban hanging down between his shoulders, behind his back.

Al-Bajūrī said,

It can be concluded from this hadīth that wrapping the turban while leaving its loose end hanging down is recommended, and to have it hang down on the back between the shoulders is the best. However, if the tail was left to hang down on the front as Sufis and some people of knowledge do, it is debatable whether it is better to keep it hanging down from the left side or the right side. This is because there is a weak hadīth specifying that it should hang to the right side and the Sufis preferred the left side because it is the side where the heart is located (leaving it to hang on the left side is to remind them to keep the heart empty of everything but Allāh).

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

He (peace be upon him) made the tail of the turban of Abdul Rahman ibn 'Awf to fall in front of him.

Abū 'Abdullāh ibn al-Hāj said,

It is a surprise that some late scholars considered leaving the tail hanging down to the front an innovation while there are explicit authentic hadīths citing that the early *salaf* did this.

118. 'Abdullāh ibn Abbās reported: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) was once delivering a sermon whilst wearing an oily headdress." ^[136]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

There are no authentic hadīths from the Prophet (peace be upon him) regarding the virtues of wearing a turban. The only authentic hadīths mention him wearing turbans. Thus, a person should not oblige people to wear a particular dress. This is because a person should wear the normal clothes that are known in their society so long as the clothes are not unlawful to wear. A person should not wear that which makes him stand out because the Prophet (peace be upon him) forbade people from wearing what would make an individual known or famous amongst people.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This sermon was delivered whilst he was afflicted with the sickness of which he died.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Al-Haytamī in his commentary concerning the reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) preferred to keep the tail of his turban hanging down behind his back, between his shoulders condemned and defamed Ibn al-Qayyim and Ibn Taymiyyah and accused them of advocating anthropomorphism! However, whoever reads the explanation of Manazil al-Sa'irīn will come to know that they (Ibn Taymiyyah and Ibn al-Qayyim) are from the esteemed major scholars of Ahlu al-Sunnah wal-Jama'ah and from the pious ones of this nation. Shaykh al-Islām, 'Abdullāh al-Ansārī al-Hanbalī explains the great status and merits of Ibn Taymiyyah and that he is innocent from the accusations made by his enemies that he was an advocate of anthropomorphism but it is the habit of the enemies of the people of hadīth and Sunnah to falsely accuse... These accusations are the heritage that those deviated people received from the enemies of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) who called the Prophet

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and his companions apostates and claimed that they invented a new religion!

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE IZĀR OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The *izār* refers to the voluminous garment that is wrapped around the lower part of the body.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The title also refers to the *ridā'*, which is the garment that covers the upper part of the body. This is similar to the use of the ayah: **{And has made for you garments which protect you from the heat}**^[137] which actually refers to the cold too.

119. Abū Mūsa al-Ash'arī narrated: "Aisha showed us a patched garment that is worn to cover the upper part, and a coarse *izār*. She then said, 'The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away whilst wearing these two garments.'"^[138]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The meaning of this hadīth is that he (peace be upon him) passed away while he had these garments to wear.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason Aisha kept the two garments of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was to seek blessing from his clothes. She also kept his jubbah (loose outer robe) and after she passed away, her sister Asmā' took it and kept it.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) wore these rough clothes despite the fact he conquered many lands, subdued his enemies and had all the treasures before his hand. This is because he never cared about worldly pleasures and favoured the pleasures found in the Hereafter, and because he (peace be upon him) wanted his nation to follow the example of his lifestyle, especially when they are old.

120. Ubayd bin Khālid narrated: “I was once walking in Madīnah and I then heard a person from behind me say, ‘Lift your *izār* higher for that shows more piety and makes it last longer.’ When I turned to see who this was, I saw that it was the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). I said, ‘O Messenger of Allāh! This is a black garment with white patterns!’ He replied, ‘Are you not taking me as your example?’ I looked at him and I saw that his *izār* reached until the halfway point of his shins.”

[139]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Lifting the garment up [above the ankles] negates the arrogance and showing off that a long garment [hanging below the ankles] entails, and so one follows the order of Allāh (peace be upon him). This is why the Prophet (peace be upon him) said it shows more piety.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The reason why the companion stated the description of the wrap was to say that this kind of clothing cannot be used to show off or make one arrogant even if it reached below the ankle due to its simplicity.

Al-Bajūrī said,

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The guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in respect to lifting the garment above the ankle applies to all types of clothes. This ruling is only applicable to men because it is recommended for women to let one inch of her clothes drag on the floor.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth shows us that a person should look after their clothes so that they do not become worn out as that will make one waste his money.

121. Salamah ibn al-Akwa' narrated: "The *izār* of 'Uthmān ibn 'Affān would fall to the middle of his shins. 'Uthmān said, 'This is how my companion, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) wore his *izār*.'" [140]

122. Hudhaifah ibn al-Yamān reported: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) caught the shin of my leg (the narrator doubted whether he heard it was his leg or the companion's leg) and said, 'This is where the *izār* should reach, and if not, then slightly lower, and if not, then it has no right to reach the ankles.'" [141]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The last part of the hadīth illustrates that one should be very cautious in ensuring that the *izār* does not even reach the ankle.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The ruling on the length of clothes after considering all the hadīths is that the Sunnah is to keep it to the halfway-point of the shin, and that it is lawful to let it reach to the ankle, and that it is disliked to let it reach below the ankle if no showing off is intended, otherwise it would be forbidden.

CHAPTER NINETEEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE WALKING OF ALLĀH'S MESSENGER

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The walking of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was in compliance with the guidance of the ayah: **{And be moderate in your pace...}**^[142]

123. Abū Hurairah narrated: "I have not seen anything more handsome than the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). It was as if the brightness of the sun shone from his face. I have not seen anyone walk faster than him. It was as if the earth would fold up for him; we found it difficult to keep up the pace when we walked with him, yet he walked at his normal pace."

^[143]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Abū Hurairah intentionally used the word "anything" to include everything, meaning that his beauty excelled the beauty of everything that a person can see such as the sun, nature, the moon, and anything that is described as beautiful.

The fast pace indicates that he possessed strong stamina.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason that Abū Hurairah referred to the face only to explain the beauty of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is because the face is the focal point of a person's beauty and often the body conforms to the status of the face.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Despite his fast pace, he walked in a manner that maintained his respect and status; hence his pace was moderate [for him].

124. Alī ibn Abī Tālib used to describe the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), saying: “When he walked, he lifted his legs with vigour; it seemed as if he was descending from a higher place.” ^[144]

Al-Bajūrī said,

He (peace be upon him) lifted his legs with vigour and did not lift them in an arrogant manner or slowly as that is the way women walk.

125. Alī ibn Abī Tālib narrated: “When the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) walked, he bent forward slightly as if he was descending from a high place.” ^[145]

Alī al-Qārī said,

This is to show that he did not drag his feet on the ground or walk in an arrogant manner.

CHAPTER TWENTY

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE HEAD-COVER OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The head-cover referred to here is a cloth that is put over the head to protect the turban from the stains of oil.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The head-cover (Arabic: *qinā'*) refers, in its broader meaning, to the sheet that a person places upon the turban and which partially covers the face. However in the context of this chapter, it refers to the cloth worn underneath the turban to protect it from the stains of oil or the heat.

126. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) often wore a cloth on his head. This cloth, because of its greasiness, looked as if it had been oiled.” ^[146]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The benefits of covering the turban with a sheet so that it covers most of the face are many, some of them are: it is a sign of one’s shyness and fear of Allāh because it is the habit of the fearful to hide and cover themselves, it helps the heart to be more attentive to Allāh and not distracted by the surroundings, it gives the person [the opportunity] to have a minor solitude, as some Sufis have said.

CHAPTER TWENTY ONE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE SITTING OF THE MESSENGER

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to describing the manner in which the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to sit.

127. Qaylah bint Makhramah reported: “I saw the Messenger (peace be upon him) in the masjid sitting in a *qurfusā'* posture. Whilst watching him [and observing his personality] I became overwhelmed due to his overwhelming tranquillity, and this caused me to shiver.” ^[147]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth is part of a longer one wherein Qaylah narrates the story of how she embraced Islām.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The *qurfusā'* (also pronounced as *qarfasā'* and *qirfisā'*) is to sit on the ground with the thighs pressing against the stomach and the arms enfolding the legs. This position is also known as *al-ihtibā'*.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

He (peace be upon him) was sitting in a humble state, gazing at the floor whilst his body parts were calm and tranquil due to his excessive fear of Allāh, the Most High.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The sitting posture of the Prophet (peace be upon him) manifested his true slavery to Allāh, the Most High as he said in a hadīth, “I sit like how a slave sits and I eat just like how a slave eats.”^[148] He did not sit in the manner of the arrogant and the proud. Qaylah was affected in the way she mentioned due to his overwhelming prestige and awe-inspiring personality that caused people to respect him highly and glorify him.

128. ‘Abdullāh ibn Zayd reported: “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) lying on his back in the masjid with one leg placed upon the other.”^[149]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This kind of posture is not common when a person is sitting with a group of people. Rather, a person adopts this posture when resting, when alone or whilst sitting in the company of a few people.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth indicates that lying down is considered a form of sitting.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is reported in Sahīh Muslim that the Prophet (peace be upon him) admonished this kind of posture. The reconciliation between his admonishment of sitting in such a position and his action [in the hadīth] is that his action shows that it is permissible to sit in that position when one knows that his *‘awrah* will not become uncovered.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Al-Khattabī said: “This indicates that the hadīth wherein the Prophet (peace be upon him) admonished this form of sitting is

either abrogated or that it is admonished only when the *'awrah* will show. This is because the *izār* could be tight and so placing the leg on the other would make most of the leg show. It was also said that this incident happened before he admonished this posture or that the admonishment does not apply to the case where one does it because of being tired or to rest, or that his action was to show that it is permissible. It is also said that resting one leg upon the other is done in two ways: (i) the two legs stretched out while one is on the other and this posture does not expose the *'awrah*, (ii) one leg is lifted and bent whilst the other leg is on it, and so the hadīth in this chapter refers to the first type while the admonishment [in Sahīh Muslim] refers to the second type.

129. Abū Sa'īd al-Khudarī narrated: "When Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) sat in the masjid, he did *ihtibā'* with his hands." ^[150]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The exception to this posture is that which he (peace be upon him) used to do after the prayer of *Fajr* as he used to sit with his legs-crossed as reported by Abū Dawūd with an authentic chain of narrators.

Ihtibā' is the common posture of the Bedouins and it is to sit on the ground and to have the thighs pressing against the stomach by wrapping them with a turban and its likes [such as the arms] to give support to the back. The Bedouins used to do it as they had no walls to lean their backs upon.

CHAPTER TWENTY TWO

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH'S RECLINING UPON PILLOWS

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to describing that which the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to rest on for support.

130. Jābir ibn Samurah narrated: "I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) reclining upon a pillow which was on his left side." ^[151]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth describes the event and is not intended to restrict the side on which a person should lean on because it is allowed to lean towards both sides.

131. Abū Bakrah related: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Shall I not inform you of the most severe of the major sins?' The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) asked this question thrice. We said, 'Yes, O Messenger of Allāh! [Please inform us.]' He said, 'Ascribing partners to Allāh, and being undutiful to your parents.' [Then] the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) sat up from his reclining position and said, 'And I warn you against giving forged statements and false testimony.' The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) kept on repeating that warning until we wished he would stop." ^[152]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

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The style of the introductory statement was often used by the Prophet (peace be upon him) as it attracts the attention of the audience and it is a good educational method.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Ibn Abbās considered all that which Allāh has admonished and made forbidden to be major sins as he did not believe that there is a minor sin given the fact that the one being disobeyed is Allāh. However, the most correct view is that sins are of two types, major and minor. The major sins are those that have been warned against in the Qur'ān and Sunnah.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The greatest of the major sins is disbelief but ascribing partners to Allāh is mentioned in this hadīth as it is the most common type of disbelief that people do. The second major sin is being undutiful to the parents and this includes all that which harms them in action or words. The mention of parents here also refers to the grandparents.

This hadīth shows that it is permissible for a person to remember Allāh and teach others whilst reclining upon a pillow and that this act does not imperfect one's mannerisms. It also shows that the preacher should repeat the message until the audience becomes moved by the enthusiasm that they see.

132. Abū Juhayfah reported: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘As for me, I do not eat whilst reclining.’” ^[153]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was intended to condemn the practice of non-Muslims and leaders of the non-Arabs at that time as they used to eat while leaning to one side to show their greatness, pride and arrogance. This statement hints that neither the Prophet (peace be upon him) nor his followers would lean when they ate as Allāh said: **{Say, “This is**

my way; I invite to Allāh with insight, I and those who follow me.”} ^[154]

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

Scholars explained that reclining is of four types: to lean on one side, to rest on one of the hands for support, sitting cross-legged on a pillow, resting the back against a pillow. Adopting any of these positions whilst eating is disliked as doing so indicates arrogance. The Sunnah is to eat while sitting down, leaning forward towards the food.

Al-Bayhaqī said,

If a person is sick and cannot eat unless they are reclining, then it is permissible to eat in such a position.

Al-Bajūrī said,

It is fine for a person to lean and eat nuts, based on the practice of Alī ibn Abī Tālib and al-Ghazalī said, “Arabs may do that but eating while sitting down is better and it is not disliked to eat while standing. As for eating whilst sitting with crossed-legs, it is not the best position to eat in.”

133. Abū Juhayfah reported the same. ^[155]

134. Jābir ibn Samurah narrated: “I saw the Messenger of Allāh reclining upon a pillow.” ^[156]

CHAPTER TWENTY THREE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH LEANING UPON PEOPLE

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter describes the manner in which the Prophet (peace be upon him) leaned whilst standing whereas the previous chapter described how he did so whilst sitting.

135. Anas ibn Mālik reported that he saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), while he was sick, coming out of his room leaning upon Usāmah ibn Zayd for support. He headed to the prayer leading the Muslims whilst wearing a Yemenī shawl that he put on his shoulders. [157]

136. Al-Fadl ibn al-'Abbās narrated: "I came to Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) during the time of his last illness before he passed away and I saw that a yellow band had been tied around his head. I greeted him and after replying, he requested that I fasten the band tightly around his head. I did so and then he sat. He placed his hands upon my shoulders, stood and then he entered the masjid." [158]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth is the evidence used as the basis for wearing yellow turbans and the evidence for wearing black turbans is the hadīth that states that he (peace be upon him) entered Makkah whilst wearing a black turban. However, the white turban is the best as we have explained before.

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Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The request of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to fasten the band around his head was to relieve his headache. This shows that seeking treatment and medicine does not contradict full reliance on Allāh; rather it shows one's humility and need for Allāh.

CHAPTER TWENTY FOUR

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE MANNER OF EATING OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

137. Ka'b ibn Mālik narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to lick his fingers thrice after eating."

Abū 'Īsa [al-Tirmidhī] said: "The narration transmitted from the other narrators of this hadīth, which Muhammad ibn Bashār narrated, is that he used to lick his three fingers." ^[159]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The hadīth wherein it says that he (peace be upon him) licked his fingers three times is an odd narration. The preserved narration is that he licked his three fingers.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The wisdom of licking the fingers is explained in another hadīth wherein he said, "When one of you finishes eating, he should lick his fingers. You do not know in which [part] of your food is the *barakah* (blessing)." ^[160]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reconciliation between this hadīth and the other one where it says that he licked his three fingers (rather than each finger thrice) is that he licked each of the three fingers thrice. The three fingers he used for eating were the thumb, index and middle fingers. The middle finger should be licked first after finishing the meal because it is the longest and so it will have more food stuck to it, then the index finger should be licked,

followed by the thumb. It is the Sunnah to lick the fingers before washing them or wiping them.

Al-Qadī 'Iyyād said,

The wisdom of licking the fingers is so that a person does not belittle the food and appreciates it even if it is little.

Alī al-Qārī said,

It is disliked to lick the fingers while eating because the fingers will then touch the food whilst having some traces of saliva upon them.

138. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to lick his three fingers after he finished eating." ^[161]

139. Abū Juhaifah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'As for me, I do not eat whilst I am reclining [upon something].'" ^[162]

140. Alī ibn al-Aqmar reports the same.

141. Ka'b ibn Mālik narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to eat with his three fingers and lick them after finishing the meal." ^[163]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

There are two etiquettes to learn from this hadīth, they are: (i) eating with three fingers and licking them after finishing eating. However, some scholars have said that eating with three fingers is not for soupy types of food i.e. it is for finger foods that can be collected in the three fingers, and (ii) licking the fingers after finishing the meal.

142. Anas ibn Mālik said: "Dates were presented to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). Due to hunger, I saw

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him kneeling with his feet upright, resting on his heels whilst eating the dates.” ^[164]

Ibn al-Uthaymīn said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) ate like that so that he would not become too comfortable and eat too much. This is because, usually when a person sits in this manner, he does not feel too comfortable and this causes him to become unable to eat excessively. If he is not comfortable he will never eat to excess, but if he is comfortable he will.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth is fully narrated in the Musnad of Imām Ahmad and its wording is: “Dates were presented to the Prophet (peace be upon him) so he divided it equally to be distributed amongst the [the needy] people and I was the one who was sent to give it away. After he finished, I saw him eating whilst sitting in a kneeling position and this made me realise that he was hungry.” ^[165]

This hadīth shows he gave priority to other persons who had a similar condition (i.e. hunger) despite the fact that he was hungry himself.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The Sunnah when sitting to eat is to kneel down with the top of the feet resting upon the floor, or to sit with the right knee up, resting on the left foot.

CHAPTER TWENTY FIVE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE DESCRIPTION OF THE BREAD OF ALLĀH'S MESSENGER

143. Aisha related: “The family of Muhammad (peace be upon him) never ate a full stomach of barley bread for two consecutive days until the day he passed away.” ^[166]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth shows that the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to eat little and that this worldly life held no weight upon his heart. He is the best of mankind but still he used to sleep hungry. This shows that the worldly life is trivial in the sight of Allāh. If it had any value, He would have endowed the best of His creation with all of its adornments and pleasures.

Al-Bajūrī said,

It is possible that the word ‘family’ mentioned in this hadīth is just an unnecessary addition i.e. if it is removed the meaning will still be the same. That is to say that the statement does not include the family of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the following hadīth confirms this meaning. It is also possible that the wording is an integral part of the hadīth and in this case the word ‘family’ refers to those under the responsibility of the Prophet (peace be upon him), and not the family in its broader sense.

144. Abū Umāmah al-Bāhilī narrated: “The family of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never had any barley bread left over.” ^[167]

Alī al-Qārī said,

This indicates that they were never full from food.

145. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās related: “The Messenger (peace be upon him) and his family spent many consecutive nights hungry as there would be no supper. Often, their bread was made of barley.” ^[168]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth shows the noble character, dignity and self-esteem of the Prophet (peace be upon him) as he took precautions so that none of his companions would know that he and his family slept hungry for several nights. This is evident as it is certain that if they were aware about it they would have raced each other to give him priority over themselves and their families. This indicates the virtue of the poor and directs people not to ask for food even when one is hungry.

146. Someone asked Sahl ibn Sa’d: “Did the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) ever eat bread made of white bran-free flour?” He replied, “The Messenger (peace be upon him) never ate it in his lifetime.” The questioner then asked, “Did you people use sieved flour in the time of the Messenger (peace be upon him)?” He replied, “We did not have sieves.” The questioner then asked, “How did you sieve the barley?” He replied, “We used to blow out the particles and then knead that which remained.” ^[169]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

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The reason why the questioner asked about barley is because it has grains that if they remain in the dough, the bread would be difficult to chew.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth shows that the Prophet (peace be upon him) was not fussy about food and so he ate the barley bread just like everyone else. It is only the fools and idle people who are fussy about food.

147. Anas ibn Mālīk reported: “The Messenger (peace be upon him) never ate food from a table, nor from a *sukurrujah* (i.e. a small plate), nor was thin soft bread ever made for him.”

Yūnus asked Qatādah (who narrated this hadīth from Anas): “Then upon what did they eat their food?” He replied: “Upon these floor-sheets.” ^[170]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows the moderation of the Prophet (peace be upon him) even in food as he ate neither from a table nor on the floor without placing a sheet underneath. This is because eating on the table was considered as a luxury whilst eating on the floor without placing anything underneath would expose the food to dirt. Thus, eating on the floor while having a sheet underneath is a humble way of eating that protects the food from dirt.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Eating on dining tables was the practice followed amongst the non-Arabs so that their heads would not nod down while eating. However, it is allowed to eat from the table if there is no pride or arrogance involved.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The *sukurrujah* is a small plate that is used for side dishes and appetisers.

148. Masrūq narrated: “I visited Aisha and she ordered food for me and then said, ‘I never eat to my full except that I wish to cry, then I begin to cry.’ I asked, ‘Why is that?’ She replied, ‘I remember the state of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) upon which he left us for the next world. I swear by Allāh that he never filled his stomach twice in one day with meat or bread.” ^[171]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Masrūq was born during the lifetime of the Prophet (peace be upon him) but never saw him as he was living in the city of Kufa in Iraq. The name Masrūq means “stolen” and he was given this name because he was kidnapped when he was a child and then later on his family managed to find him.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason Aisha used to cry every time she ate to her full was because she missed the hard life that she had experienced with the Prophet (peace be upon him). This is because that lifestyle was the highest level of virtuousness since it was the lifestyle that the Prophet chose for himself (peace be upon him) and his family.

Al-Bajūrī said,

He (peace be upon him) never had a full stomach from either meat and bread twice in one day i.e. enjoying much of the lawful matters is disliked whereas enjoying less of it is recommended, and humbleness is required.

149. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never filled his stomach with barley bread for two consecutive days until he passed away.” ^[172]

Alī al-Qārī said,

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He (peace be upon him) never filled his stomach with bread made of barley, let alone bread made of wheat. This was because he acted upon the decision he made when he was given the choice to either be a prophet who is a king in this world or just a slave of Allāh, and so he chose, "I prefer to be a Prophet who is a [true] slave of Allāh; I starve on one day so I bear it with patience and I eat well on another day so I praise Him."^[173]

Al-Bajūrī said,

He did not eat to his full twice in one day because he avoided that and preferred the state of hunger.

150. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: "Until the end of his life; the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never ate on a table and never ate thin soft bread."^[174]

CHAPTER TWENTY SIX

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE IDĀM OF THE PROPHET

Al-Bajūrī said,

The *idām* refers to all that which is eaten with bread, be it liquid or solid, and so it includes even meat. The fact that meat is considered a type of *idām* is based on the linguistic meaning of the word but it is not considered an *idām* based on the norms of people.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This is because the habit of people is to eat the *idām* to facilitate the eating of other food [i.e. it is used to eat the bread].

151. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘What an excellent *idām* vinegar is.’” ^[175]

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

This hadīth is intended to praise vinegar, given the circumstances of the event, and so it does not intend to prefer it over all other types of *idām*, as some ignorant people think. The context behind this statement is that he (peace be upon him) went home and took a piece of bread. He then asked his family if there was an *idām* to eat with the bread and so they replied that they have nothing but vinegar. Upon that he praised the *idām*.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) praised vinegar to complement and bring comfort to the heart of the one presenting it to him. Otherwise if the available *idām* was milk or meat or honey, they would have been praised instead.

152. Al-Nu'mān ibn Bashīr said: "You are in enough luxury to eat and drink all that you wish! By Allāh, I have seen your Prophet (peace be upon him) not having the worst type of dates to fill his stomach." ^[176]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The purpose of al-Nu'mān's statement was to remind the remaining companions and the generation that did not have the pleasure and honour to see the Prophet (peace be upon him) of the blessings and favours of Allāh upon them.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The purpose of al-Nu'mān was to admonish those whom he addressed and advise them to suffice with the little that is enough and to follow the example of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in this regard. The reason he said "your Prophet" was to emphasise the meaning of the advice that followed and to encourage them.

153. Jābir ibn 'Abdullāh related: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'What a wonderful *idām* vinegar is.'"

^[177]

154. Zahdam al-Jarmī narrated that: "We were in the presence of Abū Mūsa al-Ash'arī when chicken was served to us. A person from among those present distanced himself from the gathering. Abū Mūsa asked him the reason [for doing so]. He replied, 'I have seen the chicken eat something unclean so I swore that I would not eat it.' Abū Mūsa said, 'Come, for I have seen the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) eat the meat of the chicken.'" ^[178]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The direction of Abū Mūsa given to the man was to indicate that it is better for him that he offers expiation for his oath and eats from the chicken to follow the example of the Prophet (peace be upon him) based on the hadīth, “None of you shall believe until his desire conforms to that which I brought.”^[179] It also indicates that the host serving the food should try to make the person break any similar oath if the reason for leaving a particular food is for a matter that is not disliked in religion (except in the case where the man made a conditional divorce).

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

If the chicken was of the type that lives on dirt and garbage then one should not break his oath because it is forbidden to eat. However, it seems that the chicken was not from that type and it happened that it ate something dirty on that day.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The man did not specify the type of dirt that he saw the chicken eating so that he would not make the people feel disgust towards the food. This is because it suffices for a person who dislikes a type of food just to state that he does not feel like eating it, thus following the guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in this kind of situation.

155. Safīna narrated: “I ate bustard meat with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).”^[180]

Safīna is a nick name given to him. It means a ship because he carried a lot of luggage when travelling. He was one of the slaves that the Prophet (peace be upon him) freed and his name is disputed over but some stated that his actual name is Mihrān.

156. Zahdam al-Jarmī narrated: “We were present in a gathering with Abū Mūsa al-Ash’arī and in the food that was served there was poultry. Among those present was a man

from the tribe of Banī Taymullah who was reddish in complexion and seemed to be a freed slave. He moved back and sat to one side, staying away from the food. Abū Mūsa asked him to come near [and eat from the food] and related to him that he saw the Messenger (peace be upon him) also eat chicken. He excused himself saying, 'I had seen it eating something unclean. For this reason I swore an oath that I would not eat it.'"^{[181] [182]}

157. Abū Asīd narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Use olive oil as a food and for rubbing [on the body], for it is from a blessed tree.'"^[183]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The direction to eat olive oil relates to eating it with bread (i.e. using it as an *idām*).

Al-Bajūrī said,

The direction to rub the body with olive oil should be moderate. Ibn al-Qayyim said, "Using oil in hot lands such as the region of Hejaz is good for health but it is harmful if it is used in cold lands."

Alī al-Qārī said,

The olive tree is blessed because it grows in the blessed land (i.e. the region of al-Shām) and that makes its olives blessed. It was reported that the Prophet (peace be upon him) encouraged using it as a medicine to treat haemorrhoids, and in another hadīth that olive oil cures seventy diseases.

158. 'Umar ibn al-Khattab narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Use olive oil as a food and for rubbing [on the body], for it is from a blessed tree.'"^[184]

159. Zayd ibn Aslam reports the same from his father.^[185]

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160. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) loved eating pumpkin. Once food was presented to him (or he attended an invitation) where pumpkin was served. As I knew that he loved it; I sought its pieces in the platter and then placed them in front of him so that he could eat them.” ^[186]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason the Prophet (peace be upon him) liked eating pumpkin is because it sharpens the mind, cures headaches, extinguishes thirst, it is good for the one who has a fever and is suitable for one who feels cold.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) liked pumpkin because he knew that this vine possesses hidden benefits since Allāh caused it to grow over Prophet Yūnus. Yūnus subsisted and lived under the shade of this vine [during his rehabilitation].

One of the benefits concluded from this hadīth is that it is allowed for a person to reach for the food that is not in front of him if the food consists of different types.

161. Jābir ibn Tariq narrated: “I visited the Prophet (peace be upon him) and I observed that a pumpkin was being sliced. I inquired, ‘What is the reason for cutting it into pieces?’ He replied, ‘We use it to increase the quantity of our food.’” ^[187]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth shows that pumpkin is from the *idām*.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The slicing of the pumpkin into pieces indicates that one should take care of the cooking as this does not contradict asceticism or reliance on Allāh, as one can live moderately in a manner that leads to contentment.

162. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “A tailor once invited the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) to a feast he had prepared. I went with Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) and attended the gathering. The host presented the Messenger (peace be upon him) with some bread made of barley and a broth with pieces of meat and pumpkin in it. I saw the Messenger (peace be upon him) look for pieces of pumpkin from all sides of the bowl. Thenceforth, I began loving pumpkin.” ^[188]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

From the etiquettes of good hospitality is to place the food near the guest.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Anas ibn Mālik attended the invitation with the Prophet (peace be upon him) because he was his servant or because he was asked to.

The fact that the Prophet (peace be upon him) ate from all sides of the plate does not contradict his command that a person should eat only from in front of him. This is because the command was given so that other diners would not be harmed [by the person reaching], and no one would ever be harmed if the hand of the Prophet (peace be upon him) reached in front of them because people seek blessing with that.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The *fiqh* of this hadīth is as follows:

- It is recommended to accept the invitation of others even if the food made is little or the social status of the host is less than that of the invitee.
- It is recommended to like pumpkin because the Prophet (peace be upon him) liked it and the same applies to all that which he (peace be upon him) liked.

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- It is recommended to eat with the servant. The Prophet (peace be upon him) allowing his servant to accompany him and join him is an example of his humble character and kind treatment to the young companions.

163. Aisha narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) loved *halwā* and honey.”^[189]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Halwā refers to all that which is sweet, and it can be used to refer to fruits. Al-Khattabī said that it refers to the manmade sweets. Al-Tha'alibī said that the *halwā* that the Prophet (peace be upon him) liked was the mixture of dates that is knead with milk.

Al-Khattabī said, “He (peace be upon him) did not like *halwā* in the sense that he used to crave for it but rather he would like to eat more of it when it was presented to him and that is how it was known that he liked it.”

164. Umm Salamah related: “I presented a roasted side portion of sheep to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He ate from it and then prayed without performing ablution.”^[190]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The last practice of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was not to perform ablution after eating meat cooked on fire except for the meat of camels, according to the most correct view of scholars.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Mentioning the roasted meat after *halwā* and honey indicates that these are the best types of food. However, Ibn al-Qayyim mentioned that one should not eat meat all the time as that can cause illness.

165. 'Abdullāh ibn al-Hārith narrated: "We ate roasted meat with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) whilst in the masjid." ^[191]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Sunan of Ibn Majah includes the following addition to the hadīth, "Then, he got up and prayed and we prayed with him. We did not do anything after finishing the meal more than wiping our hands with stones." It is possible that this incident took place during their *'itikāf* though it is permissible to eat in the masjid if one can assure that the food will not cause mess.

166. Al-Mughīrah ibn Shu'bah narrated: "One night, I and the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) were the guests of an individual. The host served us a roasted side portion of sheep and then he (peace be upon him) took a big knife and started cutting pieces from it and he cut some for me to eat. During this period, Bilal came and began the call to prayer, and so the Prophet (peace be upon him) put down the knife and said, 'May both his hands be in dust. What made him call out for the prayer at this moment?'"

Al-Mughīrah said that his moustache had grown long and so the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said to him, "Come let me put a *siwāk* on it and then trim the hair that goes below its level." ^[192]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) cutting the meat for al-Mughīrah shows his modesty and it was an action done to show kindness to al-Mughīrah who had recently embraced Islām at that time.

The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) blamed Bilal for calling him to the prayer in the presence of food when there was still time remaining for the time of the prayer. ^[193]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The statement of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) to Bilal could be interpreted either in the sense of blame or praise. To assume it is intended to mean the latter, then it was said to praise Bilal for notifying him of the prayer. If it is the former then, it was said because delaying the prayer of *'Ishā* is better than praying it at the beginning of its time.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The scholars differed on whether it is better to trim the moustache or to shave it. Some scholars held the view that shaving the moustache is better based on a hadīth but the majority stated that trimming it is better.

167. Abū Hurairah narrated: "Someone sent the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) some meat. From it the forearm was presented to him as he loved this portion of the meat, and so he ate a morsel of it with his front teeth." ^[194]

Al-Qadī 'Iyyād said,

He (peace be upon him) liked the meat of the forearm because it is delicious, quick to be cooked, easy to chew and swallow, and it is far from the parts of the animal that are exposed to dirt and harm.

168. 'Abdullāh ibn Mas'ūd narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) loved the meat of the forearm." He also narrated that: "He (peace be upon him) was given poison in the forearm portion of the meat and it was believed that the Jews poisoned him." ^[195]

Al-Bajūrī said,

In another hadīth, it mentions that he loved the shoulder. He (peace be upon him) also liked the meat of the neck because it is

similar to the meat of the forearm in that it is far from the places of harm.

Ibn 'Umar narrated that he disliked eating seven things from the sheep: (i) the gall bladder, (ii) the bladder, (iii) the testicles, (iv) the penis, (v) the vagina, (vi) the blood, (vii) and the gland.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The lethal poisoned meat did not harm the Prophet (peace be upon him) when he ate it but it used to affect him every year until he (peace be upon him) died because of it. This was in order to double his reward. It was narrated that he (peace be upon him) only ate one bite of it and then Jibra'īl informed him about the poison upon which he (peace be upon him) informed his companions to refrain from eating it. However, some of them passed away. In another hadīth, it was the poisoned forearm that informed the Prophet (peace be upon him) about it. The Jewish woman who did this was questioned about her motives and she answered that she believed if he was a Prophet then the poison would not harm him and for that he forgave her and the woman embraced Islām after she saw the outcome of her test. However, later on she was executed because her poison led to the death of one of the other companions who ate from the meat. The wisdom behind Jibra'īl and the forearm (according to the other narration) not informing him until after he ate from the meat was to manifest the truthfulness of his status as a Prophet, to be a reason for the Jewish woman to embrace Islām, and to be an evidence against anyone who insists after that on disbelief.

169. Abū 'Ubaydah narrated: "I once prepared food for the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). Because he loved the forearm portion of the meat, I served him that portion. He then ordered another one, I served the second one. He then ordered one again. I replied, 'O Messenger of Allāh! The goat has only two forearms!' To that he said, 'I swear by the One in whose

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Hand is my soul, if you kept quiet, you could have served me every time I requested one from you.” ^[196]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This is a hadīth that shows one of the miracles of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and signs of his truthfulness.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason why the inquisitive statement of the companion resulted in not witnessing this miracle is because witnessing such a miracle is an honour by itself and only a person whose submission is perfect and free of any personal desire or opinion deserves to witness it.

170. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did not like the forearm portion of meat the best (i.e. due to its taste). Rather, as meat was only available occasionally, and as this portion of the meat cooked quickly, he liked it.” ^[197]

Alī al-Qārī said,

This is supported by the statement of Aisha that it would pass a whole month without them having anything to cook and that they would live on dates and water unless they received some meat. This hadīth also shows that he (peace be upon him) liked other portions of meat such as the meat of the back (the meat that is along the backbone of the animal), as stated in the next hadīth.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The statement of Aisha negating that he (peace be upon him) liked the meat of the forearm as a personal preference seems to be given to indicate that the noble status of the Prophet (peace be upon him) transcended any inclination to the worldly pleasures. Thus she explained that he liked it because it cooks fast and that saved him time so he could return quickly to his

commitments and look after the affairs of Muslims. However, to love the meat of the forearm as a personal preference does not contravene his perfection because imperfection is to work hard to attain a worldly pleasure or feeling sorry for missing it.

171. ‘Abdullāh ibn Ja’far narrated: “I heard the Prophet (peace be upon him) saying, ‘The best meat is the meat of the back (the meat that is along the backbone of the animal).’” ^[198]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This praise shows that the Prophet (peace be upon him) ate the meat of the back as well.

172. Aisha narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said: “Vinegar is an excellent *idām*.” ^{[199] [200]}

173. Umm Hanī’ related: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) came to my house and asked if there was something to eat. I replied, ‘Nothing besides dry bread and vinegar.’ The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Bring it. The house that has vinegar in it is not a house that has bread without an *idām*.” ^[201]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This incident happened on the day that Makkah was conquered.

Alī al-Qārī said,

It was said that the statement of Umm Hanī began with a negative word to indicate that there was no food in the house even though there was some. This was because she glorified the status of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and thought that dry bread and vinegar were not suitable foods to be served to a person with such a high, noble status.

The meaning of the statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is that a house that has vinegar will not be in need of another *idām*.

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Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The *fiqh* of this hadīth is:

- Encouraging not belittling bread and vinegar as a food.
- It is permissible to ask someone for food if the relationship is strong enough that the questioner will not feel embarrassment when asking.

174. Abū Mūsa al-Ash'arī narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'The excellence of Aisha over other women is like the excellence of *tharīd* over other foods.'" [202]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This description of Aisha is a merit she earned due to her good character, eloquence in speech, sensibility and wisdom, and her constant efforts to please her husband. This hadīth is intended to mean that she was the best of his wives because the best of women are in the following order: Maryam bint 'Imrān, Fātimah al-Zahrā' (daughter of the Prophet (peace be upon him)), Khadijah bint Khuwailid (the first wife of the Prophet (peace be upon him)) and then comes Aisha. This is the view of many of the *salaf* and many of the latter scholars.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Tharīd is a dish made of pieces of bread in meat broth. This dish does not always include pieces of meat.

175. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'The excellence of Aisha over other women is like the excellence of *tharīd* over other foods.'" [203]

176. Abū Hurairah narrated: "He once saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) performing ablution after he ate a piece of hard dry yoghurt (made from ewe or goat's milk), and he saw him on another occasion eating from the shoulder of a lamb, and then he prayed without performing ablution." [204]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The word ablution (Arabic: *wudū*) is used in this hadīth twice but each mention entails a different meaning; the lingual meaning and the religious meaning. The word was used in reference to eating dry yoghurt to mean that he (peace be upon him) washed his hands after he ate it, and the word was used in the second instance to refer to the actual ablution. Thus, the meaning of the hadīth is that he (peace be upon him) washed his hands after eating the first meal, and he did not perform ablution after eating from the sheep because it does not invalidate one's ablution.

177. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had his wedding feast in celebration of his marriage with Safiyyah with dates and *sawīq*.” ^[205]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The mother of the believers Safiyyah was the daughter of Huyay ibn Akhtab and she was from the captives (slaves) but the Prophet (peace be upon him) freed her and married her, making her freedom her wedding gift (Arabic: *mahr*). The *sawīq* is a meal made of wheat or barley. However, in Sahīh Bukhārī it states that the feast was a meal made of dates, *ghee* and dried milk or wheat.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The father of Safiyyah was the famous master of the Jewish tribe Banī al-Nadīr and his daughter was one of the female captives on the day of Khaybar. Before she was captured and entered Islām, she saw a dream that the moon fell upon her lap. When she told her father about the dream he hit her hard on the face, leaving a mark on it and he said to her, “You will keep looking high until you become the woman of the kind of the Arabs.”

178. Salma , the grandmother of 'Ubaidullāh ibn Alī narrated that Al-Hasan ibn Alī, Ibn 'Abbās and Ibn Ja'far visited her and asked her to make them a food that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) liked and ate with pleasure. However, she replied, "O my children, you will not like it now." They replied, "We will surely like it." She stood up and gathered some barley, crushed it and put it in a pot, poured a little olive oil over it, then crushed some pepper and spices and added that to the pot and served it whilst saying, "This is from the food that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) liked and ate with pleasure." ^[206]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The grandmother of 'Ubaidullāh ibn Alī was the one who helped deliver Ibrahīm, the son of the Prophet (peace be upon him). She was the servant of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the one who cooked for him. This is why she was approached and asked about the food he (peace be upon him) used to like.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Her stating that they would not like the food was meant to indicate that it would not meet their personal preferences in terms of what constitutes a good food. This was due to this food being eaten during difficult times whereas the food they (the companions who visited her) were now accustomed to was far more diverse as life had become more comfortable. Their answering that they will like it meant that they will surely like it since the Prophet (peace be upon him) liked it and they were seeking the blessings of following the example of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

179. Jābir ibn 'Abdullāh narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) came to our house and we slaughtered a sheep in his honour. He (peace be upon him) said, 'It is as if they knew we like meat.'"

Imām al-Tirmidhī said: “There is a story behind the visit of the Prophet (peace be upon him).” ^[207]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The statement of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was intended to compliment the hosts and make them happy, not to show his admiration for meat. This hadīth teaches us that the host should serve that which the guest likes, if he knows about it, and that the guest should mention to his host the food he likes (unless he knows that it would burden the host).

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The reason behind the visit of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to the house of Jābir is explained in the hadīth documented in the Musnad of Imām Ahmad wherein it states that Jābir asked the Prophet (peace be upon him) to help him pay the debts of his father, so he (peace be upon him) said that he would pay a visit to his house. Then Jābir went home and told his wife not to talk to or ask the Prophet (peace be upon him) for anything. So, when he (peace be upon him) visited them, he slaughtered for him a sheep and so he (peace be upon him) said, “It is as if they knew we like meat.” But, when he (peace be upon him) went out, Jābir’s wife asked the Prophet (peace be upon him) to pray on her and her husband so the Prophet (peace be upon him) said, “O Allāh, may your *Salah* be upon them.” This made Jābir chastise his wife for disobeying him but she said, “Did you want him (peace be upon him) to enter our house and leave without supplicating for us!” ^[208]

180. Jābir narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) went out to the house of a woman from among the Ansār and I accompanied him. The hostess slaughtered a sheep for the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and so he ate from it. She then served him fresh dates upon a tray made of palm leaves. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) ate some

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from it, then performed ablution and prayed *Dhuhr*. After returning from the prayer, she served him some of the remaining meat. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) ate from it and then prayed 'Asr without performing ablution."

[209]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The statement of Jābir when he said, "I accompanied him" demonstrates the high level of politeness and good etiquette of the companions when talking about the Prophet (peace be upon him) as their choice of words always implied that they were following the Prophet (peace be upon him).

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth shows us that the Prophet (peace be upon him) ate meat twice in one day and this does not contradict the statement of Aisha wherein she mentioned that he (peace be upon him) never had a full stomach from meat. This is because eating meat twice on the same day does not necessitate that he had a full stomach.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth teaches us that it is allowed to eat twice even if the food from the first time has not yet fully digested if one knows that he will not overeat, or if the food served first was little.

181. Umm al-Mundhir narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) visited me and Alī was with him. We had some dates hanging and the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) began eating from them and so did Alī. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) stopped him saying, 'You have not fully recovered from your illness and should not eat this.' Alī stopped and the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) continued eating. Then I prepared for them some barley and *silq* (similar to the arugula plant). The Messenger of Allāh

(peace be upon him) said to Alī, 'Eat of this, for it is more suitable for you.'" ^[210]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It is said that Umm al-Mundhir was one of the maternal aunts of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

Al-Bajūrī said,

The directions of the Prophet (peace be upon him) show that it is prescribed to seek medication and that this does not contradict reliance on Allāh.

182. Aisha, the mother of the believers, narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to come to me and ask if there was any food available for lunch. When I would say no, he would reply, 'In that case, I make the intention to fast.' On one occasion he came and enquired, I replied, 'We have received a gift.' He asked, 'What is it?' I replied, 'Hays (dates mixed with ghee and dry yoghurt or ghee and wheat).' He said, 'I woke up with the intention of fasting.' He then ate some from it." ^[211]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It is not a condition of voluntary fasting to establish the intention to fast before the time of *Fajr*. Thus, if a person wakes up and did not eat or drink, he can make the intention to fast at any point until the time before *Dhuhr*.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The wives of the Prophet (peace be upon him) are called the mothers of the believers because they are unlawful for the Muslims to marry. It is said so because it is obligatory to look after them and respect them [as mothers].

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The statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) wherein he disclosed his intention to fast shows that it is fine to show others your voluntary good deeds if the purpose is to educate them.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The act of the Prophet (peace be upon him) where he ate whilst he was fasting indicates that it is allowed for a person to break his voluntary fast and this view is supported by a number of other hadīths.

183. Yūsuf ibn 'Abdullāh ibn Salām narrated: "I once saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) taking a piece of bread made of barley and putting a date on it. He then said, 'This [date] is the *idām* for this [bread].' He then ate it." ^[212]

Alī al-Qārī said,

This hadīth teaches us to utilise the resources available to have good nutrition, for the bread made of barley is cold and dry whilst the date is warm and moist. It also teaches that one should be self-content with whatever one has.

184. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) liked to eat the remains of food." ^[213]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The remains of food refers to the food that remains in the bottom of the pot as it is the most cooked and tastiest of the food cooked in the pot.

CHAPTER TWENTY SEVEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE *WUDŪ* OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH AT THE TIME OF EATING

Al-Bajūrī said,

The word “*wudū*” used in the title of this chapter is used in its linguistic and religious sense. The former means to wash and cleanse the hands and the latter means to perform ablution.

This chapter is dedicated to explaining that ablution is neither obligatory nor recommended at the time of eating and that washing the hands is recommended.

185. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “Once after the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) finished relieving himself from the call of nature, food was served to him. He was asked if the water for ablution should be brought. He replied, ‘I have only been commanded to perform ablution when I want to pray.’” ^[214]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The statement of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was to explain to the companions that ablution is not required when a person wants to eat; rather only when one wants to pray.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The command that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) referred to was the ayah: **{O you who have believed, when you rise to [perform] prayer, wash your faces and your**

forearms to the elbows and wipe over your heads and wash your feet to the ankles.}^[215]

Al-Walī al-Irāqī said, “This hadīth is a proof that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) liked to perform ablution before each prayer, whether he was in a state of purity or not, except on the day Makkah was conquered as he prayed the five daily prayers with one ablution. This made ‘Umar ibn al-Khattab exclaim saying, ‘I saw you today doing something you never did before.’ The Prophet (peace be upon him) replied, ‘O Umar! I did that intentionally.’”^[216]

186. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “Once after the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) finished relieving himself from the call of nature, food was served to him. He was asked if he was going to perform ablution. He replied, ‘Am I going to offer a prayer so that I need to perform ablution?’”^[217]

187. Salmān al-Fārisī narrated: “I have read in the Torah that to attain the blessings from food one should wash the hands after eating. I mentioned this to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and so he said, ‘The blessing in food is attained when washing the hands before and after eating.’”^[218]

Al-Bajūrī said,

It is recommended to allow the children to wash their hands first before old people as the hands of children are more likely to be dirty compared to the hands of old people and water may run out if the old people take the lead. This is recommended before eating and the opposite is the case after eating, meaning the old people should be given priority to wash their hands over the youngsters to show respect to their age. As for the host, he takes the priority to wash his hands first before everyone but should be the last to wash his hands. It is recommended to dry the washed hands after eating but not before eating. This is because if the towel has some dirt on it and hands were dried

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using it before eating, then the dirt may transfer to the hands, and also because wet hands will prevent the ghee (butter) from sticking to the hands.

Al-Qurtubī said,

If the one who reads it (the Qur'ān) will have a tenfold reward or more for each letter, according to what we mentioned in the introduction to this book, then turning away from it and towards other scriptures is misguidance and loss, and this is a poor trade off and waste of time.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

It is important to note that in the case of those who are not well-versed in knowledge and are lacking in faith, it is not permissible for them to read any of those books.

CHAPTER TWENTY EIGHT

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO WHAT THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH SAID BEFORE AND AFTER EATING

Al-Bajūrī said,

This chapter includes all that which the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to say before and after eating and drinking.

188. Abū Ayyūb al-Ansārī narrated: “We were once sitting with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). Food was presented to him and I have never seen any food that had such a large amount of blessings at the beginning and less blessings left in the food at the end. We therefore asked, ‘O Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him)! How did this happen?’ He replied, ‘In the beginning we all mentioned the name of Allāh before we began eating. Then someone in the end joined us, and did not recite ‘*Bismillah*’ and so Satan ate with him.” ^[219]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The statement of Abū Ayyūb at the beginning demonstrates the perfect manners of the companions when talking about the Prophet (peace be upon him) as they used statements that indicated that they were his followers.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The answer of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) proves that saying '*Bismillah*' is enough to fulfil the Sunnah of mentioning the name of Allāh before eating, which is the reason why the food had so much blessing in it. However, al-Ghazālī and al-Nawawī said that adding '*al-Rahman al-Rahīm*' to '*Bismillah*' is better and closer to perfection. This is recommended to say even if the woman is menstruating or in postpartum, or when the person is in a state of major impurity due to intercourse. However, it is stipulated that they (those in a state of major impurity) do not intend to say this with the intention to recite from the Qur'ān.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is recommended to say '*Bismillah*' before commencing anything that is important and virtuous except in the case of remembrance of Allāh and supplications (i.e. it is not prescribed for us to say *Bismillah* before we invoke Allah or before reciting any *dhikr*).

189. Aisha narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'When a person eats and has forgotten to recite '*Bismillah*' [before starting to eat], then one should recite, '*Bismillahi awwalahu wa aa-khirahu*' ('*Bismillah* at the beginning and at the end')."^[220]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This is a direction to those who may forget to mention the name of Allāh before eating and then remember it before they finish eating. In such a case, the person should say, "*Bismillahi awwalahu wa aa-khirahu*" in order to attain the blessings of the food, by the will of Allāh.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The statement "*Bismillah* at the beginning and at the end" includes all that comes in the middle and it is possible that it

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refers to the first half and second half of the time spent eating. In other words, it means “*Bismillah* throughout the time spent eating.”

190. Umar ibn Abī Salamah narrated: “I entered upon the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) whilst some food had been served to him. He (peace be upon him) said, ‘O my son! Come near, say *Bismillah*, and eat with your right hand from that which is in front of you.’” ^[221]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth teaches us that it is allowed to call those other than one’s own children “son” and it includes three etiquettes pertaining to food:

1. To say *Bismillah* before eating.
2. To eat with the right hand.
3. To eat from the portion in front of you.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The ruling on eating with the right hand is that it is recommended but other scholars stated that it is obligatory due to the existence of the hadīth wherein the Prophet (peace be upon him) admonished the person who ate with his left hand.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth teaches us the following:

- It is recommended for the elders to be kind with the youth, especially when food is served so as to break the ice since there can be elements of shyness on such occasions.
- It is recommended to say *Bismillah* audibly so others can hear it.
- It is obligatory on the person to eat from the portion in front of themselves except in the case of fruits.

- It is recommended for a person to teach others who eat about any of the etiquettes of food if a person does not act upon them.

191. Abū Sa'īd al-Khudarī narrated: "After the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) finished eating he recited, '*All praise is due only to Allāh, who has fed us, granted us something to drink and has made us Muslims.*'" ^[222]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

There are different statements that the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to say to praise Allāh and it is prescribed for a person to recite these various phrases of praise at different times so that on a certain occasion one is said and at another time something else and so forth. The minimum one can say is "*Alhamdulillah*" but it is better to say that which is reported from the Prophet (peace be upon him).

Al-Bajūrī said,

Praising Allāh for the food after finishing the meal is to show gratefulness and appreciation to Allāh who has blessed us with that. The reason why he mentioned food before the drink is because drinks complement the food, not the other way around. The reason behind praising Allāh for making us Muslims is to combine praising Him for that which we receive in this world and that which we will receive in the Hereafter. It also indicates that one who praises Allāh for a worldly matter should praise Him for the blessings of Islām because through Islām we learnt to praise Him.

192. Abū Umāmah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to say after the food was removed, '*All praise is due to Allāh alone; praise which is abundant, good and blessed that is neither insufficient, nor abandoned, nor ignored from our Lord.*'" ^[223]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The Sunnah is not to say “*Alhamdulillah*” after finishing the meal whilst other people are still eating as that may make them stop eating.

The meaning of “praise which is abundant, good and blessed” is a praise that is endless just like how His blessings and favours upon us are endless, with sincerity and no element of showing off, and a praise that is ceaseless and blessed.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to supplicate for the person at whose house he ate before leaving. The Sunnah is not to leave the food even if one is full until the other people in the group finish too. This is so that they do not feel embarrassed and leave the food whilst they still wish to eat.

193. Aisha related: “While six of the companions were eating with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), a nomad came and ate all the food in two bites. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘If he had said ‘*Bismillah*’ it would have been sufficient for all of you.” ^[224]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows that leaving the *Bismillah* removes the blessings of the food.

194. Anas ibn Mālik related: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Allāh is pleased with His slave who praises Him after eating a morsel of food or taking a sip of a beverage.” ^[225]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The author kept this hadīth until the end of the chapter because it includes the reward of praising Allāh for one’s food and drink – that is winning the pleasure of Allāh.

CHAPTER TWENTY NINE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE CUP OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The cup refers to all that which is used to drink from.

195. Thābit narrated: “Anas presented to us a thick wooden cup, which was lined with metal, and said, ‘O Thābit, this is the cup of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).’” ^[226]

Mirak Shah al-Hanafī said,

It is proven in the authentic hadīth that the cup of the Prophet (peace be upon him) that Anas ibn Mālik possessed was a good cup with a length shorter than its width, and that this cup had a crack in it so the Prophet (peace be upon him) fixed it with a silver chain.

196. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “I presented the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) with drinks in this cup from all those things which are drunk; water, *nabīdh*, honey and milk.”

^[227]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The *nabīdh* is water that has had dates or grapes put in it and left overnight. By morning the water becomes sweetened with the taste of dates or grapes.

CHAPTER THIRTY

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE FRUITS EATEN BY THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

197. ‘Abdullāh ibn Ja’far narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) ate *qithā’* with ripe dates (*rutab*).” ^[228]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Qithā’ is a type of cucumber that is larger than the normal cucumber.

Al-Bajūrī said,

He (peace be upon him) combined between dates and cucumber to attain the benefits and avert the harms of each. This is because the hotness of dates neutralises the coolness of cucumber i.e. dates neutralise the negative effects of cucumber and the latter neutralises the negative effects of dates.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

You should know that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to eat from the fruits grown in his town and never refrained from it. This is a means of maintaining one’s health.

This hadīth teaches us that it is allowed to combine between two types of *idām* and the hadīth does not state that both are chewed at once. Rather, it means that both are eaten one after another so they are both in the digestive tract.

198. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) ate watermelon with ripe dates (*rutab*).” ^[229]

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Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

All the hadīths about the virtue of watermelon are fabricated or very weak except this hadīth.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The combination of fruits that he (peace be upon him) used to eat shows that he followed the logic of medicine i.e. he ate that which would neutralise the bad effects of the other food.

199. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) eating muskmelon together with ripe dates (*rutab*).” ^[230]

200. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) ate watermelon with ripe dates (*rutab*).” ^[231]

201. Abū Hurairah narrated: “People used to pick their new fruit, and then present it to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He then would take it and supplicate, ‘O Allāh! Bless us in our fruits. Bless our city. Bless us in our sāl’, and bless us in our mudd (these are two units of measurement used to measure dates). O Allāh! Ibrāhīm is Your slave, close friend, and Prophet, and I am Your slave and Prophet. And, he supplicated to You for Makkah and I supplicate to You for Madīnah for the like of what He prayed to You for Makkah.’ Then, he would call the youngest child he could see and give him that fruit.” ^[232]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth shows an allowed type of intercession - that is intercession through one’s state as a slave of Allāh and humility before Him.

It was his perfect manners, kindness and mercy that made him give the fruit to the youngest child present because children long the most for fruits.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) is also the *khalīl* of Allāh (i.e. close friend of Allāh) but he did not mention it either out of reverence for Ibrahīm or because he was granted a higher level of love and closeness to Allāh.

The fact that the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not eat the fruit brought to him and instead gave it to children demonstrates that noble people with pure souls and high manners do not long to eat something until after everyone else can have it.

The scholars are in agreement that Makkah and Madīnah are the best places on earth, and the three *imāms* hold the view that Makkah is better than Madīnah whereas Imām Mālik stated otherwise. However, the dispute is not over the noble area where he (peace be upon him) is buried for it is indeed better than the heavens and the earth.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The people brought the fruits to the Prophet (peace be upon him) because they favoured him over themselves and to seek his blessings.

202. Al-Rubayyi' bint Mu'awwidh ibn 'Afrā narrated: "Mu'ādh ibn Afrā sent me with a plate of ripe dates (*rutab*), which had small cucumbers upon it, to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He (peace be upon him) liked cucumbers. I took the plate to him and when I entered on him, I saw jewellery that was sent to him from Bahrain. He took hold of a handful from it and gave it to me." ^[233]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

He (peace be upon him) gave her from the jewellery because it was suitable for women.

Al-Bajūrī said,

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Mu'ādh ibn 'Afrā was the uncle of al-Rubayyi' and he and his brother were the ones who killed Abū Jahl in the battle of Badr.

The jewellery refers to money and pieces of jewellery.

203. Al-Rubayyi' bint Mu'awwidh ibn 'Afrā narrated: "I took a plate of ripe dates (*rutab*) and small cucumbers to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He gifted me with a handful of jewellery, or a handful of gold." ^[234]

CHAPTER THIRTY ONE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE DRINKS OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to describing that which the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to drink and the following chapter will describe the manner in which he used to drink.

204. Aisha narrated: “The drink most liked by the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was that which was sweet and cold.”

[235]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The drink being referred to in this hadīth is water as he (peace be upon him) liked to drink water cold and sweetened. It was referred to as “sweet” because he (peace be upon him) used to like having honey, dates or raisins mixed with the cold water.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Liking the drink to be sweet and cold does not contradict asceticism as it is intended to witness and observe more of the graces of Allāh and accordingly to show sincere gratitude.

Ibn Battal said,

Drinking sweetened water does not contravene asceticism and it is not included in the admonished types of luxury, contrary to scenting the water, not to mention that there is no benefit or virtue in salty water. Allāh made a likeness of the disbeliever

with salty water and of the believer with sweet water: **{And not alike are the two bodies of water. One is fresh and sweet, palatable for drinking, and one is salty and bitter.}**^[236]

Alī al-Qārī said,

It was said that the sweet water mentioned in this hadīth refers to the water mixed with honey because the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not use sugar at all, not to mention that honey is a cure in itself.

205. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “Khālīd ibn al-Walīd and I both accompanied the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) to the house of Maymūnah . There, she presented us with milk in a vessel and the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) drank from it. I was upon his right and Khālīd to his left. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said to me, ‘You possess the right of drinking but if you wish you could give your right to Khālīd.’ I replied that I would not give up his leftovers to anyone else. After that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Whenever Allāh feeds someone anything, the following supplication should be recited, ‘*O Allāh grant us blessings in it, and feed us something better than it,*’ and whenever Allāh gives someone milk to drink one should read, ‘*O Allāh grant us blessing in it and increase it for us.*’ Then, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) added, ‘There is nothing that serves the place of both food and drink except for milk.’”

Al-Tirmidhī said: “Maymūnah bint al-Hārith is the wife of the Messenger of Allāh and the maternal aunt of Ibn Abbās and Khālīd ibn al-Walīd.”^[237]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth shows that the one to the right of the person has more right to be served first than the one on the left. It also

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shows that it is permissible for the one on the right to give his right to the person on the left.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Sunnah of giving preference to the one on the right applies to food, drink, clothing etc. The Prophet (peace be upon him) explained that Ibn Abbās had the right to drink first because he was on the right side but as Khālīd was older than Ibn Abbās and a leader in his tribe as well as being a new Muslim at that time, he informed Ibn Abbās that he could give Khālīd this right to show Khālīd that he was not being disrespected or overlooked.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The response of Ibn Abbās began with the excuse of not wanting to give that right to anyone so that it would not give the impression that he was refusing to comply.

CHAPTER THIRTY TWO

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE MANNER IN WHICH THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH DRANK

206. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) drank Zamzam water whilst standing.” ^[238]

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in drinking was to drink whilst sitting down and it is proven authentic that he forbade people to drink while they are standing but at the same time it is proven authentic that he drank while he was standing. Some scholars reconciled between the two, stating that the latter abrogated the former, and other scholars stated that the order not to drink while standing was to show that it is not the best thing to do, and some scholars said that there is no need for reconciliation at all as he drank while he was standing because the situation required that. This was because, as he (peace be upon him) arrived at the well of Zamzam, people were drinking and he was handed a bottle of Zamzam water.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason he (peace be upon him) drank while he was standing was to show that this is permissible as he ordered people [at an earlier point] to only drink while they are sitting down.

207. ‘Abdullāh ibn Amr related: “I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) drink while he was sitting and also whilst stood.” ^[239]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This indicates that he (peace be upon him) drank while he was sitting many times and he drank while he was standing one time to display its permissibility. The known practice of him (peace be upon him) was to drink while he was sitting.

208. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “I gave the Prophet (peace be upon him) Zamzam water to drink, so he drank it while he was standing.” ^[240]

209. Al-Nazzāl ibn Sabrah related: “Water in a clay pot was brought to Alī ibn Abī Tālib whilst he was in the courtyard of the masjid. He took a handful from this water and used it to wash his hands. Then he rinsed his mouth, sniffed the water to clean his nose and washed his face, forearms and head. Thereafter, he stood and drank from it. He then said, ‘This is the ablution of a person who is already in a state of purity. I have observed the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) perform it so.’” ^[241]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth describes how to renew the ablution without being in a state of impurity. This ablution is intended for cleansing and not to remove the state of ritual impurity.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The relevant part in this hadīth is that he (peace be upon him) drank the water whilst he was standing.

Alī al-Qārī said,

In another version it added, “And he washed his feet.”

210. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) drank water from the vessel in three breaths (i.e.

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in three sips) and used to say, 'It is more pleasing and thirst quenching in this manner.'" ^[242]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The practice that is admonished is to breathe in the bottle or vessel and then drink because this changes the nature of the water in addition to the benefits mentioned in this hadīth. It is also admonished to drink the contents of the vessel all at once because the Prophet (peace be upon him) stated it is the way Shaytān drinks, not to mention that this could cause the person to choke and block the throat.

211. 'Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) drank water in two breaths." ^[243]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth is not an explicit evidence that he (peace be upon him) drank water in two breaths because it is possible that the narrator did not count the last breath, which is bound to happen by default, and only described the two pauses that happened while drinking.

212. Kabshah bint Thābit narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) once visited me at home and he drank while he was standing from a leather water bag that was suspended. Then, I got up and cut out the mouth [part] of the bag." ^[244]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Kabshah bint Thābit is the sister of Hassan ibn Thābit, the poet of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Him (peace be upon him) drinking while standing shows that his order not to drink while standing was to refer to it as disliked and not forbidden.

She cut out the mouth part of the bag after he (peace be upon him) drank from it in order to preserve the place where the Prophet (peace be upon him) placed his mouth upon and to keep it for seeking its blessings.

213. Thumāmah ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “Anas ibn Mālīk used to drink water in three breaths, and he stated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) drank water in the same manner.” ^[245]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows how keen the companions were to follow the Sunnah and adhere to the manners and etiquettes of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

214. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) once visited Umm Salīm at her home and he drank while he was standing, from a leather water bag that was suspended. Then, she got up and cut out the mouth [part] of the bag.” ^[246]

215. Sa’d ibn Abī Waqqās narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to drink whilst standing.”

Al-Bajūrī said,

Sa’d ibn Abī Waqqās was one of the ten people who were given the glad tidings of Paradise, the first person in Islām who shot an arrow in a battle and he witnessed all the battles [of his time], so he was called the Knight of Islām.

As it was explained, the common practice of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was to drink while he was sitting and on some rare occasions he drank while standing.

CHAPTER THIRTY THREE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE PERFUME OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to describing the guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in respect to perfume.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) liked applying perfume and he always wore it. His scent was the best and the scent of his perspiration was even better than that of perfume.

Al-Bajūrī said,

It is more emphasised for men to wear perfume on Fridays, days of Eid, when entering the state of *ihram*, when intending to pray in congregation, when attending gatherings, reciting the Qur'ān, learning and teaching knowledge, remembrance of Allāh. It is also recommended for the husband and wife to perfume themselves before being intimate.

216. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had a container that he would apply perfume from.” ^[247]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Sukkah refers here to the perfume bottle based on the context of the hadīth though one of its meanings is a perfume that is made of a mixture of elements.

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217. Thumāmah ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “Anas ibn Mālik never refused accepting perfume whenever it was offered and he narrated that, ‘The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never refused perfume whenever it was offered to him.’” ^[248]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Anas ibn Mālik never rejected perfume to follow the example of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The reason why he (peace be upon him) never rejected an offering of perfume was because it is light in weight and has a good smell.

Abū Bakr ibn al-‘Arabī said,

The reason why he (peace be upon him) never rejected an offering of perfume was because he liked it and needed it more than anyone else as he was always receiving revelation from his Lord.

218. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Three things should not be refused: cushions (pillows), incense and milk.’” ^[249]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth can be understood in two ways: that these gifts are not refused to avoid the gift giver feeling hurt by the rejection and this is the apparent meaning, or that the guest should not refuse any of these three things when the host offers them.

This applies to all that which people do not consider a favour conferred upon others i.e. it applies to all items and gifts that do not cause the recipient to feel like he will owe a favour to the individual who gifted him.

Al-Suyūṭī said,

The Sunnah is to accept and not to refuse seven things when they are offered: sweets, milk, incense, cushions, provision given to a person in need, perfume and basil.

219. Abū Hurairah narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said: ‘The perfume of men is that which possesses a fragrance that spreads yet is colourless, and the perfume of women is that which has a colour yet its fragrance does not spread.’” ^[250]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Qatādah said that scholars understood the perfume prescribed for women in this hadīth as that which she wears when she wants to go outside her house, and she can wear any type of perfume she wants when she is with her husband. It was reported that Abū Musah narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said, “The eye is liable to commit adultery; and the woman who wears perfume and then passes by people, she is considered an adulteress.”^[251]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The perfume of men is of types such as musk, rosewater and camphor and the perfume of women is of types such as sandalwood.

220. Abū Hurairah narrated a similar report. ^[252]

221. Abū Uthmān al-Nahdī narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘If one is given fragrance of basil, he should not refuse it, because it originated from Paradise.’” ^[253]

Al-Qadī ‘Iyyād said,

I find it possible to interpret the use of basil here in this context to refer to all types of perfume.

Al-Nawawī said,

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This hadīth shows that it is disliked to refuse fragrance of basil unless there is a reason to reject it (i.e. a person cannot handle its smell etc.).

Alī al-Qārī said,

The original seed of basil is from Paradise. Allāh has created the good scents in this worldly life to remind His creation of the scents of the Hereafter. This is to make them want to enter Paradise and thus increase in good deeds.

222. Jarīr ibn ‘Abdullāh related that he was presented to ‘Umar ibn al-Khattāb and then he threw off his top cloak and walked in his izār only. ‘Umar told him to take his top and put it back on and then addressed the people saying, “I have not seen anyone more handsome than Jarīr except what has been reported to us about Yūsuf.” ^[254]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason Jarīr was presented to ‘Umar and was asked to take his top off was so ‘Umar could check if he was physically fit to join the army.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Jarīr was known for his inability to remain on the back of the horse until the Prophet (peace be upon him) hit him on his chest and asked Allāh to rid him of this fault. This incident happened forty nights before the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him). He took off his upper garment to show his strength and skills.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The reason why this hadīth was included in this chapter though it does not mention anything regarding perfume was to hint that being good looking necessitates smelling good as well.

It is known that there is no one more handsome than the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the statement of 'Umar was said in respect to the physical build of Jarīr, since he made that statement after Jarīr took off his top cloak.

CHAPTER THIRTY FOUR

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE SPEECH OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to describing how the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to talk.

223. Aisha related: “The speech of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was not fast paced as that of yours. He spoke clearly, enunciating each word slowly so that anyone sitting with him would remember what he said.” ^[255]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows that due to his eloquence and concise use of words, anyone sitting with him would easily remember all that he (peace be upon him) said.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Enunciating each word slowly ensures the clearness of the sentence and it leaves no room for doubts. It also helps the listener memorise that which he has heard.

224. Anas ibn Mālik related: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to repeat a word thrice, in order that they (his listeners) could understand what was said correctly.” ^[256]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

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The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to repeat the word or the sentence for a variety of reasons: to ensure he had the attention of the people, to ensure the audience understood the meaning or when the audience was increasing around him, to ensure everybody heard what he said. This exhibits the perfection of his compassion and mercy for his nation.

Based on this hadīth, it is recommended for the teacher to talk slowly and repeat his words to ensure the audience understands him.

225. Al-Hasan ibn Alī narrated: “I asked my maternal uncle Hind ibn Abī Hālah, who was known as one who would describe the features of the Prophet (peace be upon him), to describe to me the manner in which the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) spoke. He replied, ‘The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was in a continual state of worry, constantly thoughtful and his mind was never at rest.

He would remain silent for long periods and he would not speak without need. He used to begin and end his speech with the name of Allāh, and his speech was concise yet comprehensive. He kept pauses between each sentence and word he uttered. There was no exaggeration in his speech, nor was there deficiency. He was not rude or unkind, nor did he disgrace anyone. He always glorified and appreciated the blessings of Allāh, and he never criticised food or drink even when it might be very minute. He did not criticise food, nor over-praise it. He was never angered for anything worldly. However if someone transgressed the limits in religious matters, he would not calm down until he avenged it. He neither became angry for a personal matter nor avenged for himself.

If he wanted to make a gesture or point at something, he would do so with his full hand. Whenever he was surprised by something, he turned his hands upside down, and when he spoke he moved his hands. He would hit the palm of his right

hand with the inside part of his left thumb. When he became angry with someone, he would direct his attention away from that person. When he was happy he would gaze down. The laugh of his was mostly a smile and at that moment his front teeth glittered like shining hailstones piercing the clouds.” ^[257]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth is not authentic and it has some parts that are questionable. This is also the view of Ibn al-Qayyim.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The state of worry refers to his constant fear of Allāh and this is a common trait of all Prophets. However, in public he used to maintain a smile on his face for the people, to soften their hearts.

He glorified and appreciated the blessings of Allāh, those which are hidden, those which are apparent and those which are related to this world and the Hereafter. He did that by praising Allāh with his tongue and using these blessings in obeying Him.

Ibn Taymiyyah said,

The state of worry mentioned is intended to mean that he was always alert and attentive to what he received and this involves the heart and the eyes whilst silence and thoughtfulness involve the tongue and the heart. It is factual that he was never worried or concerned about a worldly matter.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

He (peace be upon him) never rested because he was always busy in good deeds. He started and ended his speeches with the name of Allāh, meaning he started with the *Bismillah* and ended them with *Alhamdulillah* or *Astaghfirullah*. This was with the intention of making his speeches engulfed with the blessings of His Name.

Alī al-Qārī said,

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He (peace be upon him) never became angry for a worldly matter, following the divine order: **{And do not extend your eyes toward that by which We have given enjoyment to [some] categories of them, [its being but] the splendour of worldly life by which We test them. And the provision of your Lord is better and more enduring.}**^[258]

He neither became angry for a personal matter nor avenged for himself as he always encountered insult with forbearance, and harm with forgiveness, following the divine order: **{Enjoin what is good, and turn away from the ignorant.}**^[259]

He pointed out using his full hand because pointing out with some fingers is from the acts of the arrogant.

CHAPTER THIRTY FIVE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE LAUGHTER OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in respect to laughing was to be moderate just as he was moderate in all of his affairs. On most occasions, his laugh was just a smile and if he laughed audibly, he would not laugh boisterously.

226. Jābir ibn Samurah narrated: “The legs of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) were slightly thin. His laugh was only that of a smile. Every time I looked at him, I would think that kohl had been applied to his eyes even though it hadn’t.”

[260]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The slight thinness in his legs befitted the structure of his body and so it is a characteristic that people praise.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The statement that ‘his laugh was only that of a smile’ does not mean that he never laughed but rather it is to state that most of the time he used to smile. This is because it was reported that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) laughed until his molars showed. Some scholars offered a nice explanation to highlight the difference between the reasons that made him laugh and the reasons that made him smile. This explanation is that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) smiled in

matters related to this worldly life and laughed in matters related to the Hereafter.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The eyelashes of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) were dark enough to give the impression that he had applied kohl.

227. ‘Abdullāh ibn al-Hārith narrated: “I never saw a person who smiled more than the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).” ^[261]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This is a characteristic that indicates his perfection as he used to smile in the face of people despite the feelings of concern regarding the Hereafter that he concealed in his heart.

228. ‘Abdullāh ibn al-Hārith narrated: “The laughter of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was naught but a smile.” ^[262]

229. Abū Dhar narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘I know the person who will enter Paradise first and also the last person to be taken out of the Hellfire. On the Day of Judgment, a person will be brought forward and then it shall be commanded that all the minor sins of that person be put forward to him and the major sins be concealed. Then, it will be said to him, ‘On such a day you did this and on such a day you did this.’ He will attest to this without protest whilst being filled with anxiety due to the pending disclosure of his major sins. Then, it shall be commanded that for every sin of that person he be given a good deed. Upon hearing this, the person says, ‘I still have many sins left to account for, that I do not find here.’”

Abū Dhar related: “By Allāh, I saw the Messenger (peace be upon him) laughing [because of the response of the person] until his molar teeth began to show.” ^[263]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The first person who will enter Paradise is the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and the last person who is taken out from the Hellfire will be the last person to enter Paradise, leaving behind in the Hellfire all those who will remain there forever. The ones who will remain there forever are the disbelievers because the sinners amongst the believers will eventually leave Hell.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The story of the person in the hadīth is separate from the statement wherein he (peace be upon him) mentioned the first and last person to enter Paradise.

The reason that he was given a good deed for every misdeed is because Allāh, the Most High, said: **{Except for those who repent, believe and do righteous work. For them Allāh will replace their evil deeds with good. And ever is Allāh Forgiving and Merciful.}** ^[264]

The reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) laughed was because he was astonished [at what this man will be granted]. The man was anxious at first because he feared his major sins being exposed but after he saw that his minor sins turned into good deeds, he started looking forward to seeing his major sins too. Abū Dhar swore that he saw the Prophet (peace be upon him) laughing so no one doubts his statement since he (peace be upon him) was known for smiling and not laughing.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The response of the man was because he was overwhelmed with the great Mercy that Allāh bestowed upon him so he wanted to

find more sins hoping that they will be replaced with good deeds too.

230. Jarīr ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “From the day I accepted Islām, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never prevented me from entering upon him and every time he saw me, he would laugh.” ^[265]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Jarīr ibn ‘Abdullāh embraced Islām forty days before the death of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Jarīr ibn ‘Abdullāh’s statement was to say that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never prevented him from entering upon him when he was with his close companions. This shows the special status of Jarīr.

231. Jarīr ibn ‘Abdullāh narrated: “From the day I accepted Islām, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never prevented me from entering upon him and every time he saw me, he would smile.” ^[266]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth explains that the meaning intended with ‘laughing’ mentioned in the previous hadīth referred to smiling i.e. he (peace be upon him) used to smile whenever he saw Jarīr.

232. ‘Abdullāh ibn Mas’ūd narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘I know the last of the people of Hell to be brought forth, and the last of the people of Paradise to enter therein. It will be a man who will emerge crawling from Hell, and Allāh, may He be blessed and exalted, will say to him, ‘Go and enter Paradise.’ He will come to it and it will appear to him to be full. He will go back and say, ‘O Lord, I found it full.’ Allāh, may He be blessed and exalted, will say to him, ‘Do you

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remember your time before [on Earth]?' The man answers, 'Yes, I do.' Allāh, may He be blessed and exalted, will say to him, 'Make a wish,' and so the man makes a wish and then Allāh, the Most High, says to him, 'You will have that which you wished and ten times as much.' He will say, 'Are You mocking me – or laughing at me – yet You are the Sovereign?'"

'Abdullāh ibn Mas'ūd said: "And I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) laugh so that his molars appeared." [267]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The statement of the man, "Are You mocking me – or laughing at me – when You are the King and Sovereign," was said due to the overwhelming surprise felt by the man. This made him unaware of his words in a similar manner to the incident reported in the hadīth of the man who lost all of his provisions and his camel and then awaited death as he was in the middle of desert. When he saw that his camel had returned, he said out of overwhelming surprise, "O Lord, you are my slave and I am your Lord!" [268]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason the man returned after he reached Paradise was because his thought process was according to the rules of this worldly life, his understanding caused him to believe that Paradise only accommodates a specific number of people and so it was full.

Allāh, the Most High, asked the man to make a wish in order to show him that the rules of the worldly life do not apply to Paradise, and thus he could wish for what he likes.

233. Alī ibn Rabī'a narrated: "I was present when an animal (i.e. a horse or a donkey) was brought to Alī ibn Abī Tālib. When he put his feet on the stirrup, he recited 'Bismillah' and after he had mounted he said 'Alhamdulillah' and supplicated: 'Subhān Allāh, He who has subjected this to us, and we could not have [otherwise] subdued it. And indeed we, to our Lord, will

[surely] return. Alhamdulillah, Alhamdulillah, Alhamdulillah, Allāhu Akbar, Allāhu Akbar, Allāhu Akbar. Subhānak, I have wronged myself so forgive me as no one can forgive me save You.' Then, he laughed and I asked him, 'O Chief of Believers! What is the reason for laughing?' He replied, 'The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) also supplicated in this manner and thereafter laughed (smiled). I inquired from him the reason for laughing. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Allāh, the Most High, becomes pleased when His servants say, 'My Lord, forgive my sins. No one can forgive sins save You.'" ^[269]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Bismillah is recited to mean, "By the blessings of the name of Allāh I mount." The basis for saying *bismillah* when mounting is from the statement of Nūh when he mounted the ship as reported in the Qur'ān.

The reason for saying after mounting, "*and indeed we, to our Lord, will surely return,*" is because a person may fall off and die and so the statement is to remind the person that he will return to Allāh. It is for this reason that it is recommended for a person who takes a means that could lead to death (translator's note: such as driving cars, taking trains, flying on airplanes etc.) to repent and turn to Allāh during the trip.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The praise is said to praise Allāh, the Most High, for the blessing of having a means of transport.

The statement, 'Exalted be He' is to reflect on how the strong horse and camel is tamed to serve the humans who have weak bodies when compared to these animals.

Repeating the praise three times is to show one's gratitude for the blessing and repeating *Allāhu Akbar* is to glorify the perfection of Allāh manifested in His creation.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

"I have wronged myself so forgive me," is said to acknowledge one's shortcomings as opposed to the blessings that one has been granted. Thus, with all these blessings it befits that one asks for Allāh's forgiveness.

234. 'Āmir ibn al-Aswad narrated from Sa'd ibn Abī Waqqās that: "[Sa'd said] 'The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) laughed on the day of the Battle of the Trench until his teeth showed.' I asked Sa'd, 'What caused him to laugh?' He replied, 'A disbeliever had a shield, and Sa'd was an archer. He was swaying the shield from side to side to protect his forehead, whilst making derogatory remarks. Sa'd took an arrow and kept it ready in the bow. When the disbeliever exposed his head, he quickly aimed at his forehead and did not miss the target. The enemy immediately fell down with his legs rising into the air. On that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) laughed until his molar teeth were displayed.' I asked, 'Why did the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) laugh?' He replied, 'Because of what Sa'd did to the man.'" ^[270]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) laughed because he was happy that an enemy of Allāh was killed and not because of how the man fell down. This was because that disbeliever caused a lot of harm.

CHAPTER THIRTY SIX

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE SENSE OF HUMOUR OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The jokes of the Prophet (peace be upon him) were always truthful and intended to bring forth affability. He joked with his companions only according to the need. For this reason, one should be moderate in his sense of humour and refrain from insulting and mocking others.

Al-Nawawi said,

The forbidden type of joking is that which is immoderate and highly frequent for this hardens the heart and makes laughing a habit of the person, distracting the individual from the remembrance of Allāh and the religious obligations. Not to mention that excessive joking can often lead to hurting the feelings of others, thereby inducing hatred and compromising one's dignity and respect before the people. If the joke is free of all these defects, then it is the lawful joking that the Prophet (peace be upon him) did.

235. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) once called me, ‘O two eared one!’” ^[271]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The statement of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) to Anas was to joke with him and it shows his humbleness as he joked with his servant.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The statement of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was said to praise Anas for being an attentive listener who understands the words he hears accurately. The humorous aspect of the statement is that it gives the impression that the person possesses no sense except for that which emanates from the ears.

236. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to mix with us (i.e. me and my family) to the extent that he said to my younger brother, ‘Abū Umayr, what happened to the Nughayr?’”

Al-Tirmidhī said: “This hadīth shows that the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to joke with others and that it is allowed to give young children birds to play with.” ^[272]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Al-Nughayr is a type of bird and the Prophet (peace be upon him) used a *kunya* to call the young child to bring joy to his heart as he knew that his bird had died.

Al-Baghawī said, “This hadīth shows that it is allowed to rhyme if it is natural and intended.”

The *fiqh* of this hadīth is:

- It is allowed to have birds in a cage to enjoy their colour or play with so long as they are fed and looked after.
- It is allowed to call children with a *kunya* (i.e. the father of so and so).
- It is allowed to joke so long as the joke does not involve sins.
- It shows the kind manners and compassion of the Prophet (peace be upon him).
- It is from the recommended good manners to look after the vulnerable ones and bring happiness to their hearts.

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237. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The companions said, 'O Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him)! Verily, you joke with us!' He said, 'Yes, except I do not say but the truth.'" ^[273]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) joked but his jokes did not include anything unlawful as all of his statements were truthful.

238. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "A man requested from the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) a means of transport. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'I will give you the baby of a camel to ride.' The man said, 'O Messenger of Allāh! What shall I do with the baby camel?' He replied, '[Do you not know that] every camel is the baby of a camel?'" ^[274]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The response of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to the reaction of the man teaches us that one should contemplate the words he hears and not rush to respond and reject a statement or offering until after it is understood well.

239. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "There was a resident of the desert whose name was Zāhir, whenever he visited the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) he brought with him a present to give to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and when he intended to leave Madīnah, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to present him with provisions of the city. Once the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Zāhir is our desert, and we are his city.' The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had a strong bond with him though he had an unpleasant appearance. One day, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) approached him while he was selling his merchandise in the market and caught him in between the arms from the back in such a manner that he could not be seen. Zāhir said, 'Who is this? Let me go.' But when

he turned and saw with the corner of his eye that it was the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), he straightened his back and began pressing it to the chest of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). The Prophet (peace be upon him) then said, 'Who will purchase this slave?' Zāhir replied, 'O Messenger of Allāh, if you shall sell me, you will be selling something defective.' The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) replied, 'No, you are not defective in the sight of Allāh, but very valuable.'" ^[275]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Zāhir used to gift the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) from the items that the Bedouins used to make such as dry milk, ghee etc. In return, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to reciprocate with a better gift when Zāhir wanted to leave Madīnah.

The statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) that, "Zāhir is our desert and we are his city" was to show that both sets of people complete each other as the people in the desert need the ones in the city and the people in the city need the ones living in the desert.

This hadīth shows that joking is not limited to words but can also include action as can be seen from the act of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) when he held Zāhir from the back.

The reason Anas mentioned Zāhir's appearance was to clarify the reason why Zāhir described himself as defective merchandise that no one would want to buy.

The statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to Zāhir shows the virtue of this companion and at the same time goes in line with the other hadīth, "Allāh does not look at your image and wealth, rather He looks at your deeds and hearts." ^[276] The virtue of a person depends on his piety and not his physical appearance.

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240. Al-Hasan al-Basrī narrated: “An old woman came to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and said, ‘O Messenger of Allāh! Ask Allāh to grant me entrance into Paradise.’ The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) replied, ‘O mother of so and so! No old women will enter Paradise.’ The woman started crying and began to leave. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Say to the woman that she will not enter Paradise in a state of old age. Allāh says: {Lo! We have created them a [new] creation and made them virgins, lovers, equal in age.}[277]’” [278]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was intended to teach the woman in a humorous manner that old women will be created new and their age when they enter Paradise will be thirty three as stated in the hadīth reported by Mu’ādh ibn Jabal and documented in the Musnad of Imām Ahmad.

CHAPTER THIRTY SEVEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE LINES OF POETRY SAID BY THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Poetry takes the same ruling as any other speech: that which is good is allowed and can be recited, but that which is otherwise, it is not allowed to recite it or listen to it. The Prophet (peace be upon him) said that some poetry contains wisdom. This shows that not all poetry is good; hence you find poetry that encourages sins, innovation and superstition, and some that encourages guidance and promotes the truth.

241. Aisha was asked: “Did the Prophet (peace be upon him) quote from poetry that which he used as a proverb?” She replied: “He recited a line of poetry of ‘Abdullāh ibn Rawāhah but without following its structure and rhyme. He recited this couplet of his, ‘News is brought to you by a person whom you have not compensated.’” ^[279]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It was narrated that the most disliked of speech to him (peace be upon him) was poetry but he would quote some proverbs taken from poetry on occasion. Such as when he recited a line of poetry of the brother of Qais ibn Turfah whilst changing the order of the words i.e. he did not follow the order of words in the line so he said, “News is brought to you by a person whom you have not compensated.” Abū Bakr said, “O Messenger of Allāh! The couplet is not as you have recited!” The Messenger of

Allāh (peace be upon him) replied, "I am not a poet." Meaning that he only intended to mention the message of the words and not to recite the poem.

‘Abdullāh ibn Rawāhah was one of the poets who defended the Prophet (peace be upon him) but the most active influential poets who defended him were Ka'b ibn Mālīk and Hassan ibn Thābit.

242. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'The most truthful statement said by a poet is that of Labīd, 'Indeed, be aware, everything besides Allāh is false.' Umayyah ibn Abī al-Salt was close to accepting Islām.'" [280]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Labīd ibn Rabiash al-‘Amirī was one of the renowned poets, he embraced Islām and did not recite any poetry from that point on as he said, "The Qur’ān suffices me."

The meaning of the line is that everything else besides Allāh is doomed to perish.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The reason he (peace be upon him) described these words as being the most truthful statement a poet has ever said was because the statement conforms to the ayah: **{Everything will be destroyed except His Face}** [281] and this is the core of monotheism.

Umayyah ibn Abī al-Salt was a poet whose poems conformed to the tenets of Islām and he believed in the Resurrection and was a worshipper but he did not embrace Islām, though he died after the emergence of Islām.

243. Jundub ibn Sufyān narrated: "Once a rock fell upon the toe of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and caused it to bleed. Thereupon, he recited this couplet, 'You are but a toe that has bled. This is not fruitless, for reward has been obtained in the path of Allāh.'" [282]

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Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The bleeding was caused by the toe of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) hitting a stone while he was walking. This hadīth is evidence that the Muslim is rewarded for every difficulty and test he goes through if he shows patience and seeks the reward of Allāh.

244. The same is reported through another route. ^[283]

245. A man asked al-Barā ibn Āzib: “O Abū ‘Umārah! Did you all flee the battle?” He replied, “No, not all of us. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did not turn away but [some] people in the army were hasty [to collect the spoils of war] and so the people of the tribe of Hawāzin began to shower arrows [on their heads]. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was upon a mule and Abū Sufyān ibn Al-Hārith ibn Abdul Muttalib was leading it by its reins. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was reciting the following couplet, ‘Verily, I am the Prophet, and it is no lie. I am from the children [grandsons] of Abdul Muttalib.’” ^[284]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The answer of al-Barā that not everyone fled the battle on that day required him to state that he (peace be upon him) did not turn away to show that the major companions remained with him too. However, al-Barā did not use the term “flee” when talking about the Prophet (peace be upon him) to avoid attributing him with such an ugly defective characteristic. This is because it is forbidden to describe him with such a trait and it would nullify one’s Islām to call him as such if he intends to degrade him, and if no degrading is intended then the person deserves severe punishment according al-Shāfi’ī and deserves the death penalty according to Imām Mālik. This is because the term “turn away” can be used to show that the person is

changing his tactics whereas the term “flee” necessitates cowardice and fear.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The hasty ones refer to those in whose hearts Islām was not established deeply such as the new Muslims, those who embraced Islām after the conquest of Makkah and those like them.

The battle referred to here is the battle of Hunayn, which happened after the conquest of Makkah when the tribes of Hawāzin and Thaḳīf agreed to unite to fight the Muslims. In light of this, the Prophet (peace be upon him) led a force of ten thousand persons from Madīnah and two thousand from those who embraced Islām after Makkah was conquered (who are the ones who the Prophet (peace be upon him) freed on that day) and eighty disbelievers, including Safwan ibn Umayyah as he (peace be upon him) borrowed one hundred shields from him to use in the battle.

This battle was amongst the toughest that the Prophet (peace be upon him) participated in because after some of the army fled, the Prophet (peace be upon him) asked al-Abbās to call the Ansār and those who gave the pledge under the tree, and his voice was heard from the distance of eight miles, upon which the army returned to the battle swiftly. Then, after they engaged in the fight and it became extremely heated, the Prophet (peace be upon him) picked up some pebbles from the ground and threw them in the air and said, “May their faces be deformed!” Subsequently, the pebbles entered the eyes of the disbelievers and the Muhajirūn and Ansār engaged in the battle fiercely, causing the disbelievers to flee the battle and be defeated.

Angels fought alongside the Muslims in the battle of Badr and the battle of Hunayn only, where in the latter they wore red turbans.

The reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) was riding his white mule although he had horses and riding a mule in the

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battle is not suitable for engagement, was to show the Muslims that victory was guaranteed from Allāh so that their hearts would be filled with tranquillity and they would return to the battle. This action of the Prophet (peace be upon him) shows his great courage and bravery.

The meaning of the couplet is that he is truthfully the Prophet (peace be upon him) and thus he will not run away and will not be defeated, and it is no lie because a Prophet does not lie and so he was certain of victory.

246. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) entered Makkah for Umratul Qadā while ‘Abdullāh ibn Rawāhah was walking ahead of him reciting these couplets:

**O non-believers clear his path and leave today,
For today we shall strike you upon his arrival,
Such a strike that we will separate the head from its body,
And will cause a friend to forget his friend.**

‘Umar said, ‘O Ibn Rawāhah! How do you recite poetry in the presence of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and in the Sacred House of Allāh?’ The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘O ‘Umar, leave him! These couplets have more impact than showering arrows onto them.’” ^[285]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The statement of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) shows that poetry scares the enemy and troubles them, strengthening the believers to avert the harm of the disbelievers and protect the religion of Allāh.

Alī al-Qārī said,

Umratul Qadā refers to the Umrah that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) wanted to make up as he could not perform it due to the truce signed between the Muslims and disbelievers on the day of Hudaibiyyah that made the Muslims agree not to

perform Umrah on that day. This is evidence that if a person intended to perform Umrah or Hajj and after entering the state *ihrām* could not continue it, he should make it up.

The couplets were said after the day of Hudaibiyyah to celebrate this victory of the Muslims and to threaten the disbelievers of what will happen to them should they breach the truce.

The reason behind the statement of 'Umar was because he thought poetry was condemned in all cases as he read it in the Qur'ān and heard it from the Messenger of Allāh . The response of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was to show that not all poetry is condemned and admonished.

247. Jābir ibn Samurah narrated: "I sat with the Prophet (peace be upon him) more than a hundred times. His companions would recite poetry and relate certain stories from the days of Jāhiliyyah. The Prophet (peace be upon him) listened to them silently and at times he smiled with them." ^[286]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The reason he mentioned the number of times was to assure the listener that the statement he was about to narrate was true.

Al-Bajūrī said,

This hadīth teaches us that it is allowed to recite poetry and listen to it even if it includes mentioning the days before Islām and events, on the condition that it has nothing that is considered as disliked or unlawful in religion.

248. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said: "The best couplet that the Arabs ever recited is that of Labīd, 'Indeed, be aware, everything besides Allāh is false.'" ^[287]

249. Amr ibn Sharīd reported that his father said: "I once rode behind the Prophet (peace be upon him). I recited for him one

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hundred couplets of Umayyah ibn Salt's poetry. After reciting each couplet, he asked me to continue until I recited a hundred couplets. In the end, he said, 'He (Umayyah) came close to accepting Islām.'" ^[288]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The liking that the Prophet (peace be upon him) took to the poetry of Umayyah and his request to hear more of it is evidence that poetry is recommended if it includes affirmation of Allāh's Oneness and fine gems and wisdoms.

Al-Bajūrī said,

It is said that Umayyah is the famous poet Umayyah ibn Abī al-Salt al-Thaqafī who Allāh revealed an ayah regarding: **{And recite to them, [O Muhammad], the news of him to whom we gave [knowledge of] Our signs, but he detached himself from them; so Satan pursued him, and he became of the deviators.}** ^[289] He read the Torah and the Bible before the emergence of Islām, and knew that a prophet would appear. However, he desired for himself to be that prophet and that was the reason why he rejected the Prophet (peace be upon him) and caused him to envy him and disbelieve.

The statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was said after he heard the content of the poem as it included words indicating monotheism and good wisdom.

250. Aisha narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) would place something high in the Masjid for Hassan ibn Thābit, so that he could stand upon it and recite poetry praising the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) (or it was said: defending the Messenger of Allāh). He (peace be upon him) would say, 'Verily, Allāh aids Hassan with the Rūh al-Quds as long as he defends or praises the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).'" ^[290]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Rūh al-Quds (the Holy Spirit) refers to Jibra'īl and he was referred to as the “spirit” because the spirit (soul) brings life to the heart and because he is the one who delivers the revelations that provide eternal life to the Prophets.

He (Hassan) defended the Prophet (peace be upon him) in response to the false accusations and abuse of the disbelievers.

251. Aisha reported a similar hadīth through a different route.

CHAPTER THIRTY EIGHT

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE CONVERSATIONS OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH AT NIGHT

252. Aisha reported: “One night, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) related an [astonishing] story to his wives. One of his wives commented, ‘This story is as astonishing as the stories of Khurāfah.’ The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Do you know the original story of Khurāfah? He was a man from the tribe of ‘Udhrah, whom the Jinn kidnapped. They kept him for a long time, and then they returned him to the people. He began to relate the wonders and strange things that he saw during his stay with them. Thenceforth, the people began to call every story that was incredible or too much for the mind to handle, a story of Khurāfah.’” ^[291]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Khurāfah is the name of a man who was kidnapped by the Jinn during the pre-Islamic era and after some time they brought him back to the people. He used to relate strange stories about matters that people had never heard of or saw in their lifetimes, which made them feel astonished. From that time, it became a proverb to describe any unbelievable story as being a story of Khurāfah.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The purpose of the Prophet (peace be upon him) entertaining his wives at night was to make them happy and show them kindness. As for the hadīths concerning disallowing talking after praying *Ishā*, they refer to the talk that has no benefit in it.

253. 'Aisha reported:

[One day] there sat together eleven women making an explicit promise amongst themselves that they would conceal nothing about their spouses.

The first one said, "My husband is like the meat of a lean, weak camel which is kept on the top of a mountain which is neither easy to climb, nor is the meat fat, so that one might put up with the trouble of fetching it."

The second one said, "I shall not relate my husband's news, for I fear that I may not be able to finish his story, for if I describe him, I will mention all of his defects and bad traits."

The third one said, "My husband is a tall man [who is useless due to being thick-headed and ill-mannered]; if I describe him [and he hears of that] he will divorce me, and if I keep quiet, he will neither divorce me nor treat me as a wife."

The fourth one said, "My husband is a moderate person like the night of Tihāma which is neither hot nor cold. I am neither afraid of him, nor am I discontented with him."

The fifth one said, "My husband, when entering [the house] is a leopard, and when he is outside he is a lion. He does not ask about the state of his home."

The sixth one said, "If my husband eats, he eats too much [leaving the dishes empty], and if he drinks he leaves nothing, and if he sleeps he sleeps alone [away from me] covered in garments and he does not stretch his hands to avoid touching my body as he may see my grief."

The seventh one said, "My husband is an impotent wrong-doer, weak and foolish. All the defects are present in him. He may injure your head, your body or may do both."

The eighth one said, "My husband is soft to the touch like a rabbit and smells like a *zarnab* (a kind of good smelling grass)."

The ninth one said, "My husband is a tall generous man wearing a long strap for carrying his sword. His ashes are abundant and his house is near to the people who can easily consult him."

The tenth one said, "My husband is Mālik, and what is Mālik? Mālik is greater than whatever I say about him. He is beyond and above all praises which can come to my mind. Most of his camels are kept at home [ready to be slaughtered for the guests] and only a few are taken to the pastures. When the camels hear the sound of the lute (or the tambourine) they realise that they are going to be slaughtered for the guests."

The eleventh one said, "My husband is Abū Zar and what is Abū Zar (i.e. what should I say about him)? He has given me many ornaments and my ears are heavily loaded with them and my arms have become fat (i.e. I have become fat). And he has pleased me, and I have become so happy that I feel proud of myself. He found me with my family who were mere owners of sheep and living in poverty, and brought me to a respected family having horses, camels, threshing and purifying grain. Whatever I say, he does not rebuke or insult me. When I sleep, I sleep till late in the morning, and when I drink water (or milk), I drink to my fill. The mother of Abū Zar, what could one say in praise of the mother of Abū Zar? Her saddle bags were always full of provision and her house was spacious. As for the son of Abū Zar, what could one say about the son of Abū Zar? His bed is as narrow as an unsheathed sword and an arm of a lamb [of four months] satisfies his hunger. As for the daughter of Abū Zar, she is obedient to her father and to her mother. She has a fat, well-built body and that arouses the jealousy of her husband's other wife. As for the slave girl of Abū Zar, what could one say about the slave girl of Abū Zar? She does not disclose our secrets but keeps them, and does not waste our

provisions and does not leave the rubbish scattered everywhere in our house.”

The eleventh woman added, “One day it so happened that Abū Zar went out at the time when the milk was being milked from the animals, and he saw a woman who had two sons like two leopards playing with her two breasts. [On seeing her] he divorced me and married her. Thereafter I married a noble man who used to ride a fast tireless horse and keep a spear in his hand. He gave me many things, and also a pair of every kind of livestock and said, ‘Eat (of this), O Umm Zar, and give provision to your relatives.’” She added, “Yet, all those things which my second husband gave me could not fill the smallest utensil of Abū Zar’s.”

Aisha then said: “Allāh’s Messenger (peace be upon him) said to me, ‘I am to you as Abū Zar was to his wife Umm Zar.’” ^[292]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The author listed this hadīth to show how the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to interact with his wives in a manner that brought joy to their hearts and how he used to give pleasant remarks and comments.

This is a famous hadīth that some scholars dedicated books to due to the many gems and benefits it possesses. From the scholars who covered this hadīth in one book is al-Qadī ‘Iyyād in his book “*Bughyatu al-Ra’id lima Tadamanahu Hadīth Umm Zar’ minal Fawa'id*” and from the scholars who explained this hadīth in depth is al-Hafidh ibn Hajar in his book “*Fathul Bari*”.

CHAPTER THIRTY NINE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE SLEEPING OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Sleeping is one of the great signs of Allāh that indicates Allāh's Oneness, Perfect Power and Arrangement of this Universe. It is a mercy from Allāh to His slaves and one of His favours. Allāh said: **{And of His signs are your sleep by night and day and your seeking of His bounty. Indeed in that are signs for a people who listen.}**^[293] **{And out of His mercy He made for you the night and the day that you may rest therein and [by day] seek from His bounty and [that] perhaps you will be grateful.}**^[294]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Know that he (peace be upon him) used to sleep at the beginning of the night, wake up in the second half of the night and then cleanse his teeth with a *siwāk*, perform ablution and pray until a sixth of the night remained. Then, he would sleep or talk with his wives until *Fajr*. He (peace be upon him) would sleep with a light stomach and on his right side, remembering Allāh until he fell into the state of sleep.

254. Al-Barā' ibn al-Āzīb narrated: "When the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to lie down on his bed, he would put his right hand under his right cheek, and recite, '*O Allāh, save me from Your Punishment on the Day of Judgment.*'"^[295]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth provides us with three etiquettes related to sleep:

1. Lie down on the right side.
2. Put the right hand under the right cheek.
3. Supplicate: *“O Allāh, save me from Your Punishment on the Day of Resurrection.”*

Al-Bajūrī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) recited this supplication, despite his high rank and infallibility, to show humility before Allāh and to give Him His due right as the Lord of mankind. He (peace be upon him) recited such so that his nation would follow his example. [Reciting this du'a] ensures that the words of remembrance of Allāh are the last words uttered before sleeping. Furthermore, the words of this specific du'a are said to seek protection from one's shortcomings that necessitate punishment as it is possible that the individual may never wake up from his sleep. The mention of the Day of Resurrection indicates that death is the twin of sleep and waking up is similar to the state of resurrection. This is why he (peace be upon him) used to say after waking up, *“All praise be to Allāh Who restored life into us after He took our souls, and to Him we shall be resurrected,”* as shall be mentioned later in the book.

255. ‘Abdullāh ibn Mas’ūd narrated the same but with the end of the supplication as: *“On the Day where You will gather your slaves.”* ^[296]

256. Hudhaifah narrated: “When the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to lie down on his bed, he would say, ‘O Allāh! On [the remembrance of] Your Name, I die and I live.’ Then upon waking he would say, ‘All praise be to Allāh Who restored life

into us after He took our souls, and to Him we shall be resurrected.” ^[297]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

“I die and I live”: The reason sleeping is resembled to death is because a person loses control over all their senses just like it is the case in death. Also, a life can be described as such when it is spent in good deeds and obedience; otherwise the disobedient spends his life as a dead person.

Praising Allāh for life is because this is from the most important blessings as it distinguishes the human from the non-human and whereby one comes to learn about Allāh and His worship.

The last part of the supplication recited after waking up is to remind us that just as we awake to life at the cessation of sleep, there will be resurrection after death and then people will be judged.

The wisdom behind reciting these supplications is so the last deed of the day consists of the remembrance of Allāh and the first deed a statement of monotheism and *taqwa*. This reminds the person that it is important to be conscious of Allāh and His Grandeur throughout the day and not to utter anything unless it is good.

257. Aisha narrated: “Every night before the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) slept upon his bed he would join his hands, lightly blow into them and recite the last three sūrahs of the Qur’ān (i.e. Sūrah al-Ikhlās, Sūrah al-Falaq, and Sūrah al-Nās). He would then wipe his hands over whatever parts of his body he could. He began with the head and face, and then the front part of his body. He did so thrice.” ^[298]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The regular practice of this indicates the keenness of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to do so, to the extent that he

ordered Aisha to do so on his behalf during his sickness whereof he died.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) passed his hands over wherever he could reach to attain the blessings of the ayāt as this protects the person from the devil and other harmful things.

It is important that a person understands and contemplates the meanings of these ayāt by reading the tafsīr of Ibn Kathīr or the tafsīr of al-Sa'di, for example. This is because the person who recites them while understanding their meaning is not like the one who recites them without this knowledge.

258. 'Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: "Once the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) slept and began to blow. It was the nature of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) that he blew when he slept. Bilal came and gave the call for the prayer. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) awakened and offered the prayer without performing the ablution." This hadith has a detailed story behind it. ^[299]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Blowing is a sign of deep sleep and knowing that it was the nature of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), we know that blowing while sleeping is not something that is dispraised.

The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did not perform ablution though he entered a state of deep sleep. This is an exclusive quality of his due to his heart always remaining awake (i.e. conscious) as he stated in the hadith, "We Prophets, the eyes close in sleep whilst the hearts remain awake."^[300]

The detailed story of this hadīth will be mentioned in the chapter detailing his worship.

259. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "When the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) would lie down on his bed, he would say, 'All praise is for Allāh, Who fed us and gave us drink, and Who is sufficient for us, and has sheltered us, for how many have none to suffice them or shelter them!'" ^[301]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) praised Allāh for providing food and drink before he slept because without these, one's life cannot be sustained, and because sleeping occurs after one eats and drinks (i.e. it is difficult to sleep when one is hungry and thus easier to sleep when one has eaten and drunk).

Al-Mudhhir describes Allāh's sufficiency as meaning that He averts the harm of people and facilitates for one shelter. So all praise be to Allāh for making us from amongst the protected for there are many people who Allāh does not protect against the harm of evil people and they are left to fend for themselves against the evil, and thus the vile people overcome them. Likewise, there are many people bereft of shelter and so He left them to be harmed by the elements.

Al-Nawawī said,

The meaning of the last part of the supplication means that many people have no one to have mercy on them, to be compassionate with them and many have no shelter to stay in.

260. Abū Qatādah narrated: "When the Prophet (peace be upon him) was journeying and stopped for rest and there was enough time in the night, he slept on his right side. However, if he stopped close to the time of the morning, he would lift his right arm, put his head upon it and sleep." ^[302]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows the concern he had for performing the prayer of *Fajr* as sleeping in that position would make it difficult for the person to enter the state of deep sleep.

CHAPTER FORTY

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE WORSHIP OFFERED BY THE PROPHET

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Though the title of the chapter is general, the hadīths included in this chapter relate to the night prayer.

261. Al-Mughīrah ibn Shu'bah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) performed prayers of such length that his feet would become swollen. It was said to him, 'You exert yourself to such a degree yet Allāh has forgiven your past and future sins?' The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Should I not be a grateful servant?'" ^[303]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

This response of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) could be expanded in other words as: "Praying at night is to show appreciation and thankfulness for Allāh's forgiveness; hence how could it be possible for me to stop this!"

If a person fears becoming bored due to excessive worship, then he should not force himself to do it. If otherwise, one should push himself to worship as much as possible.

Ibn 'Allan al-Shafi'ī said,

The companion thought that the reason the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) underwent such difficulties in worship was because he feared the punishment of his sins or hoped for the reward [of the prayers]. But the Messenger of Allāh (peace be

upon him) clarified that the reason was nobler and higher: to show appreciation, gratitude and acknowledgement of one's servitude.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) is infallible and the sins referred to in this hadīth are not understood at face value because the good deeds of the pious are viewed as sins for the ones in higher ranks (meaning: the inability of a person to praise, worship, thank Allāh and give Him His due right is looked upon as a shortcoming that equals sins for those who are at a higher state).

262. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to pray at night until his feet became swollen. It was said to him, 'You do this although Allāh has forgiven your past and future sins?' The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) replied, 'Should I not be a grateful servant?'" [304]

263. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) performed such lengthy prayers that his feet became swollen. It was said to him, 'You do this although Allāh has forgiven your past and future sins?' The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Should I not be a grateful servant?'"

[305]

264. Al-Aswad ibn Yazīd enquired from Aisha regarding the prayer of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) at night. She replied: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to sleep for the first half portion of the night (after praying *Ishā*). He would then wake up and pray at night but when the time of the last sixth of the night entered, he would pray the *witr* and then go to his bed. If he had a desire, he would approach his wife. And, when he would hear the call for prayer, he would get up actively. If he was in a state of major ritual

impurity, he performed *ghusl*. If not, he performed ablution and then went to pray.” ^[306]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The beginning of the night starts from sunset but the time intended in this hadīth refers to after the prayer of *Ishā* because the Prophet (peace be upon him) disliked sleeping before *Ishā* and disliked talking after it, so he would sleep right after praying *Ishā*.

He used to wake up after the middle of the night as explained in the authentic hadīth found in Sahīh al-Bukharī (1131) and Sahīh Muslim (1159).

Al-Bajūrī said,

The intention of the question regarding his prayer at night was to ask about the time that he used to pray the night prayers and *witr*.

It is possible that he (peace be upon him) performed ablution because his ablution was nullified for a reason other than sleeping or that he renewed his ablution. This hadīth teaches us to care for the acts of worship, not to be lazy in sleep and to perform the worship whilst being active and energetic.

265. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās reported that he once slept at the house of his maternal aunt Maymūnah. He said: “I slept on the width of the cushion and the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) slept on the length of the cushion and he slept until the middle of the night, or a little before or after that. He (peace be upon him) then awoke, began wiping off the signs of sleep from his face and then recited the last ten ayāt of Sūrah al-‘Imrān.

He then stood and used the water he found in a leather bag that was hanging to perform his ablution. He performed his ablution thoroughly and commenced the prayer.”

'Abdullāh ibn Abbās added: "I stood next to him [on his left]. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) put his right hand on my head, took hold of my ear and twisted it. He performed two units, then two units, then two units, then two units, then two units, then two units. [Ma'n (a narrator of this hadīth from Ibn 'Abbās) says the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) prayed two units six times (a total of twelve units)].

The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) then performed the *witr* and lied down [for a short period] until the *mu'adhin* came to inform him of the *Fajr* prayer. He then prayed two short units and headed for the masjid." [307]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The reason Ibn Abbās slept at the house of his maternal aunt was because his father, al-Abbās (the uncle of the Prophet) wanted to know the worship of the Prophet (peace be upon him) at night so he could follow his guidance.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) normally slept upon a bed besides one of his wives and this was his habit. However, whenever he wanted to perform worship he would leave his wives and focus on his worship. This way he fulfilled the rights of his wives and did justice to the rights of his Lord.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It can be extracted from this hadīth that it is recommended to recite the last ten *ayāt* of Sūrah al-Imrān after waking up and that it is allowed to recite the Qur'ān in a state of minor ritual impurity.

He twisted the ear of Ibn Abbās either to notify him that he was not following the Sunnah when he stood on his left side, to keep him alert so that he could memorise the Sunnah or to remove his sleepiness.

The habit of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was to pray the *witr* at the end of the night but sometimes he prayed it at the

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mid-point and sometimes at the beginning. The variation most likely occurred due to the necessities of different situations, as it is possible that he prayed the *witr* at the beginning of the night due to sickness and at the middle of the night because he was travelling.

The *fiqh* of this hadīth is:

- It is recommended for a congregation made of two that the person following the *imām* stands to his right side, and to move to the right side if he was standing on the left side. If he does not move to the correct side, it is recommended for the *imām* to move him to his right side.
- It is recommended for the *imām* to physically instruct the person praying behind him to the Sunnah if he notices him not following it. This shows that a small amount of physical action in the prayer does not nullify the prayer, and it can be the Sunnah in some cases as exemplified in this hadīth.
- The congregation is valid with a young boy and he takes the same ruling as adults in congregation.
- It is valid to pray a voluntary prayer in congregation.
- It is recommended to pray the *witr* and voluntary prayers, two units by two units.
- It is recommended for the *muadhin* to notify the *imām* in person to come to the prayer.
- It is recommended to make the Sunnah of *Fajr* short.

266. ‘Abdullah ibn Abbās narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to pray during the night thirteen units.” ^[308]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

There are other hadīths stating that he (peace be upon him) prayed eleven units and nine units. However, scholars understood these hadīths in the context that each refers to a different situation and incident.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The thirteen units mentioned consist of two units as the Sunnah of *Ishā* or the Sunnah of ablution and eleven units as *witr*.

267. Aisha reported: “Whenever the Prophet (peace be upon him) could not pray the night prayers due to sleep or excessive fatigue; he would pray twelve units during the daytime.” ^[309]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This shows that the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not pray *witr* during the daytime. It teaches us that if a person misses his regular night prayers, it is prescribed for him to make them up during the day.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The night prayers mentioned in the hadith refer to the *tahajjud* and *witr*.

The reason the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not pray at night, based on the wording of the hadīth, shows that the narrator was uncertain as he mentioned two possibilities, each of which gives a different meaning i.e. if the reason was that he slept, that means he made the choice to sleep though he could stay awake, but if the reason was that he was too fatigued, it means that he was in a state where he could not stay awake.

268. Abū Hurairah narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) said: ‘When one awakes at night, let him begin [his night prayers] with two short units of prayer.’” ^[310]

Al-Bajūrī said,

These two units are recommended to be an introductory to the *witr* so that one can pray the *witr* actively while being fully awake. This is similar to how it is recommended to precede the obligatory prayer with the Sunnah prayer.

269. Zayd ibn Khālid narrated: “I decided that I would closely observe how the Prophet (peace be upon him) performed his prayers. Thus, I lied down on the threshold [of his house or his tent]. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) first prayed two short units, and then he prayed two long units, two long units, two long units. He then prayed two units shorter than the previous ones, and then prayed two more units shorter than the ones before. And again, he prayed two more units shorter than the previous ones. He again prayed two units shorter than the previous ones. He then prayed the *witr*. They amounted to thirteen units of prayer in total.” ^[311]

Al-Bajūrī said,

The person who narrated from Zayd doubted whether it was the threshold of his house or his tent, and it is most likely the latter because the Prophet (peace be upon him) would be with his wives in his house and so it is inappropriate to say that Zayd stood there watching him inside in such circumstances. However, during his travels, he (peace be upon him) would be in his tent and not with his wives so Zayd could remain on the threshold of his tent and watch.

The reason Zayd repeated thrice that the first two units were long was to show how lengthy they were, as if they were equivalent in length to six long units. The reason he (peace be upon him) made the first two units very long was because a person is more active and possesses more energy at the beginning of the prayer as opposed to the end. This is why it is recommended to make the first unit of the prayer longer than the second one in obligatory prayers.

The thirteen units mentioned include the introductory two units and the remaining eleven units are *witr* prayer.

270. Abū Salamah asked Aisha to describe for him the prayer of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) so she said: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did not pray more than eleven units, whether he prayed in the month of Ramadan or outside of it. He used to pray four units and it is too difficult to describe their length and earnestness. Then, in the same manner he prayed four more units. After that he prayed three units of prayer." Aisha said, "I asked him, 'O Messenger of Allāh. How come you sleep before praying the *witr*?' He replied, 'O Aisha, my eyes sleep but my heart does not.'" ^[312]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth does not contradict the other hadīths by stating that he (peace be upon him) prayed eleven units of prayer. This is because Aisha did not count the two introductory units that he (peace be upon him) prayed at the beginning as can be noted when she detailed how the units were divided four by four.

Al-Bajūrī said,

Each set of four units were prayed two by two and not as the apparent meaning of the statement of Aisha. This way, the hadīth conforms to the previous hadīth narrated by Zayd. The reason the four units were mentioned as a whole is because the two sets of two units were similar in length and performance.

This hadīth shows that prolonging the standing in prayer is better than praying a higher quantity of short units. The hadīth about the closeness to our Lord in prostration^[313] teaches us that supplications are more likely to be answered therein. The last three units were not described in the same manner as the preceding ones to show that they were short.

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The reason Aisha asked the question [regarding sleeping before *witr*] is because it was known that he (peace be upon him) ordered some of his companions such as Abū Hurairah not to sleep before praying *witr* due to fearing that they may oversleep and miss it. The answer of the Prophet (peace be upon him) came to show that the possibility to miss the *Fajr* is inapplicable in his case as his heart is awake. Thus, it is recommended for the one who is certain that he will wake up before *Fajr* to postpone the *witr* and pray it after waking up, if otherwise he should pray it before.

271. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to pray eleven units at night, one of which was a unit of *witr*. After he finished, he would lie down on his right side.”

[314]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr,

Some scholars extracted a gem from this hadīth: The number of units that he (peace be upon him) prayed at night was exactly the same as the units performed for the daytime obligatory prayers, which are *Dhuhr*, *Asr* and *Maghrib*.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This is an explicit statement to show that the least number of units for *witr* is one, and that a prayer of one unit is valid.

272. Ibn Shihāb reported the same through two different routes.

273. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to pray nine units during the night.” [315]

274. Al-A'mash reported the same through a different route.

275. Hudhaifah ibn al-Yamān narrated: “I prayed with the Prophet (peace be upon him) wherein he commenced the prayer with the following statement, ‘Allāhu Akbar dhul

Malakūtī wal Jabarūtī wal Kibryā wal 'Adhamah. Then he recited Sūrah al-Baqarah (after al-Fātihah) and proceeded to bow. The length of the bowing was as long as the standing posture, during which he said repeatedly, '*Subhana rabbiy al-Adhim.*' Then, he raised his torso and the length of his standing was like that of his bowing, during which he said repeatedly, '*Li-Rabbi al-Hamd.*' Then, he prostrated and the length of his prostration was similar to his standing, during which he said repeatedly, '*Subhan Rabbi al-'Ala.*' Then he raised himself from prostration. The length of the sitting posture was similar to the prostration, during which he said, '*Rabbi Ighfir Lī.*' He prayed each unit in the same manner and in that prayer he recited al-Baqarah, al-Imrān, al-Nisā' and [al-Maidah or al-An'ām]."^[316]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Regarding the meaning of the opening statement: *Dhul Malakūt* means the One with Dominion and Pride. *Dhul Jabarūtī* means the Subduer and Surmounter. *Dhul Kibriyā* means the One who transcends all defects and shortcomings while everything submits to Him. *Dhul 'Adhama* means the One Who nothing can encompass. It is said that *Kibryā* refers to the perfection of His essence while '*Adhamah*' refers to the beauty of His Attributes.

The narrator who heard this from Hudhaifah doubted whether it was Sūrah al-Ma'ida or al-An'ām that was recited in the fourth unit.

276. Aisha narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) stood in a [complete] night's prayer reciting one ayah of the Qur'ān."^[317]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The ayah mentioned is: **{If You should punish them - indeed they are Your servants; but if You forgive them - indeed it is You who is the Exalted in Might, the Wise.}**^[318] As stated in the hadith collected in the Musnad of Imam Ahmad.

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Ibn al-Qayyim said,

If people knew the benefits of contemplating the Qur'ān they would busy themselves with it and leave everything else. A person should recite the Qur'ān with contemplation and if he comes across an ayah that touches his heart, repeat it one hundred times or even the whole night to attain its benefit. The recitation of an ayah with contemplation and understanding is better than reciting the whole Qur'ān without understanding and contemplating it. It is certainly more beneficial to the heart and increases one's *imān* in it. Furthermore, it lets the person taste the sweetness of the Qur'ān. This was the habit of the *salaf* who used to repeat one ayah until the time of *Fajr*.

277. 'Abdullāh ibn Mas'ūd narrated: "Once at night I prayed in congregation with the Messenger of Allāh wherein he stood for such a long time that I intended to do a bad deed." Someone asked: "What deed did you intend to do?" He replied: "I was about to sit down and leave the Prophet (peace be upon him) standing alone." ^[319]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This is intended to show how long the night prayer of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was.

278. A similar report is narrated through a different route from al-A'mash.

279. Aisha narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) prayed in a sitting posture until about thirty or forty ayāt were remaining. At this point he stood up and completed them standing. He then bowed and prostrated. He would subsequently do the same in the second unit." ^[320]

Al-Bajūrī said,

This was the case when he (peace be upon him) became old in age as Aisha explicitly stated in the hadīth documented in Sahīh al-Bukharī and Sahīh Muslim.

It shows that it is allowed to pray while sitting in voluntary prayers.

280. ‘Abdullāh ibn Shaqīq asked Aisha about the prayer of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). She said: “He used to pray lengthy periods of the night whilst standing and lengthy periods of the night whilst sitting. If he prayed standing, he would bow and prostrate whilst standing, and if he prayed whilst sitting, he would bow and prostrate from the sitting posture.” ^[321]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The reward for praying while sitting down is half of praying while standing. However, this does not apply to the Prophet (peace be upon him) as he himself stated in the hadīth documented in Sahīh Muslim:

‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Amr reported: “It was narrated to me that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had said, ‘The prayer observed by a person sitting is half of the prayer.’ I came to him (peace be upon him) and found him praying in a sitting position. I placed my hand on his head. He said, ‘O ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Amr, what is the matter with you?’ I replied, ‘Messenger of Allāh, it has been narrated to me that you said, ‘The prayer of a man in a sitting position is half of the prayer,’ and you are observing the prayer sitting.’ He (peace be upon him) said, ‘Yes, it is so, but I am not like anyone amongst you.’” ^[322]

281. The wife of the Prophet (peace be upon him) Hafsa narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) prayed voluntary prayers whilst sitting. He would recite with slow, distinct and clear intonation, such that the sūrah became longer than a sūrah that was actually lengthier.” ^[323]

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Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

He prayed most of the time whilst sitting towards the end of his life as he was sick and could not stand for long durations as he used to.

The manner in which he (peace be upon him) recited was to recite slowly, contemplating the ayāt. If there was an ayah about punishment, he would take refuge in Allāh from it, and if an ayah contained *tasbih*, he would glorify Allāh, and if an ayah contained a mercy, he would ask Allāh for His mercy. This is why the sūrah appeared longer than other lengthier ones.

282. Aisha reported: “The Prophet (peace be upon him), towards the end of his life, would perform most of his prayers whilst sitting.” ^[324]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This was close to the time of his death and due to the toll inflicted by age and his illness.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This refers to the optional prayers.

283. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar narrated: “I prayed with the Prophet (peace be upon him) two units before and after *Dhuhr*, two units after *Maghrib* in his house, and [also] two units after *Ishā* in his house.” ^[325]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth talks about the regular Sunnah units associated with the obligatory prayers while the previous hadīth was regarding optional prayers.

284. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar narrated: “Hafsah related to me that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to pray two units upon the commencement of *Fajr*, when the call to prayer

was made.” Ayyūb (one of the narrators) said: “I think he said: ‘Short units.’” ^[326]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth talks about the supererogatory prayers of the Prophet (peace be upon him) that he prayed before *Fajr* and with these two units, the total number of the units is ten. Ibn ‘Umar saw him pray eight units and then his sister Hafsa, the wife of the Prophet, informed him of the other two units. The Sunnah is to recite in the first unit of the Sunnah of *Fajr* “al-Kafirūn” and the second unit “al-Ikhlās”.

Al-Bajūrī said,

The two short units referred to here are the Sunnah of *Fajr*.

285. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar narrated: “I memorised from the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) eight units of prayer; two before *Dhuhr* and two after it; two units after *Maghrib* and two after *Ishā*. Hafsa related to me about the two units before *Fajr*, which I did not observe from the Prophet (peace be upon him).” ^[327]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This shows that he (peace be upon him) prayed the regular Sunnah of the obligatory prayers in the masjid; therefore Ibn ‘Umar saw them. Unlike the Sunnah of *Fajr* which he always prayed at home.

286. ‘Abdullāh ibn Shaqīq asked Aisha about the optional prayers of the Prophet (peace be upon him). She replied: “He used to pray two units before and two after *Dhuhr*, two units after *Maghrib*, two units after *Ishā* and two before *Fajr*.” ^[328]

287. ‘Āsim ibn Damrah narrated: “We asked Alī ibn Abī Tālib about the optional prayers that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) performed during the daytime. Alī replied, ‘You

do not have the capability to perform them.' We replied, 'Whoever from amongst us that possesses the capability will do so.' Alī said, 'In the morning when the sun rises to the height, the same as it is at the time for 'Asr. At that time he performed two units. When the sun rises in the east to a similar height as it is in the west at the time of *Dhuhr*, he performed four units. He performed four units before *Dhuhr* and two after. Four units were performed before 'Asr. In between the two units [of a four unit prayer] he would sit and send salutations to the close angels, Prophets, and those who followed them from the devoted believers and Muslims.'" ^[329]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The inquiry of 'Āsim shows the keen interest of the *salaf* towards learning the guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and following it.

The first set of two units mentioned in the hadīth refers to the *Duha* prayer.

The first set of four units mentioned in the hadīth refers to, as explained by some commentators, the prayer of *awwabyeen* which is offered when the pebbles become overheated (i.e. when the temperature is high).

The second set of four units mentioned in the hadīth refers to the regular Sunnah preceding the prayer of *Dhuhr*, which confirms the previous hadīths.

The two units performed after *Dhuhr* and four units before *Asr* are not the regular Sunnah associated with these two prayers. These two prayers have a great reward mentioned in other hadīths.

The statement he (peace be upon him) said could be the *taslīm* with which he concluded the prayer or the *tashahud* wherein salutations are sent to all pious slaves of Allāh, which includes angels and the Prophets. However, the former is more likely to

be the case and more obvious in the context of this hadīth and other hadīths.

CHAPTER FORTY ONE

THE DUHA PRAYER (FORENOON PRAYER)

Al-San'āni said,

Ibn al-Qayyim compiled all the views of the scholars regarding the ruling on praying the *Duha* prayer, and they totalled to six different views, as follows:

1. It is a recommended Sunnah.
2. It is not prescribed unless there is a reason for it.
3. It is not recommended.
4. It is recommended to pray it but not on a regular basis.
5. It is preferable to pray it at home.
6. It is an innovation.

The most correct view of these is that it is a recommended Sunnah as stated by Ibn Daqīq al-'Eid.

288. Mu'ādhah narrated: “I asked Aisha, ‘Did the Prophet (peace be upon him) pray the *Duha* prayer?’ She replied, ‘Yes, he prayed four units, and would also increase upon that [number] whatever Allāh willed.’” ^[330]

Ibn Battal said,

Masrūq said: “We used to recite Qur’ān [after *Fajr*] in the masjid and would remain in the masjid after Ibn Mas’ūd would leave, and then [later we would] perform the *Duha* prayer. The news

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reached Ibn Mas'ūd and so he said to us, 'Why do you dictate upon people that which Allāh did not oblige them to do. If you want to pray it, then do so at home.'"

The *salaf* preferred praying the *Duha* prayer in secret and not to pray it in public.

Al-Sindī said,

The affirmative answer of Aisha indicates that he (peace be upon him) prayed it sometimes. This is because she related in other hadīths that he did not pray it; thus to reconcile between these hadīths, it appears she meant that he did not pray it all the time or that she did not see him pray it but was then informed by someone at a later point that he did pray it.

Hafith al-'Iraqī said,

Al-Nawawī and al-Bayhaqī said that scholars understood the hadīths indicating that the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not pray it to mean that he did not pray it regularly as he feared that it may become obligatory. This is evident in the statement of Aisha wherein she said, "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) would not do an act of worship he liked to perform just out of fear that the people would follow suit and accordingly, it would become obligatory."

Al-Minnawī said,

This hadīth was used as evidence by some scholars that the number of its units is open.

289. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to pray six units as the *Duha* prayer." ^[331]

Al-Minnawī said,

The *Duha* prayer is an established Sunnah. The Shafi'ī scholars stated that the minimum number of its units is two, the best is

eight units and the maximum is twelve (based on the hadīths narrating the number of units of this prayer).

290. ‘Abdul Rahman ibn Abī Laylah narrated: “No one had informed me that they had observed the Prophet pray the *Duha* prayer besides Umm Hānī’ for she related, ‘The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) came to my house on the day Makkah was conquered, and there he performed *ghusl* and then prayed eight units that I did not observe him perform any prayer shorter than, but he still bowed and prostrated his normal length.” ^[332]

Alau’ddin al-Baghdadī said,

Ibn Abbās said: “I did not know *Duha* prayer was mentioned in the ayah: **{Indeed, We subjected the mountains [to praise] with him, exalting [Allāh] in the [late] afternoon and [after] sunrise.}** ^[333] until I heard Umm Hānī’ tell me that the Messenger of Allāh visited her and asked for water to perform ablution and then prayed the *Duha* prayer. After he finished, he said to her, ‘O Umm Hānī’! This is the *Duha* prayer.” ^[334]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

Though this hadīth indicates that it is prescribed to shorten the *Duha* prayer, this is something debatable due to the possibility that he (peace be upon him) shortened it due to the multitude of tasks he was burdened with when Makkah was conquered, particularly as it is proven that he (peace be upon him) prayed lengthy *Duha* prayers at other times. However, al-Qadī ‘Iyyād reported from some scholars that the prayer mentioned in this hadīth is the prayer of conquest which Khālīd ibn al-Walīd prayed in some of his conquests.

Al-Tirmidhī narrated from Imām Ahmad that the most authentic hadīth about the *Duha* prayer is the hadīth of Umm Hānī’, and it is as he stated. This is the reason Al-Nawawī said that the best number of units to pray are eight, while the

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maximum is twelve (though many other scholars did not place a restriction on the maximum number of units).

291. 'Abdullāh ibn Shaqīq related: "I asked Aisha, 'Did the Prophet (peace be upon him) pray the *Duha* prayer?' She replied, 'No. He did not perform it except when he would return from a journey.'" [335]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

He prayed it after his return from travelling because he admonished arriving home from a journey at night and so he would arrive early in the morning and the first thing he would do was to go to the masjid and pray during the forenoon time.

Al-Suyūṭī said,

This clarifies the other hadīth of Aisha wherein she negated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) prayed the *Duha* prayer as she meant that he did not pray it regularly.

292. Abu Sa'īd al-Khudarī narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to pray the *Duha* prayer with such regularity that we thought he would not leave it. And, he would not pray it [for such a lengthy period of time], that we thought he would not pray it again." [336]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

'Ikrimah related that Ibn Abbās used to pray it for ten days and then leave it for ten days. Sufyān al-Thawrī related that Mansūr said, "They (the *salaf*) disliked praying the *Duha* prayer on a regular basis just like they observe the obligatory prayer." Sa'īd ibn Jubair said, "I do not pray it [sometimes], though I like praying it as I fear I might start obliging myself to pray it."

Zain al-Dīn al-Iraqī said,

The reason he (peace be upon him) did not pray it on a regular basis was because he feared it becoming obligatory upon his nation. However, as he (peace be upon him) passed away and the religion is now complete and perfect, one should try to pray it as much as possible.

293. Abu Ayyūb al-Ansārī narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) always prayed four units when the sun passed the zenith. I said, ‘O Messenger of Allāh! You constantly pray these four units when the sun passes the zenith!’ The Messenger (peace be upon him) replied, ‘The doors of the heavens open from the time the sun passes the zenith until the *Dhuhr* prayer is performed; hence I like that a good deed of mine reaches the heavens at that time.’ I asked, ‘Is there a recital in every unit?’ He replied, ‘Yes.’ I enquired, ‘Is there a *taslīm* in between?’ He replied, ‘No.’” ^[337]

Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūrī said,

These four units are known as the Sunnah of *Zawāl* which is different to the four units of Sunnah preceding the *Dhuhr* prayer and they are linked to the time of the sun passing the zenith. The wisdom for praying it at that time is because the time of midday mirrors the time of midnight; the doors of the heavens are open at midday and Allāh descends after midnight; thus both times are times of mercy.

Ibn al-Qayyim said that the Prophet (peace be upon him) prayed these four units after the sun passed the zenith.

Abdullah ibn Sa’īd al-Hadramī al-Makkī said,

The inquiry about whether these units included any Qur’ān recitation refers to anything in addition to the Fātiḥah. This is because a prayer is not accepted without reciting the Fātiḥah even if it is an optional prayer, and this is something well known.

The inquiry about the taslīm was to find out whether the four units are prayed with one taslīm or prayed two units by two. This hadīth was used as evidence by the scholars who hold the view that the optional prayers of the daytime should consist of four units with one taslīm. However, other scholars understood the statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to mean that the taslīm is not obligatory. Meaning one is not obligated to pray them two units by two and so it does not contradict that the best manner of praying the optional prayers is two by two.

294. Abu Ayyūb al-Ansārī narrated from the Prophet (peace be upon him) a similar narration through a different route.

295. ‘Abdullāh ibn al-Sāi’b narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to pray four units between the time of the sun passing the zenith and the prayer of *Dhuhr*, and he (peace be upon him) said, “The doors of the heavens open at this moment; therefore I like that a good deed of mine ascends at this moment.” ^[338]

296. Alī ibn Abī Tālib used to pray four units before the prayer of *Dhuhr* and he mentioned that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to pray these four units when the sun passed the zenith and he would make the units long in duration. ^[339]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This shows that it is recommended to prolong the *Duha* prayer.

CHAPTER FORTY TWO

PRAYING SUPEREROGATORY PRAYERS AT HOME

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It is more rewarding to pray supererogatory prayers at home than in the masjid even if the masjid is one of the three wherein the reward is doubled. Praying at home brings life to it and whenever a home is devoid of prayer then it is devoid of life. From the benefits of praying supererogatory prayers at home is that it encourages the children to pray, expels devils from the home and brings tranquillity and peace therein.

297. ‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’d related: “I asked the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) which is more meritorious, praying at home or praying at the masjid?” He replied, “You can see that my house is very close to the masjid yet besides the five obligatory prayers, I prefer to pray in my house rather than in the masjid.” ^[340]

Muhammad al-Amīn al-Shanqītī said,

The scholars differed on whether it is better to pray the supererogatory prayers at home or at the masjid of the Prophet (peace be upon him) because each group understood the overall texts differently. The views of the scholars are as follows:

Imam Abū Hanifah said that praying supererogatory prayers at home is better and there would be no difference in reward if they were prayed at the masjid of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

Imam al-Shafi'i had two views reported from him as noted in Sharh Sahih Muslim of al-Nawawi and al-Majmu' of the same author.

Mālikī scholars hold the view that praying supererogatory prayers at the masjid of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is better than praying them at home.

It should be noted that the reward for women praying at home is greater than them praying at the masjid, be it supererogatory prayers or obligatory prayers.

Al-Nabhānī said,

The reason he (peace be upon him) preferred to offer supererogatory prayers at home was so the blessings of prayer encompass the home and the household members, through this angels enter the house and devils leave it.

CHAPTER FORTY THREE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE FASTING OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to clarifying the recommended and obligatory fasting of the Prophet (peace be upon him) – that which he repeated every week such as the fast of Mondays and Thursdays, and that which he repeated every month such as the three days of each month, and that which he repeated every year such as the month of Ramadān and the day of 'Ashūrā.

The lingual meaning of the Arabic word '*sawm*' is abstaining and refraining. In its religious context it means refraining from food, drink and sexual activities during the day from the time of *Fajr* until sunset.

Fasting is of two types, the first of which is to refrain from food, drink and sexual activities and this must be observed during each day of the month of Ramadān, from *Fajr* until sunset. The other type of fasting is to refrain from sins and this must be observed all of the time. It is for this reason that each bodily limb must fast, the ears must refrain from listening to the forbidden, the tongue must refrain from uttering the forbidden and so forth.

298. 'Abdullāh ibn Shaqīq narrated: "I inquired from Aisha regarding the supererogatory fasting of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). She replied, 'At times he would fast continuous days to the point that we thought he would not cease fasting. And at times he would not fast, until we began

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thinking he would continue to not fast. The Messenger of Allāh did not fast a whole month from the time he entered Madinah, except the month of Ramadan.” ^[341]

Al-Nawawī said,

This hadith shows that it is recommended for a person to fast a day or more from each month, and that optional fasting does not have a specific time as it can be offered anytime during the year except the month of Ramadan, Eid days and the days of Tashrīq.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason it was mentioned that this was his practice from the day he entered Madinah is because most of the rulings were revealed after immigration.

This is a proof that optional fasting during the month of Ramadān is invalid.

299. Anas ibn Mālik was asked about the fasting of the Prophet (peace be upon him). He replied: “It was his habit that in some months he fasted for so many days, that it was thought he would continue fasting the whole month. In other months, he did not fast to the point that it was thought he would not fast any day from the month. If anyone wanted to observe him praying at night, it was possible, and if one wanted to observe him sleeping at night, this too was possible.” ^[342]

Yahya ibn Yahya al-Amirī said,

You should know that fasting is from the best acts of worship and it is an act of striving. Its virtue has been reported in many hadīths, the loftiest of which is the hadīth mentioned in Sahīh al-Bukharī and Sahīh Muslim wherein Allāh said on the tongue of the Prophet (peace be upon him), “Every deed of the son of Adam is for him except fasting; it is for Me and I shall reward him for it.” ^[343]

Abdul Rahman Al-Mubarakfūri said,

Al-Hafith ibn Hajar said that the meaning of this hadīth is that he (peace be upon him) did not follow a particular pattern in his worship. An example of this is that he used to pray night prayers at the beginning of the night, some other times in the middle of the night and some other times at the end of the night. Likewise, he used to fast the beginning of the month, and some other times in the middle of the month and some other times at the end of the month. Thus, if a person wanted to observe his worship, he would certainly be able to see him either fasting or praying.

300. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) at times would fast continuously to such an extent that we began to think that he would not discontinue fasting. And, at times he would not fast to such an extent that we began thinking he would not restart fasting. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did not fast a whole month from the time he entered Madinah, except the month of Ramadan.” ^[344]

301. Umm Salamah narrated: “I did not see the Prophet (peace be upon him) fast two consecutive months except the months of Sha’bān and Ramadān.”

Ibn Abdul Barr said,

‘Abdullāh ibn al-Mubarak said, “In the Arabic language saying ‘fasted the whole month’ can refer to someone who fasted most of the month.”

Ibn Rajab said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to fast during the month of Sha’bān more than any other months. The most correct view is that he (peace be upon him) fasted most of the month as evidenced in many other explicit hadīths. Ibn Abbās used to forbid people from fasting a whole month (except the month of

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Ramadān). The month of Sha'bān is the most virtuous month after the month of Ramadān due to the fact that it is the closest month to the month of Ramadan. Thus when one offers optional fasting in Sha'bān and then follows it with obligatory fasting in Ramadan, it is like the regular Sunnah prayers preceding and following the obligatory prayers.

302. Aisha narrated: “I did not see the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) fast in a month [excluding Ramadān] more than he did in Sha'bān. He fasted the month except for a few days; rather he fasted the full month.” ^[345]

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The statement of Aisha indicates that he nearly fasted the whole month of Sha'bān and the days he left out were insignificant in number. Al-Nawawī said that the Prophet (peace be upon him) did not fast a whole month except Ramadān so people would not make this act of his obligatory.

Al-Shawkānī said,

The first part of the statement of Aisha seems to contradict her last statement and scholars reconciled the meanings of the two statements by concluding that she meant that he nearly fasted the whole month. However, al-Taybī dismissed such reconciliation based on the meanings of the word “*kul*” (English: whole) mentioned in the hadith, and so he stated that she meant that he fasted the whole month of Sha'bān but not every year so that people would not think that it is obligatory to fast it.

303. ‘Abdullah ibn Mas’ūd narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) fasted for three days at the beginning of every month, and rarely would he miss fasting on Fridays.” ^[346]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalanī said,

Reconciling all the hadīths related to fasting on Friday, it is disliked to single out Friday for fasting and the wisdom behind that is because Friday is a day of celebration and such days are not fasted. However, the counterargument is that the Prophet allowed its fasting if Thursday or Saturday is fasted with it, and Ibn al-Qayyim and other scholars responded saying that fasting another day with it negates the intention of fasting Friday in particular.

Al-Shawkānī said,

This hadīth entails that he (peace be upon him) fasted Friday along with Thursday or Saturday.

304. Aisha narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) was keen to fast on Mondays and Thursdays.” ^[347]

Muhammad Alī al-Shafi’ī said,

He (peace be upon him) used to fast these two days due to their great virtue.

Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūrī said,

This shows that he (peace be upon him) had great keenness towards the fasting of these two days.

305. Abū Hurairah narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) said, ‘Deeds are presented before Allāh on Mondays and Thursdays; therefore I like for my good deeds to be presented whilst I am fasting.’” ^[348]

Ibn al-Uthaymīn said,

The virtue of the day of Monday is established in other hadīths wherein he (peace be upon him) mentioned that it was the day on which he was born, the day he was sent to people and also the day on which he received the first revelation. Fasting the day of Thursday is a Sunnah but it is less virtuous than the day of

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Monday. However, the most virtuous kind of fasting is the fasting of Prophet Dawūd which is to fast alternate days.

306. Aisha narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to fast in one month Saturdays, Sundays and Mondays, and in the following month he would fast on Tuesdays, Wednesdays and Thursdays.” ^[349]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The purpose of dividing his fasting was so that he could be able to fast most of the days of the week.

Al-San'anī said,

The reason behind him (peace be upon him) fasting Saturdays and Sundays is explained in another hadīth wherein he mentioned that he fasted them because they are the Eid days of the disbelievers. Subsequently, he wanted to oppose them by fasting these days since on their days of Eid the disbelievers would be indulging in feasts, drinks and merriment.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

It is disliked to single out Saturday for fasting and this hadīth can be reconciled with other hadīths as the ruling of “disliked” is removed when another day is fasted with it (i.e. Friday or Sunday). The reason it is disliked to single out Saturday is so that the day venerated by the Jews as a day of rest is not glorified [by the Muslims].

307. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did not fast in any month more than he did in the month of Sha'bān.” ^[350]

308. Mu'adhah narrated: “I asked ‘Aisha whether the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to fast three days of each month and she confirmed that. Thus, I asked her, ‘On

which days of the month did he fast?' She replied, 'He did not specify any particular days.'" ^[351]

Ibn Rajab said,

This hadīth shows that he (peace be upon him) did not have any specific days selected to fast the three days from each month.

309. Aisha narrated: "The day of 'Ashūra was a day that the Quraysh used to fast before Islām and the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) observed this fast too. When he came to Madīnah he observed its fast and commanded others to fast it too. However, when the command to fast the month of Ramadān was revealed, it became the obligatory fasting and the fast of 'Ashūra was left; whoever wished, observed its fast and whoever did not, left it." ^[352]

Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūrī said,

This shows that the fast of 'Ashūra^[353] was made obligatory but the ruling was abrogated when it was revealed that the fast of Ramadan is obligatory.

'Abdullāh al-Hadramī al-Makkī said,

Al-Qadī 'Iyyād said it is possible that he (peace be upon him) fasted the day of 'Ashūra to incline the hearts of the Jews to Islām just as he did when he prayed toward their *qiblah* (Jerusalem). However, when Makkah was conquered and Islām spread, he preferred to oppose them and so he said that he will fast another day with the day of 'Ashūra.

According to some scholars the best manner of fasting the day of 'Ashūra is by fasting it with the day that precedes it and the day that follows it. Then, to fast 'Ashūra and the day before it, and the last in rank is to fast the day alone.

310. 'Alqamah narrated: "I asked Aisha, 'Did the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) set aside particular days for

worship?’ She replied, ‘The worship of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was of a continuous nature, and who amongst you would have the strength that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) possessed?’” ^[354]

Ibn Battāl said,

This means that he did not specify an act of worship to a particular day but it was narrated that his optional fasting was increased during the month of Sha'bān and that he encouraged fasting Mondays and Thursdays. We understand this by stating that he (peace be upon him) fasted according to his energy level and so it happened that the fasting often coincided with the days he preferred.

Ibn Rajab said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) admonished discontinuing good deeds when they have become routine for the individual as noted in the hadīth wherein he addressed ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar, “Do not be like so and so, he used to offer night prayers and then he stopped.”^[355]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The virtue of continuing to do a good deed after it becomes habitual is so the individual does not become a person who breaks contact with his beloved. A person like that deserves admonishment. A similar case is the one who memorises from the Qur’ān and forgets it; there are many hadīths admonishing this. In this hadīth lies an encouragement for people to spare no efforts in worship, striving to reach their maximum individual capacity, provided that the exertion does not reach to the degree that will cause the person to leave the worship due to reasons such as boredom.

Al-Ghazālī said,

It was narrated that if Allāh accustoms a person to an act of worship but later on he stops it out of boredom, Allāh will despise him. This is why it is reported that the Prophet (peace be upon him) continuously prayed the two units after 'Asr to make up the two units he missed after the prayer of *Dhuhr* due to his visitors.^[356] However, he prayed them in his house and not outside so that the people would not imitate him in this matter.

311. Aisha narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) once came home while a woman was present at that time. He inquired, 'Who is this woman?' I told him the name of the woman and then said, 'She does not sleep at night.' The Messenger (peace be upon him) said, 'One should offer deeds that befit one's capacity. By Allāh! Allāh will not get bored until you get bored [from the act of worship].'" [Aisha added], "The most beloved of deeds to the Messenger (peace be upon him) were those that were performed with consistency."^[357]

Ibn Abdul Barr said,

The scholars understand the part, "Allāh will not get bored until you get bored" to mean that Allāh will continue to reward the individual until he becomes bored of offering the good deed. Boredom in worship arises when one overburdens himself with that which he cannot bear.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

Extremism in worship is of two types. The first type is that which negates the nature of the act of worship. Subsequently, the act is no longer considered to be an act of obedience. Examples of such cases are: a person who adds one unit to an obligatory prayer, fasts everyday or [during the days of *tashrīq*] instead of throwing pebbles, one throws big rocks. The second type is that which causes the person to cease his habitual acts of worship such as praying all night without sleeping, fasting every

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day except the forbidden days and overburdening oneself with anything similar.

Ibn Rajab said,

Performing a good deed that the body can bear throughout its anointed time, during one's weakness and strength will uphold the right path, and whoever performs a deed he cannot bear during weakness and sickness may end up discontinuing it.

312. Abu Sālih narrated: "I enquired from Aisha and Umm Salamah about the act that was the most beloved to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). Both answered, "That deed which was practiced continuously, regardless of its size."

[358]

313. 'Awf ibn Mālik related: "I spent a night with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He brushed his teeth with the *siwāk*, performed ablution and then stood up to commence the prayer, and so I joined him in the prayer. He began reciting Sūrah al-Baqarah [after al-Fātihah] and whenever he came across an ayah about Allāh's mercy, he paused and beseeched Allāh for His Mercy. Likewise, when he came across an ayah regarding His punishment, he paused and sought refuge in Allāh from His punishment. Then, he bowed and remained bowing for as long as he had spent in the standing posture. He recited whilst bowing, '*Subhāna dhil Malakūti wal Jabarūti wal Kibriyā wal 'Adhamah' Dhul Malakūt.*' Then he prostrated for a similar length to the bowing and recited the same in the prostration. Then, he recited [in the second unit] Sūrah al-Imrān and repeated the same in each unit." [359]

Al-Bajūrī said,

Dhul Malakūt means the One with Dominion and Pride. *Dhul Jabarūti* means the Subduer and Surmounter. *Dhul Kibriyā* means the One who transcends all defects and shortcomings

whilst everything submits to Him. *Dhul 'Adhama* means the One Whom nothing can encompass. It is said that *Kibryā* refers to the perfection of His essence while *'Adhamah* refers to the beauty of His Attributes.

Ibn Sayyid al-Nās said,

This is one of the hadīths that provide a vivid insight into his fear of his Lord and his worship.

CHAPTER FORTY FOUR

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE QUR'ĀNIC RECITATION OF THE MESSENGER

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to recite the Qur'ān whilst standing, sitting and lying down. He recited it with ablution and without ablution. The only thing that prevented him from reciting it was the state of major impurity.

314. Ya'lā ibn Mamlak narrated that he asked Umm Salamah about the way the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) recited the Qur'ān, and she described his recitation as clear, thoughtful and slow, letter by letter. ^[360]

Al-Ghazālī said,

The recommended way to recite the Qur'ān is to recite it slowly and clearly (Arabic: *tartīl*). It was narrated that Ibn Abbās said, "I prefer to recite Sūrah al-Baqarah and al-Imrān slowly and contemplate them than reciting the whole Qur'ān hastily."

315. Qatādah narrated: "I asked Anas ibn Mālik, 'How was the recital of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him)?' He replied, 'He prolonged the recitation of Qur'ān.'" ^[361]

Al-Taybī said,

The letters that are prolonged in the recitation of the Qur'ān are three letters, namely (أ – و – ي) and the length of the prolonged

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letter depends on the letter that follows and whether it is paused or not.

316. Umm Salamah narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) recited every ayah separately; he recited ‘*Alhamdulillāhī Rabbil ‘Ālamīn*’ and paused, then recited ‘*Ar-Rahmānir Rahīm*’ and paused. Then he would pause after reciting ‘*Mālikī Yawmiddīn*.’” ^[362]

Al-Sakhawī said,

This is evidence that he (peace be upon him) used to recite Sūrah al-Fātihah audibly.

Ibn Battal said,

He (peace be upon him) used to recite in this way to fulfil the command of Allāh to recite the Qur’ān slowly and thoughtfully. Thus, he (peace be upon him) recited in such a manner to teach his nation the way to recite the Qur’ān and how to contemplate it.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The method of recitation mentioned in this hadīth is the most recommended way. It is better to pause after each ayah even if the following ayah depends on the ayah that precedes it.

317. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abī Qays reported: “I inquired from Aisha about the recital of the Prophet (peace be upon him): whether he recited quietly or audibly. She replied, ‘He recited in both ways; he recited quietly and audibly.’ I said, ‘Praise be to Allāh, who has accorded ease in this matter.’” ^[363]

Al-Nabhānī said,

Ibn Abbās said, “When the Prophet (peace be upon him) recited the Qur’ān in his house, those in the same house would be able

to hear his recital but he would not let it reach [to the ears of those] outside his house.”

318. Umm Hānī' narrated: “I heard the Prophet (peace be upon him) reciting the Qur'ān at night, whilst I was upon my bed.” ^[364]

Al-Qasim ibn Salam said,

Umm Hanī intended to mean that she heard his recitation during the night.

‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’īd al-Hadramī said,

This hadīth refers to an instance when the Prophet (peace be upon him) was in Makkah and he was offering his night prayers next to the Ka’bah. This happened before the time of Hijrah.

319. ‘Abdullāh ibn Mughaffal narrated: “I saw the Prophet (peace be upon him) riding his camel on the day of the conquest of Makkah and he was reciting, {Indeed, We have given you, [O Muhammad], a clear conquest, that Allāh may forgive for you what preceded of your sin and what will follow.} ^[365] He (peace be upon him) recited it and did *tarjī'* ^[366].”

Mu’awiya ibn Qurrah (a narrator of this hadīth) said, “If I did not fear that people would gather around me, I would have recited it for you in the same tone.” ^[367]

‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’īd al-Hadramī said,

This indicates that reciting audibly is better than reciting inaudibly in some places especially when it is to glorify Allāh and awake the heedless. The conquest referred to is either the conquest of Makkah, as reported from Anas ibn Mālik, or Khaybar, as reported from Mujāhid, or the Hudaibiyyah Truce as reported from the majority because it was the basis of all the conquests that followed.

He (peace be upon him) recited the entire Sūrah of al-Fath as stated in the hadīth mentioned by al-Bukharī. *Tarjī'* means the

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coming and going of sound and it often happens due to joy as it happened to the Prophet (peace be upon him) on that day.

320. Qatādah said: “Allāh blessed every Prophet that He had sent with a beautiful face and beautiful voice. Your Prophet (peace be upon him) had a beautiful face and a beautiful voice, and did not recite with *tarjī*’.” ^[368]

Ibn al-Athīr said,

This refers to his recital when he was not riding since the instance of the *tarjī*’ happened while he was riding.

Muhammad ibn Yūsuf al-Shāmī said,

Ibn al-Munīr, al-Zarkashī and others commented on the statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) wherein he mentioned that Prophet Yūsuf was given half of the beauty, saying, “Some people think that the other half of beauty, based on this hadīth, is divided among the rest of people while, in fact, it means that Prophet Yūsuf was given half of the beauty given to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).

321. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Abbās narrated: “The recitation of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was audible enough that it might have been possible that if he recited in the house, those in the courtyard would be able to hear it.” ^[369]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This explains the previous hadīths regarding the audibleness of his recitation, which is to state that if he recited audibly in the night then it would be loud enough to be heard by those who were near to him, meaning he did not recite very loudly.

CHAPTER FORTY FIVE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE CRYING OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Ibn Al-Qayyim said.

The nature of his crying was similar to that of his laughing; he neither laughed out loud nor did he laugh boisterously. Likewise when he cried, he neither wailed nor was his breath taken away due to it. Rather, his eyes would shed tears and a sound would emit from his chest; he cried out of his mercy for the deceased and sometimes he cried out of his concern and mercy for his nation. Sometimes he would cry due to his fear of Allāh, and sometimes when he heard the Qur'ān, due to his love of Allāh. Thus embodying the required combination of love and fear of Allāh.

322. 'Abdullāh ibn Shikhīr narrated: "I entered upon the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) whilst he was praying. Due to his crying, such sound emitted from his chest like that of a boiling kettle." ^[370]

Abdul-Karīm al-Khudair said,

This description given by the narrator is to show the high level of humility and piety of the Prophet (peace be upon him) from the effect of the Qur'ān. However, it is unfortunate that many people enter the prayer and end it without being affected by the Qur'ān they recite. The description given in this hadīth is what happens to those who follow the Prophet's example which

results from the fear of Allāh that one feels whilst standing before Him in the prayer.

You find some people who are touched by the recitation of some individuals but never feel anything when the same ayāt are recited by someone else. This could be due to the beauty of the voice but one ought to be blamed if he only becomes touched by particular voices and does not get touched if the Qur'ān is recited beautifully by other people. This is because a person should feel touched and effected by the words of the Qur'ān, per se, and so the beauty of the voice should serve to help the person to increase this feeling and not be that which makes the person cry.

Sometimes, there are individuals who we hear cry aloud in the prayer. If this happens because the person is overwhelmed and cannot control himself, then the person is not blamed. It is noticed that the effect on some people is short i.e. they cry when they come across an ayah and after the ayah ends, they return to their normal status. It should be noted that the real crying that affects the heart is that which does not end quickly. It was reported that many of the righteous predecessors would fall sick in the next morning because of their crying in the night while praying. Thus, the heart which cannot maintain this effect is indicative of the effect being weak upon it. I saw during the last Ramadān someone who was weeping out loud in the prayer and after the prayer ended he entered into a verbal altercation with other people over some issue. This shows that the heart is still taken away by this worldly life and the sins are not yet cleansed.

323. 'Abdullāh ibn Mas'ūd related: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) once asked me to recite the Qur'ān to him. I said, 'O Messenger of Allāh! How could I recite it to you when it has been revealed to you?' He (peace be upon him) said, 'I love to hear it from other people.' Thereupon I began reciting Sūrah al-Nisā and when I reached this ayah, {But how [will it be with them] when We bring of every people a witness, and We

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bring thee [O Muhammad] a witness against these?}^[371] **I saw tears begin to flow from the eyes of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him)."**^[372]

Al-Qastalanī said,

This effect is what a person would have when listening to the Qur'ān with his heart and not just his ears. Allāh said: **{And when they hear what has been revealed to the Messenger, you see their eyes overflowing with tears because of what they have recognized of the truth.}**^[373]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Ibn Battal said: "It is possible that he (peace be upon him) requested to hear the Qur'ān from Ibn Mas'ūd to show that listening to the Qur'ān is Sunnah (even if the person has memorised it) or to contemplate it and reflect upon it because the listener is more focused and more able to contemplate than the reciter who is busy reciting."

Abū Hafs al-Sūhrawardī said,

This is indeed the truthful manner for listening to the Qur'ān. It is a truthfulness that no two believers would ever dispute over its truthfulness, and evidence testifying to the guidance of the person who is listening in such a lofty manner. The ignited flame of this thoughtful listening overcomes the coldness of certainty, causing the eyes to be flushed with tears. The combination of the element of certainty with the element of attentive and thoughtful listening brings forth different emotions; sometimes it produces grief, which is an enkindled emotion, and some other times it brings forth the flames of yearning, which is an enkindled emotion, and sometimes it sets the fire of regret, which is also an enkindled emotion. If listening to the Qur'ān manages to call forth these emotions from a heart that is filled with the coolness of certainty, the eyes will have no power but

to release the tears therein because water is a result of the engagement between heat and cold. When the heat of listening emerges into the layers of the heart, its effect reflects on the bodily limbs through goose bumps; Allāh said: **{Allāh has sent down the best statement: a consistent Book wherein is reiteration. The skins shiver there from of those who fear their Lord.}**^[374] And when its effect escalates, it reaches into the brain causing the eyes to drop its tears, and when its effect crosses the borders and reaches into the soul, the waves can no longer be constrained within and so crying and disturbance manifest upon the body. Each person, depending on his level, experiences these conditions.

324. 'Abdullāh ibn 'Amr narrated: "In the time of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) there once occurred a solar eclipse. Subsequently, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) began to pray and he stood for such a period that it seemed that he did not intend to bow. He then remained bowing to such an extent that it seemed that he did not intend to rise. Then in the same manner after standing up from bowing, he stood for such a long period that it seemed that he did not intend to prostrate. He remained in the position of prostration for such a long period that it seemed that he did not intend to raise his head. In this manner he did the same after lifting his head and sitting between the two prostrations. He did the same [as he did in the first prostration] in the second one. After he arose from the prostration he began breathing heavily and crying whilst pleading, 'O Allāh! You have promised me that you will not punish them so long as I am among them. O Allāh! You have promised me that you will not punish them while they seek forgiveness. O Allāh! We beseech you for your forgiveness.'

When he (peace be upon him) completed the prayer, the sun had already cleared. Thereupon, he (peace be upon him) delivered a sermon wherein he praised and exalted Allāh then

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he said, 'Indeed, the sun and moon are from the signs of Allāh that do not eclipse because of the death or birth of anyone. Whenever eclipses happen, hasten to resort to the remembrance of Allāh.'" ^[375]

Abdul Karīm al-Khudair said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) refuted the claim of the disbelievers before Islām that eclipses occur because of the death of persons who possess great status. This great sign is taken lightly today because the people perceive it as a mere natural phenomenon whose time of occurrence can be expected based on calculation. In other words, people have started to look at it through the lens of science to the extent that they will buy sunglasses and travel to other countries just to watch an eclipse while they should fear Allāh and rush to perform prayers in light of the guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in this regard.

Muhib al-Dīn al-Tabarī said,

It coincided on this day that the son of the Prophet (peace be upon him) died. The sun would often eclipse, according to their observations, on the twenty eighth or twenty ninth of the month. Thus, when they saw it had eclipsed on the tenth they said it must have eclipsed due to the death of the son of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

Abū al-Hasan al-Nadwī said,

Had this emotional sad event (i.e. the death of the son of the Prophet (peace be upon him)) happened to any other leader, ruler or preacher, the least they would have done is to remain silent so as not to negate the speculations of people about the relation between the event and the occurrence of the eclipse. This is because the occurrence would serve their cause and movements and would allow them to enforce a layer of

glorification that would make people trust them more. However, in this great event, the position of the Prophet (peace be upon him) stands out, drawing the line between Prophets and all other leaders due to his refusal to take advantage of any event to attract more praise and glorification. This is why Allāh (peace be upon him) prescribed to pray upon the occurrence of this event so as to prevent any opportunity for this deviated notion to grow in the hearts of people and strengthen the bond between the people and Allāh .

325. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās related: “One of the daughters of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was on her death bed. He picked her up and placed her before him. Thus she passed away whilst in front of him. Umm Ayman began wailing aloud at her passing. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Are you crying in the presence of the Messenger of Allāh!?’ She said, ‘Do I not see you cry?’ He replied, ‘The tears you see are not from crying, but rather they are a mercy from Allāh. A believer is in a good state at all times, his soul is taken out whilst still praising Allāh.’” ^[376]

‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’īd al-Hadramī said,

It is prohibited to wail loudly but as she saw him shedding tears she thought what she did was permissible. This is why when he (peace be upon him) admonished her act, she replied, “I saw you crying.” Meaning, “I followed your guidance and I thought it is allowed to wail along with shedding the tears.” The response of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was to teach her that he was not crying due to an inability to be patient or due to panic but rather his tears fell due to the mercy that Allāh had planted in his heart. This hadīth does not contradict the hadīth wherein Aisha mentioned that, “The Prophet (peace be upon him) never cried over a dead person; the most he would do was to hold his own beard.” This is because she meant that he never cried due

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to grieving over the deceased but his tears were due to his mercy for his nation.

326. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) kissed [the forehead] of ‘Uthmān ibn Madh’ūn [after his death] and his eyes were shedding tears whilst he was doing so.” ^[377]

Abdul Muhsin al-Abbad said,

This shows that kissing the dead is permissible and there are other hadīths that indicate this permissibility.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

From the guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is to cover the face and body of the deceased and to close the eyes of the person. Sometimes he would kiss the deceased just as he did with ‘Uthmān ibn Madh’ūn.

327. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “We witnessed with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) the burial of one of his daughters. He was sitting next to the grave whilst the tears flowed from his eyes. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Is there any person here who did not have sexual relations today.’ Abū Talhah replied, ‘I did not.’ The Prophet (peace be upon him) told him to enter the grave and so he entered her grave and buried her.” ^[378]

Abdul Muhsin al-Abbad said,

This hadīth indicates that a person who has sexual relations on the same day should not enter the grave to bury the deceased.

Al-Qastalanī said,

The reason Abū Talhah was given precedence over ‘Uthmān (the husband of Umm Kulthūm) was because ‘Uthmān had sexual intercourse with one of his women that night and so the Prophet

(peace be upon him) did not want him to enter the grave of his wife. This was because he did not like that he left his wife on her death bed to fulfil his desires. It is possible that the sickness of his wife was long and 'Uthmān needed to fulfil his desire that night and did not think she may die on the same night.

CHAPTER FORTY SIX

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE BED OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) slept only to provide his body with rest and thus he would not oversleep, sufficing with the amount of sleep that provided this. It is for this reason that he did not sleep upon luxurious mattresses or beds. This is because he had great targets to achieve in his lifetime, due to him being the Messenger of Allāh and the role model for mankind.

328. Aisha narrated: “The bed on which the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) slept upon was made of leather stuffed with the fibre of palm trees.” ^[379]

Al-Qadī 'Iyyād said,

This indicates the permissibility of pillows, sleeping pads and to have sleeping pads that are made of leather and stuffed.

Ibn al-Jawzī said,

Aisha narrated, “A woman from the Ansār visited me and saw that the pad on which the Prophet (peace be upon him) used to lie on was a folded robe so she left and returned with a pad filled with wool. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) came afterwards and saw it so he asked about it. I mentioned to him what happened so he told me to return it three times but as he saw that I liked it and wanted to keep it he said, ‘O Aisha, return

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it for by Allāh if I wanted, Allāh would have given me mountains of gold and silver.”^[380]

329. Muhammad al-Baqir narrated that someone asked Aisha [... to the end of the previous hadith] and then asked Hafsa: “How was the bed of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) in your house?” She replied: “It was a rough canvas made of wool folded into two, which was spread for him to sleep on. On one night we thought if we folded it into four and spread it, it would become more comfortable and so we folded it and spread it that way. In the morning, he asked, ‘What did you spread out for me last night?’ We replied, ‘It was your bed but we folded it into four so that it may become softer.’ He (peace be upon him) said, ‘Leave it in its original state. Its softness prevented me from praying the night prayers.”^[381]

‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’īd al-Hadramī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) thought that his sleeping pad was changed as he noticed it felt softer and he asked his wife to fold it into two layers (the manner in which he was accustomed to) because a softer bed can cause one to fall into deep sleep.

CHAPTER FORTY SEVEN

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE HUMILITY OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Humility is to show kindness in treatment and interaction, and also to refrain from false pride and arrogance. The humility of the Prophet (peace be upon him) manifested in his mannerisms, character and dealings with people as will be explained in this chapter.

330. 'Umar ibn al-Khattab narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Do not over praise me as the Christians over praised Īsa ibn Maryam for I am just a slave of Allāh, so call me the slave of Allāh and His Messenger.'" ^[382]

Ibn Shamah said,

Apart from the fact that the Mawlid is an innovation, it often includes other wrongdoings such as mixing between men and women, songs, musical instruments, liquor and drugs. However, what is even worse is the major shirk committed when they go to extremes towards the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) or any awliyā' by seeking his or their help and believing he knows the future and such similar acts of disbelief that people do when they celebrate the birthday of the Prophet (peace be upon him). They do such acts even though they have been ordered not to go to extremes in praise for him (peace be upon him) as reported in the hadith.

The irony is that many people are enthusiastic, energetic and keen to attend these innovated celebrations whilst you will find them too slack and lazy to attend that which Allāh has dictated for them to attend such as the congregational and Friday prayers and still they do not find their slackness as a serious issue. Evidently, this is due to their weak *imān*, poor insight of their hearts and the many sins that cover their hearts. We ask Allāh to protect us from all of that, for us and all Muslims.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The admonished over praise that is mentioned in this hadīth refers to that which is false praise. This is similar to how the Christians praise Jesus with false praise when they claim that he is the son of God.

331. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “A woman came to the Prophet (peace be upon him) and said, ‘I wish to speak to you in private.’ He replied, ‘Choose any street of Madīnah and I will come there and listen to you.’” ^[383]

Al-Nawawī said,

This hadīth shows the closeness of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to his people and his desire to help people have their rights fulfilled and guide those who need guidance, so that people can see his actions and follow his example. This hadīth does not condone sitting with women in privacy as [the Prophet (peace be upon him) made it a point to meet her in public]. They met on the road and though people were passing by, no one could hear her question as she wanted to ask it in private.

332. Anas ibn Mālik related: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) would visit the sick, attend funerals, ride donkeys and accept the invitations of slaves. On the day of the battle of Banu Quraydhah, he rode upon a donkey, the reigns of which were made of date palm leaves, and the saddle was also made of date palm leaves.” ^[384]

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'Abdullāh ibn Sa'īd said,

Some people preferred solitude and that made them lose the immense reward of these good deeds despite the fact that their solitude brought forth great benefit to them.

The guidance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) when visiting the sick is to sit near his head and then inquire about the condition of the person's health.

He used to attend the *janazah* and witness the burial of the deceased. The way of the Prophet (peace be upon him) when walking in funerals was that his sadness would manifest upon him, he would speak little and he would be engaged in contemplation of the event.

333. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) accepted and attended invitations to places where bread made of barley and days old stale fat was served. The armour he possessed had been pawned to a Jew. [He passed away] without possessing a sufficient amount to release it." ^[385]

'Abdullāh ibn Sa'īd said,

This shows that it is allowed to eat old food so long as it does not cause harm. The story of the armour is that he (peace be upon him) pawned it for thirty *sā'* of barley as stated in *Sahīh al-Bukharī*, and the name of the armour was "Dhāt al-Fudūl" as stated by Ibn al-Qayyim. The reason he (peace be upon him) went to the Jewish man instead of his companions was to show that dealing with Jews and pawnbrokers is permissible and because the companions would not agree to take money from him (peace be upon him) or accept it as a pawn type agreement. The armour was released by Abū Bakr [after the Prophet's (peace be upon him) death] and handed to Alī ibn Abī Tālib. The hadīth also shows the rigorous self-discipline employed by the Prophet (peace be upon him).

334. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) performed Hajj upon an old and worn saddle. On it was a piece of cloth, the value of which did not equate to four Dirhams. He (peace be upon him) supplicated, ‘O Allāh! Make this Hajj one that has no element of showing off or seeking fame.’” ^[386]

Al-Zarqanī said,

Despite the infallibility of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the impossibility that he would do an act for fame or showing off, he asked Allāh to make his Hajj free from these two traits due to his great humility and his consideration of himself as just a normal person. This is because ostentation and seeking fame can easily creep upon someone mounting a fancy ride and wearing fancy garments.

‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’īd said,

Given that Hajj entails detachment from all worldly pleasures, it befitted the most that he (peace be upon him) manifested the highest level of humility in this event.

335. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “There was no individual more beloved to the companions than the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). When they saw him they would not stand up as they knew that he disliked it.” ^[387]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

Al-Nawawī said that the reason he (peace be upon him) disliked them standing up for him is he feared that this would lead to them over glorifying him just as he stated, “Do not over praise me.” However, he did not dislike that they stand up for each other because he stood up for some of his companions and they stood up for other people in his presence and he did not object to this. The other reason is that the level of love and bond

between him and his companions was perfect to the extent that standing up would not have manifested more love or honouring.

336. Al-Hasan ibn 'Alī reported: "I asked my maternal uncle, Hind ibn Abī Hālah, who was known for his skill of describing, about the awe-inspiring characteristics and features of the Prophet (peace be upon him), whilst hoping he could describe to me some of his features to be well acquainted with his description. My maternal uncle described the Prophet (peace be upon him) by saying, 'His qualities and attributes were the acme of beauty, and his companions and whoever saw him held him in high esteem. His face used to shine like the full moon... [To the end of the hadith].'

I withheld this information from al-Hussain but when I shared it with him I realised that he had inquired about it before me and I found out that he had asked our father about the interaction of the Prophet (peace be upon him) both outside and within his house and his features, leaving nothing to inquire about."

Al-Hussain ibn Alī ibn Abī Tālib narrated: "I asked my father about what the Prophet (peace be upon him) did when he was at home. He said: "He (peace be upon him) distributed his time into three portions; one portion for Allāh, another portion for his family and a portion for himself. Then, he distributed his personal portion in two, one for himself and one for the people; in such a manner that he communicated knowledge to the masses through his close companions when they visited him and he did not conceal anything from them. During the portion he dedicated for people, he gave preference to the people of greater piety and status to enter upon him and he distributed this time according to their level of piety. From among those who visited him, some had one need, some had two needs, and some had many needs. He (peace be upon him) sacrificed the time to fulfil all their requirements and busied them in things that would rectify them and the entire nation.

When they inquired on matters related to religion, he replied to them in a manner that benefited them and he used to say, 'Those that are present, should convey to those that are absent regarding these beneficial matters.' He also used to say, 'Those people who for some reason cannot bring forth their needs, you should inform me about them. This is because the person who conveys to a ruler the need of another, who is unable to do so himself, Allāh will keep that person firm on the Day of Judgment.' No issues besides those of importance and benefit were presented to him in his gatherings and he did not accept listening except to that which was beneficial and lawful. The companions came to his assemblies for their religious and lawful needs and they did not depart without enjoying the taste of his knowledge, and they left with guidance for the people.'

I then asked him about his interaction with people outside his house. He replied, 'The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) controlled his tongue, only speaking regarding that which concerned him. He brought unity amongst the people and did not alienate them. He honoured the esteemed ones of every group and made them the leaders of their groups. He warned the people and was cautious when dealing with people to preserve his status among them but he never lacked courtesy towards others.

He inquired about his companions if one of them was absent and he made himself aware about the affairs and conditions of people. He praised good deeds and encouraged them and admonished the misdeeds and discouraged them. He was moderate and consistent in all matters. He did not neglect guiding the people out of fear that they become either heedless or inclined to the worldly pleasures. He was prepared for every scenario, and he established the rights of others in all matters, and did not exceed the limits in this.

Those who were close to him were the best of people, the best of whom in his eyes were the ones who wished everybody

well, and the ones with the highest status in his eyes were the ones with the most compassion, who aided the creation the most.'

I then asked my father regarding the gatherings of the Messenger (peace be upon him). He replied, 'The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) began and ended all of his sittings with the remembrance of Allāh. When he came to a gathering, he sat where there was space available, and instructed the people to do the same. He gave every attendee his due respect and rights to a degree that led every individual present to think that he (peace be upon him) was honouring him the most. When an individual came to sit with him or came regarding some issue, he (peace be upon him) would remain seated until that person began to rise. Whenever he was asked for something, he would fulfil that request, and did not refuse it; [if he did not possess that which was required] he would advise the person with soft and kind words. His affection and good manners were for all and not restricted to certain people. He was like a father to them and he was just and fair with each one of them.

His gatherings were the gatherings of knowledge, humility, patience and trustworthiness. In his gatherings, voices were not raised and vile and unlawful topics were refrained from. If anyone committed a fault, it was not publicised. All were regarded as equals amongst themselves and superiority was according to the piety possessed. Therein the old were respected, the young were loved, the needy were given preference, and strangers and travellers were cared for and his gems were observed attentively and memorised.'" ^[388]

'Abdullāh ibn Sa'īd said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) did not talk unless there was a need, be it related to religion or worldly affairs, following the guidance of the ayah: **{And they who turn away from idle**

speech]^[389] and he would repeat his speech twice or thrice to ensure the listeners understood and memorised his statements.

He (peace be upon him) used to bring the hearts of people together and removed all disputes and animosity from their hearts so that they became like one person and he did not do anything that could cause dispute due to his overwhelming compassion and forgiveness.

He (peace be upon him) inquired about the affairs of people to see if there were cases of injustice to be removed, rights to be restored or oppressed people to help. This manner should be followed by the rulers, scholars and pious people and anyone who has followers as they should follow up the news of their followers to avoid neglecting them.

He (peace be upon him) drew close to the best of his people because they would benefit the most from his knowledge and learn it. The teacher should make his best students stay close to him because this will ensure that those who will be entrusted with knowledge are those whose piety is trusted.

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Al-Hasan did not inform al-Hussain about his inquiry about the description of the Prophet (peace be upon him) but later on he found out that al-Hussain had already enquired about it. So he asked him regarding what he had acquired since al-Hussain had collected more information than him.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) was cautious in his interactions due to the fact that people are of different natures; there are the rude, the aggressive, the kind and the well-mannered etc. Thus, he dealt with each individual in a suitable and appropriate manner to keep everyone close to him.

This hadīth proves that the virtue of the companions differs from one to another. The best of them was Abū Bakr, then 'Umar, then Uthmān, then Alī, and then the ten companions who were given the glad tidings of Paradise.

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Fatherhood is of two types, religious and biological. The former is established for the Prophet (peace be upon him), meaning he is the father of all believers and the latter is negated, as stated in the Qur'ān: **{Muhammad is not the father of [any] one of your men, but [he is] the Messenger of Allah and last of the prophets. And ever is Allah, of all things, Knowing.}**^[390]

337. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘Even if the foot of a goat was gifted to me, I would accept it, and if I was invited to eat from it, I would surely accept that invitation.’”^[391]

Ibn Battal said,

Al-Muhallab said, “This hadīth shows that one should show humility, refrain from arrogance and bring the hearts together by accepting the invitation even if it is for something minute and by accepting gifts. This is because these acts confirm the bond between people and invitations for food cannot be given unless this bond of affability pre-exists between people. It is for these reasons that the Messenger (peace be upon him) encouraged accepting the gift (even if it is little) and answering the invitation of people.

338. Jabir narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) came to visit me [while I was sick] and he did not come on the back of a mule or on a Turkish horse.”^[392]

Ibn Battal said,

This hadīth teaches us that visiting the sick whether on a ride or by foot is a rewarding deed when the intention is sincerely for the sake of Allāh alone, even if the effort required to reach the sick is minimal.

Badr al-Din al-'Aynī said,

This hadīth shows the virtue of walking over riding when visiting the sick as it shows more humility.

339. Yūsuf ibn ‘Abdullāh ibn Salām reported: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) named me Yūsuf and he put me on his lap and then wiped his hand over my head.” ^[393]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is recommended for a person of high esteem, whose example is followed to name the children of his companions and to choose for them good names. This hadīth also shows that the names of the Prophets are good names.

340. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) performed Hajj upon an old and worn saddle. Upon it was a piece of cloth, the value of which was less than four *dirhams*. He (peace be upon him) supplicated, ‘O Allāh! Make this Hajj one that has no element of showing off or seeking fame.’” ^[394]

341. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “A tailor once invited the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) to his home. Tharīd was served, in which pumpkin was added, and he (peace be upon him) began eating it as he liked the pumpkin.” Anas added, “After that, whenever food was prepared for me, if pumpkin could be added to it, it was added.” ^[395]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Tharīd is a dish made of pieces of bread in meat broth. This dish may or may not include pieces of meat. This hadīth shows that it is recommended to like all that which the Prophet (peace be upon him) liked.

342. ‘Amrah reported that someone asked Aisha: “What was the normal routine of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) at home?” She replied: “He was a man from amongst men. He himself removed anything that was attached to his clothing, milked his goats, and did all of his work himself.” ^[396]

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Abū Bakr ibn al-Arabī said,

The best work that a person can do individually without the help of others is the acts of worship so that they are all sincerely for Allāh alone. This includes doing everything that leads to these acts of worship as that will amplify the reward.

Al-Taybī said,

The reason Aisha mentioned first that he (peace be upon him) was a man is because disbelievers believed that it does not befit the status of Prophets to do what normal people do. Their belief was mentioned in the Qur'ān wherein Allāh said: **{And they say, "What is this messenger that eats food and walks in the markets?"}**^[397] And so she wanted to show that he (peace be upon him) was simply a man from the sons of Ādam whom Allāh honoured with Prophethood and the Message. Thus, he was like all other humans and humble in all of his affairs.

CHAPTER FORTY EIGHT

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE CHARACTER OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The character consists of inward etiquettes such as shyness, patience and generosity, and outward etiquettes such as cheerful countenance, good treatment, and honesty in speech.

The character of the Prophet (peace be upon him) is the most perfect of all characters for his character resembled the Qur'an.

343. Khārijah ibn Zayd ibn Thābit related: "A group of people came to Zayd ibn Thābit and requested him to tell them about the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He replied, 'What should I tell you? I was his neighbour and he used to send for me every time something was revealed to him, so that I could transcribe it for him. If we entered into discussion regarding worldly affairs, he would join us in doing so. If we entered into discussion regarding the Hereafter, he would join us in doing so. If we entered into discussion regarding food, he also did so. All of this that I have stated regarding him is factual.'" ^[398]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Zayd ibn Thābit was one of the scribes of the Qur'ān who transcribed it directly from the mouth of the Prophet (peace be upon him). He was the most knowledgeable companion in the science of inheritance and one of the most esteemed Qur'ān reciters.

He (peace be upon him) mentioned that he was the neighbour of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to show his closeness to him in terms of location and companionship and to indicate that he was more familiar with him than other companions.

The Prophet (peace be upon him) joined their conversations because this life is the farmland of deeds where people plant their seeds to reap the harvest in the Hereafter. Thus, he would join them in order to help them survive this life and to reach the Hereafter safe. This is why he joined their conversations regarding the Hereafter, to inspire them towards the attainment of good deeds. The mentioning of food indicates that he (peace be upon him) showed them its benefits and etiquettes.

In summary he (peace be upon him) used to join them in conversation so that they would not become bored and share with them through the means of conversation, religious rulings and exhortations.

344. 'Amr ibn al-ʿĀs reported: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) embraced and spoke to vile people with a cheerful countenance to soften their hearts. He used to embrace me and speak to me in a manner that made me feel that I was the best amongst the people. I asked, 'O Messenger of Allāh! Who is better, me or Abū Bakr?' He replied, 'Abū Bakr.' I then asked, 'Am I better, or is 'Umar?' He replied, "Umar.' I asked, 'Am I better or is 'Uthmān?' He replied, "Uthman.' After I asked him these questions and he told me the truth, I wished I had not asked him such." ^[399]

'Abdullāh ibn Sa'īd said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to embrace people with a cheerful countenance to either make them more inclined towards Islām, to aid them in remaining steadfast in religion or to avoid their evil. It is allowed to avoid the evil of bad people by showing them a cheerful countenance but it is not allowed to praise the evil people as this constitutes lying.

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The extra attention he (peace be upon him) gave them does not contradict the fact that he gave equal attention to all of his companions. This is because that (i.e. giving them equal attention) was the case in normal circumstances when there was no necessity or need to show more attention. From the benefits of meeting vile people with cheerful countenance is that it prevents arrogance and pride.

The reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) showed more attention to 'Amr ibn al-'Ās is because he was new to Islām and from the leaders of his tribe.

The reason he regretted enquiring such is because he thought the attention and good treatment he received was due to his status in the religion but then he realised it was to soften his heart. It is for this reason a person should not ask about a matter before verifying it, in order to avoid embarrassment.

The kind of mannerisms mentioned in this hadīth reflects the ayah: **{So by mercy from Allāh, [O Muhammad], you were lenient with them. And if you had been rude [in speech] and harsh in heart, they would have disbanded from about you. So pardon them and ask forgiveness for them and consult them in the matter.}**^[400]

345. Anas ibn Mālik related: "I served the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) for ten years. He never once said *uff* to me and he never asked me the reason behind anything I did, nor did he ever ask me the reason behind anything that I left. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was the most beautiful of people in character. I have never felt any fabric, pure silk or anything else softer than his palm. Nor did I smell any musk or any other fragrance, with a sweeter scent than the perspiration of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him)."

^[401]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The act of refraining from asking others regarding things that have been done or not done shows that one should avoid blaming others for things that have already occurred. It shows that one should safeguard his tongue from admonishing and rebuking others [for actions that have no religious implications] and that one should soften the heart of the servant by not admonishing him if it is regarding something personal (i.e. worldly) but issues related to religion must be addressed.

The softness of his hands and pleasant scent of his body indicates the perfect character and features of the Prophet (peace be upon him) for the pleasant scent he possessed was due to his interactions with angels.

346. Anas ibn Mālik reported: “A man wearing a yellow coloured garment sat with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) and the habit of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was that he would often avoid bluntly expressing things that other people would dislike. After the man left, he said to those who were present, ‘It would have been better if you told him not to wear yellow clothing.’” ^[402]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) tended to avoid saying or doing something to an individual if that was something that the person would dislike. The reason he (peace be upon him) did not ask the individual to remove it directly, though wearing yellow clothes is not allowed, is because it was not yet made forbidden otherwise he (peace be upon him) would have not postponed giving the advice. This is supported by another hadīth wherein the Prophet (peace be upon him) saw ‘Amr ibn al-‘Ās wearing yellow garments and ordered him to remove them right away. If someone asks why the Prophet (peace be upon him) ordered ‘Amr bluntly but delegated this task to the other companions in the case of the man mentioned in this hadīth, the answer is: ‘Amr was wearing something that was

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deemed unlawful while at the time of the other incident it was not yet made forbidden. And, if we assume that wearing yellow clothing is not forbidden, then the answer is: it could be that the man was a new Muslim, and he (peace be upon him) feared that such a blunt direct order would lead to an undesired outcome whilst in the case of 'Amr, he would be very happy to hasten to obey the Messenger (peace be upon him).

The argument of some who said that he (peace be upon him) disliked the colour yellow because it is a distinguishing sign of the Jews is incorrect. This is because this colour was made as the sign that distinguishes them from Muslims only recently as it happened in some countries like Egypt. Ibn Abī Hajlah mentioned that the Christians wore blue turbans, the Jews wore yellow turbans and al-Samirah wore red turbans in 701 H. The reason they wore such distinctive colours is because it happened that one day a man from Morocco was sitting at the door of a castle and a Christian man came wearing a white turban. Thereupon, the Moroccan man got up and stood in respect thinking he was a Muslim. However after he realised that he was a Christian, he went to the Sultan, Al-Nasir Muhammad ibn Qalawūn and requested the change of the dress code of the non-Muslims living in the lands of Islām so that they could be distinguished from the Muslims and he accepted his request.

347. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was never indecent or offensive. Nor did he shout in the market. He did not respond to a bad deed with a bad deed. Rather, he forgave and pardoned it.” ^[403]

Bakr Abū Zayd said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) was selective in his words and he was always keen to use the most respectful and kindest words which were far from the words used by rude and vulgar people. He disliked giving respectful titles to those who did not

deserve them and also using insulting words against those who should be honoured. For example, he prevented people from addressing the hypocrite with the title “master” and from calling Abū Jahl with the *kunya* Abul Hakam, or a slave person from calling his master ‘my lord’ and a master calling his slave “my slave”. Rather, he directed the master to say “my boy” or “my girl” and the slave to say to their masters “my master” etc.

348. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) never hit anything or anyone with his hands, unless he was fighting in the Path of Allāh, and he did not hit a servant or a woman.” ^[404]

Ibn Abdul Barr said,

This hadīth indicates that it is recommended for rulers and scholars not to avenge themselves. By doing so, they follow the example of the Prophet (peace be upon him) by forgiving those who were unjust to them.

349. Aisha narrated: “I have never seen the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) avenge the injustice he was subjected to unless there was a case where the laws of Allāh were transgressed or broken. If the laws of Allāh were transgressed, there was no one angrier than him. If the situation arose where he was given a choice between two things, he always chose the one that was easier, unless it was sinful.” ^[405]

Ibn Abdul Barr said,

There are three benefits concluded from this hadīth:

1. It is recommended for rulers and scholars not to avenge themselves, thereby following the example of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and to forgive those who show injustice towards them. The scholars agreed that the judge cannot judge in a case in which he is involved.
2. It is allowed to take concessions.

3. The Messenger (peace be upon him) never avenged in personal matters related to worldly affairs. As for the cases where he was abused verbally, then it is mandatory to avenge because this is from the rights of Allāh and it is an act of disbelief. If a person apostates then he cannot be left without a punishment.

350. Aisha narrated: “A man sought permission from the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) to enter his presence whilst I was with him. He (peace be upon him) said, ‘What a wretched person is he amongst his community,’ and then he gave him permission to enter. After the person entered, he spoke in a kind manner to him. When the man left I said, ‘O Messenger of Allāh! You said what you said before he entered and then you spoke so kindly to him!’ The Messenger (peace be upon him) said, ‘O Aisha! Indeed, from the vilest are those who people avoid to avert their wickedness.’” ^[406]

Al-Khattabī said,

The fact that the Prophet (peace be upon him) mentioned the bad trait of this man in his absence does not make it an act of backbiting. This is because this kind of statement is intended to warn people from the person and admonish others from following his ways. It is possible that the wickedness of the man was done in public and in religion mentioning the wrongdoing of a person who does it in public is not considered backbiting.

Ibn Battal said,

Whoever Allāh has guided to take the path of sensibility to accustom his tongue to saying good words follows the example of the Prophets. They are indeed the best role models that all should follow. This hadīth shows that it is not considered backbiting when mentioning the public sins of a *fāsiq* (a person who does sins in public). It also indicates that kindness should be employed towards the *fāsiq* if there is a benefit hoped from

him. The person mentioned in this hadīth is 'Uyaynah ibn Badr al-Fazarī who was the leader of his people and he was known as, "The idiot who people obey." The Prophet (peace be upon him) hoped with his kind treatment towards him that he would embrace Islām and subsequently his people would follow suit in doing so.

351. Al-Hasan ibn Alī narrated that al-Hussain ibn Alī said: "I inquired from my father regarding the conduct of the Prophet (peace be upon him) with his company. He replied, 'The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) maintained a cheerful countenance and he was easy mannered. He was soft-natured; neither rude nor harsh, and neither stone-hearted nor loud or offensive in his speech. He did not mention the faults of anything and he was not narrow-minded or argumentative. If he heard or saw something he disliked he would turn his attention away as if he did not notice it. He did not make people fall into despair or feel disheartened, and he did not respond negatively to the requests that he disliked. He refrained from three traits related to himself: stubbornness in arguments (in some versions: pretension), excessiveness (in some versions: pride), and that which did not concern him. He refrained from three traits related to people: he did not disgrace or insult anyone, nor look for the hidden faults of others; he only spoke that from which reward was hoped.

When he spoke, those present bowed their heads in such a manner, as if birds were perched upon them. When he was silent, the others would begin speaking. They would not dispute in his presence regarding anything and whenever a person spoke to him the others would keep quiet and listen until he would finish. They would speak in order (i.e. the first person to arrive would be the first person to speak and so forth). When those around him laughed due to some reason, he would laugh as well and he would show surprise at the things that surprised the people. He exercised patience at the crude

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and indecent questions of the traveller and his companions would bring travellers to his assemblies. He used to say to his companions, 'When you see a person in need, always help that person.' If someone praised him, he would detest it unless it came from someone, who in the process of giving thanks praised him. He did not interrupt someone speaking. However, if one exceeded the limits he would stop him or would get up and leave." ^[407]

'Abdullāh ibn Sa'īd said,

The cheerful countenance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) does not negate the sad state of his heart due to his concern about the Hereafter and his nation.

He (peace be upon him) never uttered a word or did something that hurt others without any lawful right. He was merciful and soft-hearted with the believers. He never dispraised a food or anything lawful and this does not contradict that he dispraised the forbidden and admonished it.

If someone asked him for something that he disliked, he would not make the person hopeful to achieve it nor resigned to give up on it. Rather, he would remain silent.

This hadīth manifests the perfect character of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

352. Jābir ibn 'Abdullāh narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was never asked of something to which he said 'No.'" ^[408]

Al-Nawawī said,

This shows the excessive generosity of the Prophet (peace be upon him) for he was never asked for anything from this worldly life except that he agreed to give it away.

Ibn al-Uthaymīn said,

This hadīth along with other hadīths encourages us to spend for the sake of Allāh for Allāh has provided people with money to test them. Allāh said: **{Your wealth and your children are but a trial and Allāh has with Him a great reward.}**^[409] Thus, some people spend it to fulfil their unlawful desires and pleasures which keep them distant from Allāh whilst some other people spend it in the path of Allāh seeking His reward. As for those who spend it in matters that are neither prescribed in religion nor forbidden, then they have just wasted their wealth.

353. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was the most generous amongst the people in performing good deeds. He would increase in generosity during the month of Ramadān until the month’s end. In this month Jibra’īl used to visit him and recite the Qur’ān to him. Every time Jibra’īl met him, the generosity of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was more than that of a wind that brings forth heavy rains.” ^[410]

Ibn Battal said,

Al-Muhallab said, “This hadīth shows the benefits and blessings of being in the company of pious and righteous people as this reminds the person to do good deeds and increase his share from good deeds. This is why the Prophet (peace be upon him) ordered us to sit with the learned ones and spend time in the gatherings of Allāh’s remembrance and gave the example of the righteous friend as the perfume seller. It also shows the blessings attained through good deeds and that a good deed leads to another i.e. the blessing of fasting, meeting Jibra’īl and reciting the Qur’ān increased the generosity of the Prophet (peace be upon him).

354. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) would not store anything for the following day.” ^[411]

Al-Qastalanī said,

It is permissible to store the food for one's wife and children and this does not negate reliance on Allāh because the Prophet (peace be upon him) did it and he is the master of those who rely on Allāh. This is because taking the means (whilst the reliance on Allāh is established in the heart) does not contradict one's reliance. The fact that he (peace be upon him) stored for his family their sustenance for one year does not contradict that he did not store anything for the next day because this was either before he had access to sustenance or it means that he did not store anything for himself.

355. 'Umar ibn al-Khattab narrated: "A man came to the Prophet (peace be upon him) asking for something. The Prophet (peace be upon him) replied, 'I do not have anything at present but go and purchase something on my name and I will pay for it when I have sufficient money.' 'Umar said, 'O Messenger of Allāh! You have already given him that which you had and Allāh did not make you responsible for that which is beyond your means.' The Messenger (peace be upon him) disliked this statement of 'Umar. A man from the Ansār said, 'O Messenger of Allāh! Spend whatever you wish, and do not fear any diminution from the Lord of the Throne.' The Messenger (peace be upon him) smiled and the happiness could be seen on his face due to the statement of the man. He (peace be upon him) then said, 'With this I have been ordered.'" ^[412]

Abdullah ibn Sa'īd said,

The statement of 'Umar either meant that he (peace be upon him) gave to that person before, therefore there was no need to promise him more since he (peace be upon him) did not have anything at that time or that he (peace be upon him) answered the man in a kind manner when he explained that he did not have anything to give away. The reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) disliked the statement of 'Umar is that it made the man feel disappointed and that the promise made was not

considered a burden given that he used to be lavished with the blessings of Allāh.

356. Al-Rubayyi' bint Mu'awwidh ibn 'Afrā narrated: "I took a plate of ripe dates (*rutab*) and small cucumbers to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He gave me a handful of jewellery, or a handful of gold." ^[413]

357. Aisha narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) accepted gifts and would reciprocate in return." ^[414]

Al-Khattabī said,

Accepting gifts is a form of generosity and from the kind manners that bring hearts together and it was reported that he (peace be upon him) ordered people to exchange gifts as that will bring forth love between people. The acceptance of gifts was one of the signs of his prophethood mentioned in previous scriptures wherein he was described as a person who accepts gifts and does not take charity. The Prophet (peace be upon him) used to reward those who gave him gifts so that no one could have the upper hand over him or hold favours over him. Allāh said: **{O my people, I do not ask you for it any reward. My reward is only from the one who created me. Then will you not reason?}** ^[415] And if he (peace be upon him) accepted gifts without rewarding those who presented the gifts, it would have been as if he was receiving rewards for his mission. It is for this reason, giving gifts to rulers is considered a form of bribery because it was not allowed for the Messenger (peace be upon him) to accept gifts without reciprocating or to take without giving, and he is the leader and master of all humanity.

CHAPTER FORTY NINE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE MODESTY AND SHYNESS OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The quality of *haya'* is an attribute that brings forth nothing but good and it is one of the parts of *imān*. It induces the person to do the good in all of his affairs, be it related to worship, etiquettes or social life. It also keeps the person away from the ugly sins, wrongdoings and ill-manners.

358. Abū Sa'īd al-Khudarī narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) was the most modest, more so than a virgin in her private quarters. If he did not like something, we could notice that on his face." ^[416]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

Al-Qadī 'Iyyād said, "Shyness and modesty were made part of *imān* though it is a human instinct. For a characteristic to fall in line with the guidelines of religion [rather than being a mere human instinct], one would need to establish the intention, endeavour and possess the knowledge to do so. As for stating that shyness brings about nothing but goodness, it is found problematic because someone may argue that sometimes shyness prevents one from facing and stopping a wrongdoer or not fulfilling rights and obligations. The answer to this is that there are two types of shyness; one that conforms to religion and that does not lead to the aforementioned weakness whilst

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the other type is given the same name (i.e. shyness) because it shares the trait of preventing one from low and ugly acts.

Abū al-'Abbās al-Qurtubī said that cultivated shyness is the type of shyness that Allāh has made part of *imān* and the characteristic that people ought to acquire. However, the instinctual type of shyness could support the attained shyness and it could integrate with the attained shyness until the prescribed shyness becomes an innate nature and the Prophet (peace be upon him) enjoyed both types; his instinctual shyness made him more modest than a virgin girl in her private quarters and his attained shyness elevated him to the highest status.

359. Aisha reported: "I never looked towards the private parts of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), [or she said] that I never saw the private parts of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him)." ^[417]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This hadīth manifests the perfect level of shyness possessed by the Prophet (peace be upon him) because he did not do anything that would allow her to look at his private parts. This is because a woman would not dare to see the private parts of her husband unless he would allow it and give his consent.

CHAPTER FIFTY

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE CUPPING OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Cupping is a medical treatment that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had administered upon himself many times and he paid the cupper for it. He also encouraged it and stated that it is a cure. Ibn Abbas narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) said "Healing is in three things: in the incision of the cupper, in drinking honey, and in cauterizing with fire, but I forbid my Ummah (nation) from cauterization (branding with fire)."^[418]

360. Anas ibn Mālik was asked about the ruling on the income of the cupper. He said: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had the treatment of cupping administered upon him by Abū Taybah. In return, he (peace be upon him) gave Abū Taybah two *sā'* of food, and interceded on his behalf with his masters that the stipulated labour tax imposed upon him be reduced. He also said, 'Indeed the best of treatments is cupping.'"^[419]

Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūrī said,

This hadīth shows that it is allowed to charge fees for medical treatment and it is recommended to intercede for people so that the person receiving the request reduces some of their rights and becomes easy with others in this regard. It shows that it is permissible for the master to let his slave work independently in

return of a fixed payment with the rest of the earnings going to the slave.

The scholars differed on the ruling of the income of the cupper, the majority stated that it is lawful as stated by al-Hafith ibn Hajar.

361. Alī ibn Abī Tālib narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) had the treatment of cupping administered upon him and ordered me to pay the cupper his fees, so I did.” [420]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Ibn al-Jawzī mentioned that the Prophet (peace be upon him) disliked the income of cuppers because cupping is from the things that Muslims ought to offer for free when it is required by fellow Muslims.

362. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) had the treatment of cupping administered on both sides of his neck and the top area between his shoulders, and paid the cupper his fees. Had it been forbidden to charge fees for cupping, he would have not paid it.” [421]

Alī al-Qārī said,

It is proven in many hadīths that he had cupping administered on different parts of his body depending on the treatment needed on each occasion. The majority of scholars relied on this hadīth amongst others to state that the income of cuppers is lawful.

363. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Umar narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) requested a cupper to treat him. After he finished, he (peace be upon him) inquired from him regarding the amount of labour tax he paid his master. The cupper replied, ‘Three sāl.’ So he (peace be upon him) had it reduced to two sāl’, and gave him his remuneration.” [422]

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Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The name of the cupper mentioned in this hadīth is said to be Abū Taybah as mentioned in the previous hadīth.

364. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to have the treatment of cupping administered upon both sides of his neck and between the two shoulders. He used to take this treatment on the seventeenth, nineteenth or the twenty first of the lunar month.” ^[423]

Ibn Muflih said,

The reason why the Prophet (peace be upon him) cupped the top area between the shoulders is because this is the closest area to the heart which can be cupped.

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

The administration of cupping on both sides of the neck can treat sicknesses related to the head and its parts such as the face, teeth, ears, eyes, nose and throat if the sickness is due to excessive or corrupted blood.

‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’īd said,

The companions used to follow his example in choosing the time for cupping as they liked doing it on the odd nights of the month. This is due to the virtue of odd numbers as Allāh loves odd numbers. The best day to have cupping administered is on a Monday if it coincides with the seventeenth, nineteenth or twenty first of the month.

365. Anas bin Mālīk narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had cupping administered upon the top of his foot at a place called Malal whilst he was in the state of *ihrām*.”

^[424]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Malal is a place between Makkah and Madīnah. It is about seventeen miles away from Madīnah.

It is allowed to administer cupping whilst a person is still in the state of *ihrām* if the treatment does not include removing hair; otherwise it is considered to be forbidden unless there is a necessity and in such a case the person is required to slaughter a sacrifice as expiation.

CHAPTER FIFTY ONE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE NAMES OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The names of the Prophet are more than just names as they reflect his character and nature.

366. Jubair ibn Mu'tim narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'I have many names. I am Muhammad, I am Ahmad. I am al-Māhi [the obliterator] with whom Allāh obliterates disbelief. I am al-Hāshir [the gatherer] as the people will be gathered after I am gathered [on the Day of Resurrection], and I am al-'Āqib [i.e. the one who succeeds the other Prophets in bringing about good], after whom there will come no prophet." ^[425]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) will be the first one to be resurrected as stated in the authentic hadīth. His other agreed upon names that are mentioned in the Qur'ān are: al-Shāhid (the witness), al-Mubashir (giver of glad tidings), al-Nadhīr al-Mubīn (the evident warner), al-Dā'ī ila Allāh (caller to Allāh), al-Sirāj al-Munīr (enlightening luminary), al-Mudhakir (the reminder), al-Rahmah (the mercy), al-Ni'mah (the grace), al-Hādi (the guide), al-Amīn (the trustworthy), al-Muzzamil (enwrapped in his raiment), and al-Muddathir (the one shrouded in his mantle).

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367. Hudhaifah narrated: "I once met the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) in one of the roads of Madīnah. He said, 'I am Muhammad, and I am Ahmad, and I am the Prophet of Mercy, the Prophet of Repentance, I am Muqaffā (the last Prophet), I am al-Hāshir (the first one to be gathered), and the Prophet of the battlefield.'" ^[426]

Ibn al-Jawzī said,

Ibn Qutaybah said, "From the signs and evidence regarding the coming of the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him) is that his name (i.e. Ahmad or Muhammad) was prophesied in the previous scriptures and yet no one was given it before him. This was so that Allāh could protect this name and avert any doubts and false claims should someone be named with it. Thus, when his time came and the People of the Book spread the news that he was about to come out, his name was given."

Al-Taybī said,

He is the Prophet of the battlefield because of his keenness for *jihad* and the great courage he possessed on the battlefield.

368. The same is reported from Hudhaifah through another route.

CHAPTER FIFTY TWO

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE MANNER OF LIVING OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The subject of this chapter has already been addressed in chapter nine under which two hadīths were listed, and it is addressed here again to emphasise his (peace be upon him) concern regarding the Hereafter and his disinterest regarding the worldly pleasures.

369. Al-Nu'mān ibn Bashīr said: "You are in enough luxury to eat and drink all that you wish! By Allāh, I have seen your Prophet (peace be upon him) not having the worst type of dates to fill his stomach." ^[427]

370. Aisha narrated: "We, the family of Muhammad (peace be upon him) would pass a whole month without kindling a fire in our homes. [During this time] we would sustain ourselves on dates and water." ^[428]

Abū Bakr ibn al-Arabī said,

Al-Tirmidhī reported from al-Zubair ibn al-'Awwām that when the ayah: **{Then you will surely be asked that Day about the delight [you indulged in, in this world]}^[429]** was revealed, he asked, "O Messenger of Allāh! What delight will we be asked about when all that we have is just dates and water?" The Prophet (peace be upon him) replied, "Indeed, it will happen." ^[430]

Ibn Battal said,

This shows the rigorous self-denial and self-restraint of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and his favouring of the Hereafter over the worldly pleasures. This is because when he was given the choice between receiving the pleasures of this worldly life and the pleasures of the Hereafter, he chose the latter, and when he was given the choice either to be a Prophet and a slave to Allāh or a Prophet who is a king, he chose the former. It is also an evidence for those who favour poverty over possessing riches.

371. Abu Talhah narrated: “We complained to the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) regarding the hunger we suffered, and showed him the stones fastened on our stomachs. Thereupon, he (peace be upon him) raised his garment and revealed two stones that he had fastened onto his stomach.”

Al-Tirmidhī said: “They fastened stones on their stomachs due to the severe exhaustion and hunger they suffered from.”

[431]

Alī al-Qārī said,

It was said that the benefit of fastening a stone onto the stomach is that it averts intestinal emphysema, gives support to the back and thus allows easy movement. Al-Hafith ibn Hajar mentioned that this was the habit of Arabs or the people of Madīnah.

372. Abu Hurairah narrated: “Once, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) exited his house at such a time that he would not normally leave his home, a time at which people would not meet him. Abū Bakr came to him and so he (peace be upon him) asked, ‘O Abū Bakr! Why have you come out?’ Abū Bakr replied, ‘I came out to meet the Messenger of Allāh, to look at his face and greet him.’

Soon after, ‘Umar came and so he (peace be upon him) said, ‘O Umar! Why have you come out?’ ‘Umar replied, ‘O Messenger of Allāh, due to hunger!’ The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, ‘I too am slightly hungry.’ They then proceeded

to the house of Abū al-Haytham al-Tayhān al-Ansārī. He owned many date palms, trees and sheep, but he did not have any servants. However, after arriving, they did not find him present. They asked his wife, 'Where is your husband?' She replied, 'He has gone to bring us fresh water.' It was not long until he arrived whilst carrying a water bag with difficulty. He placed it to the ground, embraced the Prophet (peace be upon him) and said, 'May my father and mother be sacrificed for you.'

He then invited them to his garden where he spread out for them a mat to sit upon and then went to a palm tree and brought a large cluster of dates, placing it before his guests. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'Why did you not just pick for us the ripe ones [rather than bringing forth a whole cluster?]' The host replied, 'O Messenger of Allāh! I wanted that you could eat what pleases you from it.' They ate from the ripe dates and drank from the water. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'I swear by the One in whose Hand is my soul that this is also included amongst those blessings of which one will be asked on the Day of Judgment; the cool shadow, fresh and pure dates, and cold water.'

Abū al-Haytham then went to prepare some food, and the Prophet (peace be upon him) said to him, 'Do not slaughter a sheep that gives milk.' So, he slaughtered for them a sheep that had not yet reached four months. After they ate, the Prophet (peace be upon him) asked the host, 'Do you have any servants?' He replied, 'No.' The Prophet (peace be upon him) replied, 'When we receive captives of war, remind us.'

Thus at a later point, two slaves were brought to the Messenger (peace be upon him) upon which Abū al-Haytham came to the Prophet (peace be upon him) who said to him, 'Pick from them.' He (peace be upon him) said, 'O Messenger of Allāh! I would prefer if you chose for me.' The Prophet (peace be upon him) said, 'The one whose advice is sought ought to be

honest in his advice. I hence choose this slave for you, as I saw him praying. My advice to you is to treat him well.'

Abū al-Haytham went to his wife, and told her what the Messenger (peace be upon him) had advised him to do with the slave. His wife said, 'You will not be able to fulfil that which the Prophet (peace be upon him) has commanded except by freeing him.' He said, 'Then, he is free.' The Prophet (peace be upon him) said, 'Allāh has not sent a Prophet or a vicegerent except that He (peace be upon him) made for them two types of close advisers. One of which ordains the good and forbids the evil. The other tries to corrupt the individual. The one that is saved from the corrupt advisor is saved from ruin and destruction.'" ^[432]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

It is evident that the Prophet (peace be upon him) experienced periods of time when he had nothing and periods of time when he possessed riches but it was his habit to distribute the wealth he received between the needy ones and spending upon the army and delegates etc.

Al-Hulaymī said in *Shu'ab al-Imān* that the Prophet (peace be upon him) should be given his due respect by not describing him as a poor person. Al-Badr al-Zarkashī quoted some latter jurists who said the Prophet (peace be upon him) was not poor; rather he was rich for Allāh sufficed him in his worldly life.

The *fiqh* of this hadith is:

- It is permissible to express one's pain and hunger if it is intended to help oneself to endure it. This is because if the intent is to complain, it is ugly and disliked.
- It is allowed to drink fresh water and look for it and that does not contradict *zuhd*.
- Serving one's family is from the good manners and humbleness.

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- It is recommended to honour the guest and show happiness for hosting them.
- It is recommended to serve fruit before serving the food and to hasten serving the food that can be eaten right away, especially if the host believes the guest is hungry. Some of the *salaf* disliked the host burdening himself with that which is beyond his capacity as that will affect one's sincerity and may result in showing worry.
- The host should serve the best food he has even if this may take more time to cook.
- It is allowed to eat to a full stomach and the hadīths condemning overeating relate to when it is harmful or when it becomes regular as this hardens the heart and makes one forget about the needy ones.
- Al-Nawawī said, "The mention of the questioning on the Day of Judgement regarding the bounties that Allāh has bestowed upon us, which is mentioned in the hadīth, was to draw attention to His favours upon us and it was not intended for the purpose of condemnation or questioning."
- The advisor should mind the best interest of the one asking for advice and must not withhold information that may benefit him.
- It shows that those who pray are better than those who do not pray.
- It is from evil to remain silent about evil and being good requires the person to order the good and forbid the wrong.

373. Sa'd ibn Abī Waqqās reported: "I was the first man to spill blood in the path of Allāh, and I was the first man to shoot an arrow in the path of Allāh. I found myself fighting besides a group of people from the companions of Muhammad (peace be upon him) and we were in such a state where we ate nothing except the leaves of trees and shrubs. As a result, the corners of our mouths were sore and when we relieved ourselves, what came out appeared as if a camel or sheep had relieved itself.

And now, the people of Banu Assad come to criticise my worship. Indeed, I am ruined and in loss if their [false] claim is true.” ^[433]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The companions used to pray in secret and it happened that some disbelievers saw Sa’d with a few other companions praying in secret. Thus, they started to abuse them and the dispute escalated so Sa’d hit one of them and made him bleed.

The battle referred to in the hadīth is the battle of al-Khabat which happened in the eighth year. The number of companions was three hundred and their leader was Abū ‘Ubaydah. Before they left Madīnah, the Prophet (peace be upon him) gave them a bag of dates and so Abū ‘Ubaydah used to divide it between the companions and reduce the share of each until it dwindled down to one date per person. After they finished the dates and endured a great degree of suffering, Allāh gave them from the sea an extremely large fish that they lived on for approximately one month. It was said that the battle that Sa’d referred to was a battle that the Prophet (peace be upon him) participated in, which is reported in Sahīh al-Bukharī and Sahīh Muslim. Regardless of which battle it was, the relevance of this hadīth in the context of this chapter is that it indicates the minimal resources that the Prophet (peace be upon him) possessed, because if he had more he would have given his companions more.

The reason Sa’d ibn Abī Waqqās was upset with Banī Assad is because he was appointed as the ruler of Basra during the time of ‘Umar and they falsely claimed that he did not know how to pray. So he expressed his objection to this, indicating to them the absurdity of their claim when he was from the first ones who embraced Islām and accompanied the Prophet (peace be upon him) for such a long time.

374. Khālīd ibn 'Umayr and Shuwaysa narrated: "Umar ibn al-Khattab instructed 'Utbah ibn Ghazwān and those under his command to travel to the farthest point of the lands of the Arabs and the nearest part of the lands of the non-Arabs and camp there. The army embarked on the journey and when they reached al-Mirbad, they saw some strange white stones. They asked, 'What is this?' The people replied, 'This is Basra.' Then, they proceeded until they reached a small bridge. The people said, 'This is the place that 'Umar had ordered us to set up our camp.'" [The narrator mentioned the story in its totality.]

'Utbah ibn Ghazwān said: "By Allāh, I was the seventh of the first seven with the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), eating nothing but the leaves of trees until the corners of our mouths were sore. I picked up [from the floor] a garment and then I cut it into two halves and gave one half to Sa'd and I wore the other half. Each one from the seven became a leader of a city from amongst the cities. After us, you will find leaders that are in no way similar to us." ^[434]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

'Umar ibn al-Khattab sent 'Utbah ibn Ghazwān with a group of people to guard the borders from where the attacks of the disbelievers were feared. He appointed for them the location where they needed to set up their camp in.

Al-Tirmidhi did not include the full story due its irrelevance to the chapter; thus he jumped to the parts that are related to the title of the chapter.

The reason 'Utbah ibn Ghazwān mentioned that he and the other six companions became rulers eventually was to show them how life was difficult at that time and how it changed afterwards.

The full incident is mentioned in Sahīh Muslim^[435] and part of the remaining statement of 'Utbah was, "I seek refuge in Allāh from being great in this world whilst being small in His sight."

375. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said: ‘I was made to fear [for striving] in the path of Allāh at a time when no one else was threatened. I was harmed [for striving] in the path of Allāh at a time when no one else experienced harm. Thirty consecutive nights and days passed wherein I and Bilal had no food that even an animal would eat, except for the minute, hidden under the arm of Bilal.’” ^[436]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

Narrated Aisha: “I asked the Prophet (peace be upon him), ‘Have you encountered a day harder than the day [of the battle] of Uhud?’ The Prophet (peace be upon him) replied, ‘Your tribes have troubled me a lot, and the worst trouble was the trouble on the day of ‘Aqaba when I presented myself to Ibn ‘Abd-Yalail ibn ‘Abd-Kulal and he did not respond to my request. So I departed, overwhelmed with sorrow and proceeded on. I could not relax until I found myself at Qarnath-Thalib where I lifted my head towards the sky to see a cloud shading me unexpectedly. I looked up and saw Jibra’īl in it. He called me saying, ‘Allāh has heard your people’s words to you, and what they have replied back to you, Allāh has sent the Angel of the Mountains to you so that you may order him to do whatever you wish to these people.’ The Angel of the Mountains called and greeted me, and then said, ‘O Muhammad! Order what you wish. If you like, I will let al-Akhshabain (i.e. two mountains) fall upon them.’ I said, ‘No but I hope that Allāh will let them beget children who will worship Allah Alone, and will worship none besides Him.’” ^[437]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Al-Tirmidhī said that this was during the period when the Prophet (peace be upon him) left Makkah.

376. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) would not consume bread or meat in the

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morning or evening twice in one day, except if he was invited as a guest.” ^[438]

377. Nawfal ibn lyās al-Hudhalī narrated: “Abdul Rahman ibn al-‘Awf would host gatherings for us, and verily he was a good host. Once we were returning from a place with him. On returning we went with him to his house. When we entered his home he first took a bath and then came to us. Bread and meat was served upon a large platter. Thereupon he began to cry. I asked, ‘O Abu Muhammad! What causes you to cry?’ He said, ‘Until the demise of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), neither did he or his family members fill their stomachs with something as little as the bread made of barley. I never thought that we would be delayed from that which is better for us.” ^[439]

‘Abdullāh ibn Sa’īd said,

The crying of Abdul Rahman ibn al-‘Awf was due to his concern regarding the consequences of the ease which had come to engulf their lives. This is because the simple lifestyle of the best of mankind (peace be upon him) was such that he could not eat to his full even with the barley bread. The first generation used to become worried and concerned when life became easy for them as they feared that Allāh had made their reward in this worldly life instead of the Hereafter.

CHAPTER FIFTY THREE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE AGE OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLAH

378. ‘Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) remained in Makkah for thirteen years during which he received revelation, and in Madīnah for ten years. He passed away at the age of sixty three.” ^[440]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) was forty years old when he received the revelation on the first occasion and it was mentioned previously in the chapter of revelation that the revelation was in the month of Ramadān. The most famous and correct view is that he was born in the month of Rabī’ al-Awwal.

Abdul Rahman al-Mubarakfūrī said,

Al-Tirmidhī reported three narrations regarding the age of the Prophet (peace be upon him) at the time of his passing. The first hadīth states that he passed away when he was sixty three years old, the next hadīth states that he was sixty years old and the last hadith states that he was sixty five years old. Al-Nawawī offered a good reconciliation between these three hadīths as he stated, “The most correct and most widely accepted view is that he (peace be upon him) was sixty three years old when he passed and the hadīth stating his age as sixty was mentioned in respect to decades and not to give an exact number. The other hadīth was just a confusion on the part of Ibn Abbās for ‘Urwah rejected this statement of his and said that Ibn Abbās erred as

he did not accompany the Prophet as much as other companions and did not witness the beginning of his prophethood.” The scholars agreed that he (peace be upon him) was born on a Monday and died on a Monday but they differed upon which day of the month he was born, whether it was the second, eighth, tenth or twelfth of Rabī’ al-Awwal.

379. Jarīr narrated that he heard Mu’āwiyah saying in a speech he delivered: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away at the age of sixty three. Likewise, Abū Bakr and ‘Umar passed away at the same age. I am [currently] sixty three.” ^[441]

Alī al-Qārī said,

Given the age of passing of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and his two companions, Mu’āwiyah expected to die at the same age. In Jāmi’ al-Usūl it is stated that Mu’āwiyah passed away at the age of seventy eight and it was said at eighty six years old. Mirak said, “He hoped to die at the age of sixty three just like the Prophet (peace be upon him) and his two companions but that did not happen as he died when he was nearly eighty years old.”

380. Aisha narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) passed away when he was sixty three years of age.” ^[442]

381. ‘Abdullāh ibn ‘Abbās narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away when he was sixty five years old.” ^[443]

382. Daghfal ibn Handhalah narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) passed away when he was sixty five years of age.”

Al-Tirmidhī said: “Daghfal did not hear any reports from the Prophet (peace be upon him) directly, though we know that he lived during the lifetime of the Prophet (peace be upon him).”

383. Narrated by Rabī'a ibn Abī Abdul Rahman: "I heard Anas ibn Mālik describing the Prophet (peace be upon him) saying, 'He was neither too tall nor short; neither absolutely white nor brown; his hair was neither very curly nor completely straight. The divine revelation was revealed to him when he was forty years old. He stayed ten years in Makkah, and stayed in Madīnah for ten more years. When he died, he was sixty years old and had [approximately] twenty grey hairs in his head and beard.'" ^[445]

384. Anas ibn Mālik reports the same through a different route.

CHAPTER FIFTY FOUR

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE DEATH OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLAH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The author wanted to highlight the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him) after he finished the chapters related to his description for his death was indeed the greatest calamity that befell the Muslims.

The most famous remark made upon the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was said during the state of confusion that overtook the Muslims. They could not believe the news and were under the shock of it. Then Abū Bakr addressed the people, “Whoever worships Allāh, then know that Allāh is alive and does not die, and whoever worships Muhammad, then Muhammad has died.”

385. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The last glimpse I laid upon the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was on a Monday when the curtain of his house was lifted [the people had aligned [in rows] for the prayer]. I looked at him [and his face was bright] and it was as if it was a page of a *mus-haf* (Qur’ān). Upon seeing the Prophet (peace be upon him), we were about to leave the prayer [due to the overwhelming joy of seeing him]. However, he (peace be upon him) beckoned to us to complete the prayer. Abū Bakr led the people in prayer and he let the curtain fall. Towards the end of that day the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away.” ^[446]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This hadīth explains that the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him) was on a Monday. On that day, the sickness of the Prophet (peace be upon him) became severe and so Abū Bakr led the *Fajr* prayer. The brief moment that the Prophet (peace be upon him) lifted the curtain and saw his companions standing in lines with humility ready for the prayer he rejoiced at witnessing that scene and smiled as stated in the hadīth in *Sahīh al-Bukharī* and *Sahīh Muslim*.

The concern and worry of the Prophet (peace be upon him) regarding the prayer did not stop there for his last words upon his death bed were to remind the people to observe the prayer and he mentioned it twice as stated in *Sunan ibn Mājah*^[447]. This shows the great status of the prayer in Islām.

The correct view is that the Prophet (peace be upon him) passed away during the time of *Duha* and it seems that the meaning of Anas was that people verified the news of his death towards the end of the day. It happened when they inquired from Abū Bakr regarding the authenticity of such news. He confirmed the news, kissed the Prophet (peace be upon him) between his eyes and delivered a speech to the people to inform them about it.

386. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was resting against my chest, [or she said: in my lap]. He asked for a wash-basin to relieve himself. He relieved himself and thereafter, he passed away.”^[448]

Ibn Kathīr said,

It is reported in the two *Sahīh* books that in the presence of Aisha some people mentioned that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had appointed Alī by will as his successor. Aisha said, “When did he appoint him by will? Verily when he died he was resting against my chest (or she said: in my lap), he asked for a

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wash-basin and then collapsed whilst in that state. I could not even perceive that he had died, so when did he appoint him by will?"

Talhah ibn Musarrif related, "I asked 'Abdullāh ibn Abī Awfa, 'Did the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) have a will?' He replied, 'No.' I said, 'If he did not do so, why did he order us to write our own wills?' He said, 'His will was that we do not overlook the book of Allah.'"

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The other hadīths indicate that he (peace be upon him) was resting against her chest. The Prophet (peace be upon him) asked the permission of his wives to be treated in the house of Aisha and he used to lead the prayer until he could no longer do so due to his sickness. The last prayer he led was a Friday prayer and then Abū Bakr began leading the prayer from that Friday until the *Fajr* prayer on Monday.

Due to his sickness, he could not get up from his bed and this is why he asked for the container.

387. Aisha narrated: "I saw the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) just before he passed away placing his hands into a cup of water. He would wipe his face with it whilst saying, 'O Allāh help me endure the agonies of death.'" ^[449]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The Prophet (peace be upon him) repeated the statement, "There is no god worthy of worship besides Allāh" and then said, "Death possesses agony." Then he stretched his hand, raised it and said, "I choose to be with the company of the higher companion" until he died and his hand fell down.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

Al-Suhailī said, "The reason why these ("O Allāh, [with] the higher companion") were the last words of the Prophet (peace

be upon him) is because they refer both to *tawhīd* and to *dhikr* in the heart. It offers comfort to those who are unable to speak [when dying], because some people may not be able to speak out loud for some reason, but that does not matter if their hearts are steadfast in remembering Allāh.”

388. Aisha said: “I no longer rejoice at anyone experiencing an easy death after having witnessed the difficulties in death endured by the Messenger of Allāh.” ^[450]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

This shows that experiencing hardship and agony at the time of death does not indicate a lower status of *imān*; rather it is a means whereby the good deeds of the believers increase or the bad deeds of the believers are erased.

Al-Sindī said,

This hadīth proves that Aisha knew that the more agony a person experiences at the time of death, the more good deeds he receives. [This is from] observing the extreme level of suffering the Prophet (peace be upon him) endured upon his death bed.

389. Aisha related: “After the demise of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him), the people disagreed regarding where to bury him. Abū Bakr said, ‘I heard something from the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) that I did not forget. He (peace be upon him) said, ‘Allāh does not take the life of His Prophets except in the location He [or the Prophet] wishes them buried.’” Thus he was buried in the place where his bed was.” ^[451]

Alī al-Qārī said,

The companions differed regarding the location where they should bury the Prophet (peace be upon him), some suggested

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to bury him in his masjid, some said in al-Baqī' where his companions were buried, and some suggested in Makkah.

Al-Zarqanī said,

Indeed, there was no darker day than the day on which he (peace be upon him) died. Upon his death, he moved to another place that has the pleasure of receiving him, and to celebrate his coming Paradise wore its best adornment to welcome his soul.

After the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him), it is reported that his donkey showed sadness until it fell in a well and died. Also, his camel refused to eat and drink anything after his death until it died.

390. 'Abdullāh ibn Abbās and Aisha both narrated: "Abū Bakr kissed the Prophet after he passed away." ^[452]

391. Aisha narrated: "Abū Bakr entered upon the Prophet (peace be upon him) after his death. He kissed him between his eyes, put his hands upon his forearms and said, 'O my Prophet! O my close companion! O my best friend!'" ^[453]

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

It is permissible to express one's sadness over someone's death if the statement is simple and truthful and is not intended to wail or to show discontentment as this does not contradict the patience that one is obliged to show in such events, as can be noted in this hadīth.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Abū Bakr cried and kissed the forehead of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to follow the example that he (peace be upon him) set when he kissed 'Uthmān ibn Madh'ūn after his death. It shows that it is recommended to kiss the face of the deceased pious person.

392. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: “The day the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) arrived at Madīnah, everything became illuminated. The day that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away, everything darkened. We had not yet dusted off the earth of his burial from our hands, yet we felt a change in our hearts.” ^[454]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

After the burial of the Prophet (peace be upon him), Fātimah chastised the companions, including Anas ibn Mālik for having the heart to place the Prophet (peace be upon him) down in his grave [and bury him] as she knew their extreme love towards him. In response, Anas remained silent given the emotional state he was in at that time as if to indicate that they disliked doing so but they had to subdue their hearts to comply with his command.

The statement where he said that they felt a change in their hearts meant that they did not find their hearts to be upon the same degree of purity, serenity and softness as before the Prophet’s death, when revelation was still being revealed to him, and when he was still teaching them.

Ibn Abdul Barr said,

Indeed, the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him) made all other calamities and hardships look small and trivial. How could it not be when by his passing the divine revelation ceased descending to the earth!

The Prophet (peace be upon him) said that there is no Muslim who is afflicted with a calamity and says that which Allāh has enjoined, *“Innā lillāhi wa inna ilayhi rāji’ūn. Allāhumma ajurni fi musībati wakhluḥ li khayran minha”* (Verily to Allāh we belong and to Him we will return. O Allāh, reward me for my calamity and compensate me with something better than it), but Allāh will compensate him with something better than it.

393. Aisha narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away on a Monday." ^[455]

394. Muhammad al-Bāqir narrated: "The Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) passed away on a Monday. His burial waited until the day of Monday and night of Tuesday had passed, and then he was buried on the night of Wednesday." Sufyān (the narrator of this hadīth) said: "In other narrations it is stated that the sound of spades could be heard in the latter portion of the night." ^[456]

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

It is permissible to bury the deceased at night. Imām Ahmad was asked about the ruling on burying the deceased during the night and he did not object to it and said, "Abū Bakr was buried at night, and Alī ibn Abī Tālib buried Fātimah at night."

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason why the companions delayed his burial was either due to the fact that some of them did not believe that he had passed away, because they differed upon where to bury him or because of their busyness with the succession of the Prophet (peace be upon him) so as to avert any possible disputes that may have arisen if there was a delay in the decision being made and the pledge being given. The burial was decided after the intervention of Abū Bakr whose statement settled the dispute.

Ibn Battal said,

It is narrated that Aisha said, "We did not know of the burial of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) until we heard the sound of spades in the latter portion of the night of Wednesday." ^[457]

‘Uqbah ibn ‘Amir narrated, "There are three times at which the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) forbade us to pray or to bury our dead: when the sun has clearly started to rise until it is

fully risen, when it is directly overhead at midday until it has passed its zenith, and when the sun starts to set until it has fully set.”

Al-Bajūrī said,

The burial preparation began on Tuesday and the burial finished during the latter part of the night of Wednesday. This can reconcile the reports stating he was buried on Tuesday and the reports stating he was buried on Wednesday.

395. Abū Salamah ibn Abdul Rahman ibn ‘Awf narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away on a Monday and was buried on Tuesday.” ^[458]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

To reconcile between this hadīth and the previous one, it can be said that the companions started to prepare the body of the Prophet (peace be upon him) at the end of Tuesday and only finished the preparation during the latter portion of the night of Wednesday.

396. Salim ibn ‘Ubayd narrated: “During his sickness the Prophet (peace be upon him) fell unconscious; when he later recovered consciousness he asked, ‘Has the time of the prayer commenced?’ They replied, ‘Yes.’ Then he said, ‘Order Bilāl to call to the prayer, and order Abū Bakr to lead the people in prayer.’ Then again, he lost consciousness; when he was revived, he said, ‘Has the time of the prayer commenced?’ They said, ‘Yes.’ He (peace be upon him) said, ‘Order Bilāl to call to the prayer, and order Abū Bakr to lead the people in prayer.’

Aisha said, ‘My father is a man with a soft heart, prone to being moved. If he stands in that position, he will cry and he would not be able to control it. If you wish you can appoint someone else.’ He again lost consciousness, and when he revived this time, he said, ‘Order Bilāl to call to the prayer, and order Abū Bakr to lead the prayer, for indeed, you women are

the companions of Yūsuf.' Thereupon, Bilāl was ordered to make the call to prayer and he did so, and Abū Bakr was ordered to lead the people in prayer, and he did so. Then the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) found some respite from his illness and so he (peace be upon him) said, 'Find someone for me upon whom I may lean.' Barīrah and another man came and he (peace be upon him) leaned upon them. When Abū Bakr saw him, he began to move back so that the Prophet (peace be upon him) could take his place, but the Prophet (peace be upon him) indicated to him that he should remain firm in his place, until Abū Bakr completed his prayer.

Then, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) passed away, upon which 'Umar said, 'By Allāh, if anyone mentions that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) has died, I will strike his neck with this sword of mine.' The Arabs were illiterate and never before Muhammad (peace be upon him) had there been a Prophet amongst them. The people desisted [from any action] and said, 'O Salīm, go to the Messenger of Allāh's companion and call him.' I came to Abū Bakr whilst he was in the masjid. I approached him whilst crying and in a state of shock. When he saw me, he said, 'Did the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) die?' I replied, 'Indeed but 'Umar is saying, 'If I hear anyone mention that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) has died, I will strike his neck with this sword of mine.'"

Abū Bakr then said to me, 'Come,' and so I proceeded with him until we reached the people, who had entered the room of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him). He said, 'O people! Make way for me.' They made way for him until he bent down to the Prophet (peace be upon him) and touched him; he then said: "{Verily, you [O Muhammad (peace be upon him)] will die and verily, they [too] will die.}"^[459]

The people asked, 'O companion of the Messenger of Allāh, has the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) died?' He answered, 'Yes.' They knew that he had spoken the truth.

They said, 'O companion of the Messenger of Allāh! Is the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) to be prayed upon?' He said, 'Yes.' To which they replied, 'And how?' He said, 'A group shall enter, say the *takbir*, pray and then invoke Him. Then they shall leave, another group shall enter and do the same until everyone has prayed.'

The people asked, 'O companion of the Messenger of Allāh! Is the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) to be buried?' He said, 'Yes.' They said, 'Where?' He answered, 'In the same place that Allāh took his soul, for indeed, Allah did not take his soul except in a good and pure place.' And they knew that he had spoken the truth. Then he ordered the offspring from the Prophet's father's side to wash him.

The Muhājirūn then assembled to decide the succession to the Prophet (peace be upon him). They said, 'Let us go to our brothers from amongst the Ansār and include them in this matter.' The Ansār said, 'Amongst us is a leader and amongst you is a leader.' 'Umar ibn al-Khattab said, 'Who is that person from your midst who possesses these three: {The second of two; when they two were in the cave, when he said unto his comrade: 'Grieve not. Indeed! Allah is with us?'}' 'Umar then extended his hand to give the pledge of allegiance. Subsequently, all those present followed suit and wholeheartedly gave allegiance to Abū Bakr. ^[460]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

This shows that Prophets can fall unconscious (al-Ghazalī stated that their unconsciousness can be short or long in duration and al-Subkī stated that in this state their hearts are still awake) since it is considered as a sickness that does not entail a defect or a flaw; contrary to madness and insanity which Prophets are protected from experiencing. The reason that Allāh allows His Prophets to fall sick is so that their reward can be increased and to consolidate the people (i.e. to strengthen them with the

knowledge that even Prophets are subject to hardship and sickness) and to avert the possibility of any extreme glorification on the part of the people after they witness the miracles of the Prophet (i.e. to prevent people from worshipping Prophets after seeing their miracles).

This hadīth shows that the person who should be asked to lead the prayer is the one with best understanding of religion, who can recite the Qur'ān in the best manner and has the most sense of piety. The fact that the Prophet (peace be upon him) ordered Abū Bakr to lead the prayer more than once is a strong indication that he was the most deserving to be his successor.

The similarity between Aisha and the woman mentioned in the story of Yūsuf is that both did not reveal the true purpose behind their requests and instead gave different justifications. Zulaykha invited the women and showed them good hospitality whilst her real purpose was to let them see the beauty of Yūsuf so that they could relate to her for falling in love with him. Similarly, Aisha stated that she disliked her father leading the people in the prayer because his soft heart would cause him to cry when reading the Qur'ān. In reality, she made that request because she feared that the people would dislike him for taking the place of the Prophet (peace be upon him), as she clearly revealed in another hadīth documented by al-Bukharī.

There are different hadīths, each of which states different people that the Prophet (peace be upon him) leaned upon. In Sahīh al-Bukharī and Muslim it states that they were two men: al-Abbās and Alī. In Muslim, they were al-Abbās and his son al-Fadl, and in another hadīth, they were al-Abbās and Usāmah ibn Zayd. In Sunan al-Daraqutnī they were Usāmah and al-Fadl, in Sahīh Ibn Hibbān they were Baryrah and Nubah, and in the book of Ibn Sa'd they were al-Fadl and Thawban. The reconciliation between these hadīths, if all are proven authentic, is that he (peace be upon him) went out of his house more than once and on each occasion he leaned upon different people.

The signal of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to Abū Bakr (to remain as the *imām* of the prayer) indicates that he prayed behind Abū Bakr. However, in *Sahīh al-Bukharī* and *Muslim* it states that he (peace be upon him) sat on the left side of Abū Bakr, thus Abū Bakr stood leading the prayer behind the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the people followed the lead of Abū Bakr. This explains the basis of the view of al-Shafī'ī that it is allowed for a person praying in congregation to leave following the *imām* [i.e. leave the congregation by intending to pray individually] and then follow another *imām*.

The reason 'Umar denied the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and threatened anyone who dared to say that is because he thought that he was just unconscious. Regarding the meaning of the statement that Arabs were illiterate and that never before Muhammad (peace be upon him) was there a Prophet amongst them is that the Arabs never had the knowledge of how a Prophet would die, which can be attained either through witnessing that or through scripture, and Arabs never had either (i.e. they were not from the People of the Book. Therefore they did not have a scripture and no Prophet was sent to them before the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him)).

Referring to Abū Bakr as the companion of the Prophet (peace be upon him) indicates that he was known amongst the people with that description as if they agreed that it is his description that Allāh has confirmed in the *Qur'ān* (i.e. the ayah wherein it says in its meaning "he says to his companion....").

Abū Bakr addressed the people after he verified the death of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and said, "Whoever worships Muhammad then know that Muhammad has died, and whoever worships Allāh, then Allāh is Alive and does not die." Then he recited the ayah **{“You will die and so they shall too...”}** Thereupon, the people began to cry. This shows the courage and knowledge of Abū Bakr as he quoted the ayāt to refute the claim that the Prophet did not die and stayed firm in the face of such a difficult calamity.

The response of the companions to the news differed, 'Umar could not believe the news and threatened anyone who claimed that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had died, 'Abdullāh ibn Anīs could not get up and remained seated upon hearing the news and 'Uthmān could not speak. Abū Bakr was the firmest and he arrived whilst his eyes were full of tears.

Ibn Battal said,

Al-Bukharī documented in his Sahīh that Aisha narrated: "Allāh's Messenger (peace be upon him) died whilst Abū Bakr was at a place called al-Sunah (al-'Aliya). 'Umar stood up and said, 'By Allāh! Allāh's Messenger is not dead!' 'Umar (later on) said, 'By Allāh! Nothing occurred to my mind except that.' He said, 'Verily! Allāh will resurrect him and he will cut the hands and legs of some men.' Then Abū Bakr came and uncovered the face of Allāh's Messenger, kissed him and said, 'Let my mother and father be sacrificed for you, [O Allāh's Messenger], you are good in life and in death. By Allāh in Whose Hands my life is, Allāh will never make you taste death twice.' Then he went out and said, 'O oath-taker! Don't be hasty.' When Abū Bakr spoke, 'Umar sat down. Abū Bakr praised and glorified Allāh and then said, 'No doubt! Whoever worshipped Muhammad, then Muhammad is dead, but whoever worshipped Allāh, then Allāh is Alive and shall never die.' Then he recited Allah's Statement: **{[O Muhammad] Verily you will die, and they also will die.}**^[461] He also recited, **{Muhammad is no more than an Apostle; and indeed many Apostles have passed away, before him, If he dies or is killed, will you then turn back on your heels? And he who turns back on his heels, not the least harm will he do to Allāh and Allāh will give reward to those who are grateful.}**^[462]

The statement of Abū Bakr that the Prophet (peace be upon him) will not taste death twice was in response to the statement of 'Umar and others who said that the Prophet (peace be upon him) died and will be resurrected again in this life. This is to

state that he dies once in this life and will be resurrected on the Day of Judgment. This hadīth shows the virtue of Abū Bakr and that he was more knowledgeable than 'Umar. This event showed his sensibility, firmness and his ability to understand events in the light of the Qur'ān and it also shows his high status amongst the Muslims.

397. Anas ibn Mālik narrated: "When the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) was experiencing the agonies of death, Fātimah said, 'What a calamity that has inflicted my father!' Thereupon, the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'No calamity will inflict your father after today. That which has befallen your father is inevitable and none will be saved from it until the Day of Reckoning.'" ^[463]

Al-Sindi said,

The meaning of the statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him), "No calamity will inflict your father after today" is that the agony he felt would come to a halt through his death.

398. 'Abdullāh ibn Abbās narrated: "I heard the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) say, 'The person who experiences the loss of two young children [during his lifetime], Allāh shall admit him in Paradise by them!' Aisha asked, 'What about the one from your nation who experiences the death of one young child [during his lifetime]?' He replied, 'O successful! The one who loses one child shall also enter Paradise.' Aisha then inquired, 'What about those from among your nation who have not lost any children?' He replied, 'I shall be their intercession in the Hereafter for no loss equals the loss of my death.'" ^[464]

Ibn al-Qayyim said,

From the hadīths that encourage us to have children is this hadīth.

Al-Baydāwī said,

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The meaning of this hadīth is that the deceased children precede their parents to Paradise and prepare for their parents places therein.

Alī al-Qārī said,

The praise of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to Aisha (“O successful”) was due to her questioning. He mentioned this to indicate that she is guided to the good as her questions were an evidence of her concern for the Muslims.

CHAPTER FIFTY FIVE

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO THE INHERITANCE OF THE MESSENGER OF ALLĀH

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

This chapter is dedicated to mentioning that which the Prophet (peace be upon him) left behind after his death, and to clarify that the inheritance of Prophets is knowledge and anything else is left for charity.

399. ‘Amr ibn al-Hārith, the brother of Juwairiyya said: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did not leave behind anything except his weapons, his mule and a piece of land that he allocated for charity.” ^[465]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The Juwairiyya referred to in this hadith is the mother of the believers, Juwairiyya bint al-Hārith.

The slaves of the Prophet (peace be upon him) who were mentioned in the hadīths were either freed or died during his lifetime [as stated in the hadith in Sahīh al-Bukharī which reads, “When Allah’s Apostle died, he did not leave any *dirham* or *dinār* (i.e. money), a slave or a slave woman, neither did he leave anything else besides his white mule, his arms and a piece of land which he had given in charity.”]

Ibn Battal said,

The king of Aylah sent the Prophet (peace be upon him) a white mule as a gift.

400. Abu Hurairah narrated: “Fātimah came to Abū Bakr and asked him, ‘Who shall inherit from you?’ He replied, ‘My wife and my children.’ She said, ‘Then why is it so, that I cannot inherit from my father?’ He replied, ‘I heard the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) say, ‘We (i.e. the Prophets) are not inherited from.’ However, I will support those whom the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to support and I will spend upon those whom he spent upon.” ^[466]

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

Fātimah came to Abū Bakr after he become the successor of the Prophet (peace be upon him) to ask him for her share from that which her father (peace be upon him) had left behind [as he acquired some estates from war booties]. It seems that she was not aware of his statement that no one inherits from him. This can be supported by the fact that she did not object to the statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) after she heard it and this is why Abū Bakr did not distribute that which the Prophet (peace be upon him) had between his wives and daughters. Nonetheless, Abū Bakr explained that he was now responsible for the affairs of the Muslims. Therefore he would make sure to keep the arrangements of the Prophet (peace be upon him) stay as they were and thus, he would continue to give her the support that she used to receive from the Prophet (peace be upon him) and spend upon everyone that the Prophet (peace be upon him) spent upon during his lifetime.

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The hadīths indicating that Fātimah refused to talk with Abū Bakr after he denied her what she thought to be her right in the Prophet’s (peace be upon him) properties do not mean that she boycotted him. Rather, she refused to talk with him regarding the matter and she did not boycott him, which is forbidden to do so as stated in the hadīth.

Given the high level of piety and sensibility of Fātimah, it appears that she did not boycott Abū Bakr. This can be corroborated by the hadīth documented by al-Bayhaqī who reported from the way of al-Sha'bī that Abū Bakr visited Fātimah and Alī ibn Abī Tālib said to her that Abū Bakr sought permission to visit her. She said, "Are you happy for me to allow him?" He replied, "Yes." So she allowed him to enter upon her.

Some of our scholars said that the forbidden type of boycott between Muslims is that when two people ignore each other when they meet. It is evident that what she did was avoid meeting him, as it seems to be the case that she was too busy with her sadness and sickness.

The reason she became upset though she heard the hadīth is because she understood the hadīth in a different manner to Abū Bakr. Her understanding led her to believe that she was not subject to this hadīth (meaning she was an exception to the general statement) whilst Abū Bakr understood the hadīth to be applicable to everyone, and the interpretation of both are possible.

401. Abū al-Bakhtarī narrated: "Both al-Abbās and Alī ibn Abī Tālib disputed over the inheritance of the Prophet (peace be upon him) so they went to 'Umar during his reign as the Caliphate whilst each of them accused the other. 'Umar said to Talhah, al-Zubayr, 'Abdul Rahman ibn 'Awf and Sa'd ibn Abī Waqqās, 'Do you not bear witness that you heard the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) say, 'The wealth that a Prophet [leaves behind] is for charity, except that which he used to feed and clothe his family. Indeed, we are not inherited from.' This hadīth also has a story [which is being shortened here]." ^[467]

Al-San'ānī said,

The meaning of this hadīth is that all of the wealth that the Prophet (peace be upon him) left behind was for his nation as

charity. The money he used to feed his family was exempt from this ruling as Allāh allowed him to do so and it appears that even this was considered a charity for them (his family) during his lifetime.

It was said that the wisdom for Prophets leaving nothing behind as inheritance was so that their heirs would not wish for their death. As for the inheritance mentioned in the ayāt: **{Sulaymān inherited Dawūd}**^[468] and **{Who will inherit me and inherit from the family of Ya'qūb}**^[469], both refer to knowledge.

Al-Khattabī said,

Mālik ibn Aws said: “‘Umar ibn al-Khattab sent a messenger to call me to present myself before him. I went and found ‘Umar sitting on a bare bed, with no mattress. I greeted him and sat down, and he said, ‘O Mālik, some families from your people have come to us and I have ordered that some shares be allocated to them. Take them and divide among them.’ I said, ‘O Amir al-Muminīn! I would prefer that you appoint someone else to do this.’ He said, ‘Take them [and perform the task.]’ Then his doorkeeper Yaria’ came to him and said, ‘Will you give ‘Uthmān, Abdul Rahman ibn ‘Awf, al-Zubayr and Sa’d ibn Abī Waqqās permission to enter?’ He responded, ‘Yes.’ So he let them in, they entered and sat down. Then after a while, Yaria’ came and said to ‘Umar, ‘Do you allow Alī and al-Abbās to enter?’ He replied, ‘Yes.’ So he let them in, and they entered. Al-Abbās said, ‘O Amīr al-Muminīn, judge between me and this one (Alī).’

The group, ‘Uthmān and his companions, said, ‘O Amīr al-Muminīn! Judge between them and give them a break from one another.’ ‘Umar said, ‘I ask you by Allāh, by whose permission the heaven and earth exist, do you know that the Messenger of Allāh said, ‘We cannot be inherited from; what we leave behind is charity?’” The group replied, ‘He did say that.’ Then ‘Umar turned to Alī and al-Abbās and said, ‘I ask you by Allāh, do you

know that the Messenger of Allāh said that?' They said, 'He did say so.'

'Umar said, 'Allāh allocated for the Messenger something exclusive for him when He said: **{And what Allāh gave as booty (Fai') to His Messenger (Muhammad (peace be upon him)) from them, for which you made no expedition with either cavalry or camels. But Allāh gives power to His Messengers over whomsoever He wills. And Allāh is Able to do all things.}**'^[470] Then he said, 'And Allāh gave his Messenger the war booty of Banī al-Nadyīr but by Allāh, he did not keep it for himself and withhold it from you, rather he gave it to you and distributed it amongst you, until only this wealth was left. The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) gave his family what they needed for the whole year from this wealth, then he took what was left and put it in the Bayt al-Māl.' Then he addressed the group, 'I ask you by Allāh, do you know this?' They replied, 'Yes.' Then he said to Alī and al-Abbās, 'I ask you by Allah, do you know this?' They replied, 'Yes.'

'Umar said, 'Then Allāh took the soul of His Prophet (peace be upon him), and Abū Bakr said, 'I am the successor of the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him).' By Allāh, Abū Bakr took it and used it in the same manner that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) had done. Then you and him (al-Abbās and Alī) went to Abū Bakr, you (al-'Abbās) demanding your share from the inheritance of your nephew (the Prophet (peace be upon him)) and he (Alī) demanding the share of his wife from the inheritance of her father (the Prophet (peace be upon him)) and Abū Bakr said to you that he had heard the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) say, 'We cannot be inherited from. All that which we leave behind is to be given for charity' and Allāh knows that he was honest and sincere, and sought the truth.

Then Allāh took the soul of Abū Bakr and I said, 'I am the successor of the Messenger of Allāh and the successor of Abū Bakr.' I took over and I used it as the Messenger of Allāh (peace

be upon him) and Abū Bakr had done. And you have come to me and spoken to me, when you were both in agreement. When I thought that I might give it to you, I said, 'If you wish, I will give it to you both, on condition that you make a promise to Allāh that you will use it as the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) did, as Abū Bakr did and as I have done since the beginning of my reign.' You replied, 'Give it to us on that basis.' Thus I gave it to you. I ask you by Allāh, did I not give it to them on that basis?' The group replied, 'Yes.' Then he turned to Alī and al-Abbās and said, 'I ask you by Allāh, did I not give it to you on that basis?' They replied, 'Yes.' He said, 'And now you are seeking a different judgement from me? If you are not able to manage it properly, then give it to me and I will take care of it'"

Abu Dawūd said, "Al-Abbās and Alī came the second time asking 'Umar to divide it in two halves between them so that each one could be responsible for his part but 'Umar refused to divide it." This is a very good explanation and is indicated from the context of the hadīth where it mentions that al-Abbās and Alī were in agreement regarding the matter but they differed upon a new idea that came into their mind at that time which was to divide it. Also, it cannot be that they acknowledged the statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and yet still came to demand inheritance. 'Umar refused to divide it due to his fear that the people coming after al-Abbās and Alī may not possess their wisdom, insight, piety and knowledge and so they would claim its ownership.

402. Aisha narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'We cannot be inherited from. All of that which we leave behind is for charity.'" ^[471]

403. Abu Hurairah narrated: "The Prophet (peace be upon him) said, 'My inheritance is not to be distributed by *dinārs* and *dirhams*. Whatever is remaining, after setting aside the expenditure of my wives and workers, is for charity.'" ^[472]

Ibn Battal said,

The statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him) in this hadith does not entail an order because he did not leave behind any money to be divided as he died whilst his armour was still pawned. Thus he (peace be upon him) meant that his heirs will not have any money from him after his death as he will not leave behind any.

He (peace be upon him) excluded the expenditure of his wives after his death because they were his dependants and leaving them without support entails what Allāh said: **{And it is not [conceivable or lawful] for you to harm the Messenger of Allāh.}**^[473]

The workers mentioned in this hadīth are his workers who worked in the land he possessed in Fadak, Banī al-Nadīr and Khaybar (his war booty) as he used the income generated from these lands to spend upon his family and the rest he gave in charity to benefit the Muslims. This remained until the time of 'Umar who gave the wives of the Prophet the choice either to continue receiving their share from these lands or to allocate for them some properties. Aisha and Hafsa chose to take the properties and so he excluded them from their share in the lands and gave them what they wanted. These were then left for their heirs after they died.

Al-Tabarī said, "This is evidence that it is allowed to allocate some income for those whose time is dedicated to managing acts that are considered as good deeds such as the *muadhin* (caller to prayer), teachers, judges, rulers, scholars etc."

404. Mālik ibn Aws ibn al-Hadathān narrated: "I entered upon 'Umar and Abdul Rahman ibn A'wf, Talhah and Sa'd also came. At a later point, Alī and Abbās also entered whilst they were in the midst of an argument. 'Umar asked them (Abdul Rahman, Talhah and Sa'd), 'Do you bear witness by the One whose permission allows the heavens and earth to exist that the Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'We are not

inherited from. Whatever is left behind is charity.” They replied, ‘O Allāh, yes.’” There is a long story behind this hadīth.

[474]

405. Aisha narrated: “The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) left behind no *dinārs*, *dirhams*, sheep or camels.” [The narrator of this hadith] said: “I am in doubt regarding whether she also mentioned male and female slaves.”

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

It is narrated that Abū Hurairah walked in the market of Madīnah. He stood and shouted, “O people of the market! How slack you are!” The people asked, “O Abu Hurairah! Why do you say that?” He replied, “The inheritance of the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) is distributed whilst you are still here and not collecting your share from it!” The people asked, “Where is it distributed?” He replied, “It is now being distributed in the masjid. Thereupon, the people rushed to the masjid and Abū Hurairah waited in the market until their return. When they returned, he asked them about what happened so they said, “We went there but we saw nothing being distributed.” He said, “Have you not seen anyone in the masjid?” They said, “Yes, we did! We saw some people praying, and some people reciting the Qur’ān, and some people studying that which is lawful and that which is forbidden.” He said, “Woe to you! That is the inheritance of Muhammad (peace be upon him).”^[475]

CHAPTER FIFTY SIX

THE REPORTS PERTAINING TO SEEING THE MESSENGER OF ALLAH IN DREAMS

Abdul Razzaq al-Badr said,

The author concluded his book with this chapter to confirm the relation between knowing the description of the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the ability to verify seeing him in dreams. This is because a person who does not know the attributes and description of the Prophet (peace be upon him) cannot verify if the one in his dream is the Prophet (peace be upon him) or not.

406. ‘Abdullāh ibn Mas’ūd narrated: “The Prophet (peace be upon him) said, “The one that has seen me in a dream has indeed seen me, for Shaytān cannot impersonate me.” ^[476]

Ibn Hajar al-Asqalānī said,

The phrase “... for Shaytān cannot” indicates that although Allāh gave him the ability to appear in any form he wants, He does not allow him to appear in the form of the Prophet (peace be upon him). This was the opinion of a group who said concerning the hadīth, “What this refers to is when a person sees him as he really looked.” Some of them restricted it even further and said, “He must see him as he looked when he died, so he must even take into consideration the number of his white hairs which were no more than twenty.” The correct view is that he may be seen at any age or in any condition, so long as he appears as he really looked, whether as a youth, in the prime of manhood, in old age or any other time of his life.

Ayyūb said, "If a man told Muhammad (meaning Ibn Sirīn) that he had seen the Prophet (peace be upon him) [in a dream], he would say, "Describe to me the one whom you saw." If he gave a description that he did not recognise, he would say, "You did not see him."

Al-Qurtubī said, "There are different opinions about the explanation of this hadīth. Some people said that it means seeing his real actual person in the literal sense, meaning that whoever sees him in a dream sees him actually, and hence seeing him in a dream is the same as seeing him whilst awake. However, the corruption of this opinion can be noticed with basic intellect because it necessitates that anyone who sees him [in a dream] will see him in the form he died in and also that two persons should not be able to see him at two different places if they dream at the same time. This opinion also means that he is alive, leaves his grave, walks about in the markets, speaks to people and they speak to him. It also entails that his grave does not contain his body, and hence his grave is empty and those visiting are just going to an empty grave and greeting someone who is not there, since (according to this claim) he can really be seen at any time of the day (in a dream), in places other than his grave. Anyone who has the least grip on his senses will not hold on to such ignorance.

Another group said whoever sees him in the physical form he is known of during his lifetime [in the authentic hadīth] has truly seen him in the dream and if his physical form was different then it is a false dream. However, it is known that he (peace be upon him) can be seen in a dream in a state that befits him but different to his state during his lifetime, such as when a person sees in his dream that the body of the Prophet (peace be upon him) has filled the dreamer's house, which is interpreted to mean that the house is full of blessings. Let alone, if the Shaytān could impersonate his physical form or anything that is attributed to him, then that would contradict the generality of the statement of the Prophet (peace be upon him), 'Shaytān

cannot impersonate me.' The correct understanding of this hadith is that it is possible to see him in different ways and states, so either the dream means exactly what happens in it or it needs to be interpreted for witnessing him in a dream can occur either to warn the person against evil, give him glad tidings or to remind him."

407. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'The one that has seen me in a dream has indeed seen me, for Shaytān cannot take my form.'" [477]

408. Tariq ibn Ashyam narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'The one that has seen me in a dream has indeed seen me.'" [478]

Al-Nawawī said,

The meaning of this hadīth is that seeing the Prophet (peace be upon him) in a dream is something true and not a false dream. However, it is not allowed to establish a ruling in religion that contradicts any of the established rulings based on a dream even in this case. This is because a dreamer does not fulfil any of the conditions of testimony. However, if a person sees the Prophet (peace be upon him) in a dream wherein he orders the person to do something that is considered recommended in religion, or to avoid something that is considered disliked or forbidden in religion, or instructs the person to do something that has a benefit, then it is agreed upon that it is recommended to comply. This is because the ruling of the act that is instructed to be performed or avoided is already established in the religion before the dream.

409. Abū Hurairah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said: 'Whoever sees me in a dream has indeed seen me, for the Shaytān cannot impersonate me.'"

Kulayb [the one narrating this report from Abū Hurairah] said: "I mentioned this hadith to Ibn 'Abbās and stated that I

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saw him (peace be upon him) in a dream. I said to Ibn 'Abbās that I found the image in my dream very similar to that of al-Hasan. Ibn 'Abbās said, 'Truly, al-Hasan was very similar to the Prophet (peace be upon him) in appearance.'" ^[479]

410. 'Awf ibn Abī Jamīlah narrated that Yazīd al-Fārisī, who was a transcriber of the Qur'ān, said: "I saw the Prophet (peace be upon him) in my sleep in the time of Ibn 'Abbās. I informed Ibn 'Abbās regarding my experience and he said, 'The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) used to say, 'Verily, the Shaytān cannot imitate my form, therefore whoever sees me in his sleep has indeed seen me.' Can you describe for us the man whom you saw?' I said: 'Yes, I saw a man of a medium build; his skin was white with a hint of red. His eyes were [dark as if they had been applied] with kohl and he possessed a beautiful smile. He had a handsome, rounded face and his beard went from here to here, almost filling his upper chest.'"

'Awf (one of the narrators) said: "I do not recall any other features besides these that he described."

Ibn 'Abbās said: "Had you seen him whilst awake you would not have been able to describe him better."" ^[480]

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason 'Awf mentioned the work of Yazīd is to indicate he saw the Prophet (peace be upon him) in his dream.

411. A'wf al-A'rabī narrated: "I am older than Qatādah."

412. Abu Qatādah narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said, 'The one who sees me (meaning in a dream) has indeed seen a thing that is true.'" ^[481]

413. Anas ibn Mālīk narrated: "The Messenger of Allāh (peace be upon him) said: 'Whoever sees me in a dream has indeed seen me, for the Shaytān cannot impersonate me. The dream of

a believer is one portion of the forty six portions of Prophethood.” ^[482]

Ibn ‘Uthaymīn said,

The meaning of the words of the Prophet (peace be upon him), “The dream of the believer is one portion of the forty six portions of Prophethood” is that the dreams of the believers come true, because they are like parables that the angels give to the one who sees them. They may tell of something that is happening or that is going to happen, so it happens in accordance with the dream. So these dreams are like the revelation of Prophethood in that they come true, yet they are different from it. Hence they are one of the forty six portions of Prophethood.

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason why the dreams of the believers are likened to Prophethood is because both entail knowing some of the unseen; hence no one must interpret them without knowledge.

414. ‘Abdullāh ibn al-Mubarak said: “If you are trialled by becoming a judge, then resort to that which has been narrated [from the Prophet (peace be upon him) and the four rightly guided caliphs.]”

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

Abdullāh ibn al-Mubarak considered taking the position of a judge a trial due to its great impact upon people.

415. Ibn Sirīn said: “These hadīths are the religion. Therefore, pay heed to whom you take your religion from.”

Ibn Hajar al-Haytamī said,

The reason why the author placed this hadīth and the one before it at the end of the book is to encourage people to learn the

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knowledge of the Sunnah and to refer to it, especially during the times of trials and tests. Hence, one should find pious knowledgeable people to take this knowledge from.

Ibn Abdul Barr said,

Al-Mughīrah said, “We used to examine the conduct and prayers (piety) of the person before we would take knowledge from him.”

Shams al-Din al-Safirī said,

Al-Nawawī said, “We only learned the knowledge from those whose piety was manifested, knowledge was verified, competency was unquestionable and who were known for this.

Ibn Muflih said,

Imam Mālik said, “Knowledge must not be taken from four types of people and can be taken from anyone besides them. It is not taken from a person whose foolishness is shown in public, a person who has lied before, a person who follows his desires and calls people to follow that which suits his desires, and an old man who is known for worship and virtue but he does not understand that which he teaches.

Al-Suyūṭī said,

Some of the scholars said, “It is recommended to start listening to (i.e. learning) the knowledge of hadīth after the age of thirty. This was the view of the people of Shām. And it was said after the age of twenty, which was the view of the people of Kufa. Sufyān al-Thawrī said, “If a man wanted to learn hadith, he would worship for twenty years beforehand.” Abū Abdullāh al-Zubayrī, who was a Shafī'ī scholar, said, “It is recommended to learn hadīth in one's twenties, because it is when his mind reaches maturity. Before that, I prefer a person to occupy himself in memorising Qur'ān and studying *fiqh*.”

[1] As stated by al-Dhahabi in his Siyar A'lam al-Nubala

[2] Al-Tadhib

[3] Qur'ān 33:21

[4] Tafsīr Ibn Kathīr (6/391)

[5] Qur'ān 68:4

[6] Sahīh Muslim (746)

[7] Al-Jami' Li Akhlāq al-Rawī wal Sami' (1/9)

[8] Taken from al-Jawab al-Sahīh (5/438)

[9] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5900) and Sahīh Muslim (2347)

[10] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1754)

[11] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3551) and Sahīh Muslim (2337)

[12] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3549) and Sahīh Muslim (2337)

[13] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3637)

[14] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3638)

[15] Tahdhīb al-Kamal (1/214)

[16] Sahīh Muslim (2339)

[17] Note: The translation of the part concerning the eyes in this hadīth is based on the explanation of al-Qadī 'Iyyād and the scholars who interpreted the words of this hadīth.

[18] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2811)

[19] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3549) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3636)

[20] Al-Jami' al-Saghīr (6471)

[21] Sahīh Muslim (167)

[22] Sahīh Muslim (2339)

[23] Mu'jam al-Tabaranī al-Kabīr (12181)

[24] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (190) and Sahīh Muslim (2345)

[25] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3643)

[26] Musnad Ahmad (26793)

[27] It refers to hadīth six in this book wherein 'Alī ibn Abī Tālib described the Prophet (peace be upon him) in detail. This hadīth is included here because of the addition related to the seal of prophethood.

[28] See footnote 7

[29] Musnad Ahmad (20732)

[30] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2658) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (230)

[31] Musnad Ahmad (22997)

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[32] Al-Jamī' al-Saghīr (6484)

[33] Sahīh Muslim (2346)

[34] Qur'ān: 4:64

[35] Sahīh Muslim (2338)

[36] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1755)

[37] See footnote of hadīth 4

[38] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5908) and Sahīh Muslim (2338)

[39] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1781)

[40] See footnote of hadīth 27

[41] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3588) and Sahīh Muslim (2336)

[42] See footnote of hadīth 28

[43] This statement is not from the words of the Prophet (peace be upon him) but the meaning is indicated and supported in other hadīths.

[44] Sunan Abu Dawūd (4163)

[45] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (295) and Sahīh Muslim (297)

[46] Hidayatu al-Ruwāt Ila ahadīth al-masabīh wal Mishkat (4/237)

[47] Sahīh Muslim (268)

[48] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1756)

[49] Al-Mughnī 'Ān Hamil al-Asfār Fi Takhrīj Ma Fi al-Ahyā min Akhbar (1/187)

[50] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3550) and Sahīh Muslim (2341)

[51] Musnad Ahmad (12690)

[52] Sahīh Muslim (2344)

[53] Musnad Ahmad (8/27)

[54] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3297)

[55] Musnad al-Bazzar

[56] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3502)

[57] Musnad Ahmad (12/68)

[58] See hadith 39

[59] Musnad Ahmad (11/160)

[60] Additions of 'Abdullāh ibn Ahmad ibn Hanbal to Musnad Ahmad (7113)

[61] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5896)

[62] Mukhtasar al-Shama'il of al-Albani (39)

[63] Translator Note: This hadīth could not be located from other sources with the exact same text but the meaning is correct and supported by many other authentic hadīths.

[64] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1757) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (3499)

[65] Musnad Ahmad (8612)

[66] Musnad Ibn Abbad (1/471)

[67] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3496)

[68] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3878) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (3497)

[69] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3495)

- [70] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (51/77)
- [71] Ibid.
- [72] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1762)
- [73] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1765) and Sunan Abu Dawūd (4026)
- [74] Sunan Abu Dawūd (4082) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (3578)
- [75] Musnad Ahmad (13763)
- [76] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1767) and Sunan Abu Dawūd (4020)
- [77] Sahīh Muslim (2577)
- [78] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5813) and Sahīh Muslim (2079)
- [79] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (197), Sahīh al-Bukhārī (376) and Sahīh Muslim (503)
- [80] See hadīth 4
- [81] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2812) and Sunan Abu Dawūd (4065)
- [82] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2814)
- [83] See hadīth 52
- [84] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2810)
- [85] Sahīh Muslim (2082) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2813)
- [86] Sahīh Muslim (274)
- [87] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (7324)
- [88] Sahīh Ibn Hibbān (6359)
- [89] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2820) and Sunan Abū Dawūd (155)
- [90] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1769)
- [91] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5857)
- [92] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3614)
- [93] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5858)
- [94] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5851) and Sahīh Muslim (1187)
- [95] Al-'Ilal al-Kabīr of al-Bukhārī (291)
- [96] Al-Sunan al-Kubra of al-Nasā'ī (9719)
- [97] Musnad Imam Ahmed, 24749.
- [98] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5855) and Sahīh Muslim (2097)
- [99] Sahīh Muslim (2099)
- [100] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5856) and Sahīh Muslim (2097)
- [101] See hadīth 34
- [102] Majma' al-Zawa'id wa Manba' al-Fawa'id (5/141)
- [103] Sahīh Muslim (2094)
- [104] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1785)
- [105] Sahīh Ibn Hibbān (5459)
- [106] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5870)
- [107] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5875) and Sahīh Muslim (2092)
- [108] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3106)
- [109] See hadīth 90
- [110] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1746)
- [111] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5873) and Sahīh Muslim (2091)

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[112] Sunan Abū Dawūd (4226)

[113] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1744)

[114] Musnad Ahmad (3/195)

[115] Al-'Ilal al-Kabīr of al-Bukhārī (287) who said this report [from Jābir through this chain] is not authentic.

[116] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1742) and Sunan Abū Dawūd (4229)

[117] Sahīh Muslim (2091)

[118] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1743)

[119] Sunan al-Nasā'ī (5204)

[120] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5865) and Sahīh Muslim (2091)

[121] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1691) and Sunan Abū Dawūd (2583)

[122] Sunan Abū Dawūd (2584)

[123] Sunan Abū Dawūd (1690)

[124] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1683)

[125] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1692)

[126] [Translator's Note] This was due to a rumour spreading during the battle that he had been martyred, causing confusion amongst the Muslim army.

[127] Sunan Ibn Majah (2806)

[128] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3044) and Sahīh Muslim (1357)

[129] Sahīh Muslim (1356)

[130] Al-Hafīth Ibn Hajar said in Fathul Barī commenting on this hadith (no. 1737) "Al-Mawardi said, 'From the exclusive qualities of Makkah is that it is not allowed to fight its inhabitants. If they transgress and rebel against the Muslims, if their evil can be stopped without fighting then it is not allowed to fight them, and if fighting is the only solution then the majority said it is allowed because fighting the rebellious is from the rights of Allāh and cannot be overlooked whilst others said that they should be pressured until they become obedient again.'"

[131] Muwatta Mālik (1271) – See hadīth 112

[132] Sahīh Muslim (1358)

[133] Sahīh Muslim (1359)

[134] Ibid.

[135] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1736)

[136] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (927)

[137] Qur'ān: 16:81

[138] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3108) and Sahīh Muslim (2080)

[139] Musnad Ahmad (23086)

[140] Musannaf ibn Abī Shaybah (24240)

[141] Sunan Ibn Majah (3572)

[142] Qur'ān: 31:19

[143] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3648)

[144] See hadīth 7

- [145] See hadīth 5 and 6
- [146] See hadīth 33
- [147] Sunan Abū Dawūd (4847)
- [148] Al-Mughni 'Ān Hamil al-Asfār Fi Takhrīj Ma Fi al-Ahyā min Akhbar (2/454)
- [149] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6287) and Sahīh Muslim (2100)
- [150] Al-Sunan Al-Kubra of al-Bayhaqī (3/236)
- [151] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2770) and Sunan Abū Dawūd (4143)
- [152] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (2654) and Sahīh Muslim (87)
- [153] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5389)
- [154] Qur'ān: 12:108
- [155] See hadīth 132
- [156] See hadīth 130

- [157] See hadīth 59
- [158] Mukhtasar al-Shama'il of Al-Albani (107)

- [159] Sahīh Muslim (2032)
- [160] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1801)
- [161] Sahīh Muslim (2034)
- [162] See hadīth 130
- [163] Musannaf Ibn Abi Shaybah (23869)
- [164] Sahīh Muslim (2044)
- [165] Musnad Ahmad (13101)
- [166] See hadith 149
- [167] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2359)
- [168] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2359)
- [169] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5413)
- [170] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5415)
- [171] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2356)
- [172] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5416) and Sahīh Muslim (2970)
- [173] Musnad Ahmad (12/143)
- [174] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6450)
- [175] Sahīh Muslim (2051)
- [176] Sahīh Muslim (2977)
- [177] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1839)
- [178] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5517) and Sahīh Muslim (1649)
- [179] Al-Arba'ūn al-Nawawiyyah (41)
- [180] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3797)
- [181] Previously explained in hadith 154.
- [182] See hadīth 154.
- [183] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1852)
- [184] See hadīth 157.

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- [185] Musannad Abdul Razzaq (19568)
- [186] Musnad Ahmad (12811)
- [187] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3304)
- [188] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5379) and Sahīh Muslim (2041)
- [189] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5431) and Sahīh Muslim (1473)
- [190] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1829)
- [191] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3311)
- [192] Sunan Abu Dawud (188)
- [193] The Prophet said: When the supper is brought and the prayer begins, one should first take food" [Sahīh Muslim]
- [194] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (4712) and Sahīh Muslim (194)
- [195] Sunan Abu Dawud (3780)
- [196] Al-Bidaya wal Nihayah (6/127)
- [197] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1838)
- [198] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3308)
- [199] Previously explained in hadith 151.
- [200] Sunan Abu Dawūd (3820)
- [201] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1841)
- [202] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5418) and Sahīh Muslim (2431)
- [203] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5428) and Sahīh Muslim (2446)
- [204] Musnad Ahmad (9050)
- [205] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3744) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (1909)
- [206] Al-Targhīb wal Tarhīb (4/173)
- [207] Al-Ajwibah al-Murdiyyah (1/177)
- [208] Musnad Ahmad (14245)
- [209] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (80)
- [210] Sunan Al-Tirmidhī (2037)
- [211] Sahīh Muslim (1154)
- [212] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3260)
- [213] Musnad Ahmad (13300)
- [214] Sunan Abu Dawūd (3760) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1847)
- [215] Qur'ān: 5:6
- [216] Sahīh al-Nasai' (133)
- [217] Sahīh Muslim (374)
- [218] Sunan Abu Dawūd (3761) and Sunan al-Tirmidhi (1846)
- [219] Musnad Ahmad (23522)
- [220] See Sahīh al-Jami' (1323)
- [221] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3265) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1857)
- [222] Sunan Abu Dawūd (3850) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3457)
- [223] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5458)
- [224] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1858)
- [225] Sahīh Muslim (2734)

- [226] Sharh al-Sunnah of al-Baghawī (2935)
- [227] Sahīh Muslim (2008)
- [228] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5440) and Sahīh Muslim (2043)
- [229] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3836) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1843)
- [230] Musnad Ahmad (12460)
- [231] See hadīth 195
- [232] Sahīh Muslim (2038)
- [233] Sharh al-Sunnah of al-Baghawī (2897)
- [234] Musnad Ahmad (27020)
- [235] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1895)
- [236] Qur'ān: 35:12
- [237] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3730) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2455)
- [238] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5617) and Sahīh Muslim (2027)
- [239] Sunan Abu Dawūd (653) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1883)
- [240] See hadith 206
- [241] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5615)
- [242] Sahīh Muslim (2028)
- [243] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3417) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1886)
- [244] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3423) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1892)
- [245] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5631) and Sahīh Muslim (2028)
- [246] Musnad Ahmad (12188)
- [247] Sunan Abū Dawūd (4162)
- [248] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5929)
- [249] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2790)
- [250] Sunan Abū Dawūd (2174) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2787)
- [251] Reported by al-Tirmidhī
- [252] See hadīth 219
- [253] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2791)
- [254] Musnad al-Farūq of Ibn Kathīr (2/682)
- [255] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3639)
- [256] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6244)
- [257] See hadīth 8
- [258] Qur'ān: 20:131
- [259] Qur'ān: 7:199
- [260] Sunan al-Tirmidhi (3645)
- [261] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3641)
- [262] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3642)
- [263] Sahīh Muslim (190)
- [264] Qur'ān: 25:70
- [265] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3035) and Sahīh Muslim (2475)
- [266] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3821)
- [267] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6571) and Sahīh Muslim (186)

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- [268] Sahīh Muslim (2747)
- [269] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3446)
- [270] Musnad Ahmad (1620)
- [271] Sunan Abū Dawūd (5002) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1992)
- [272] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6129) and Sahīh Muslim (2150)
- [273] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1990)
- [274] Sunan Abū Dawūd (4998) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1991)
- [275] Musnad Ahmad (12669)
- [276] Sahīh Muslim (4657)
- [277] Qur'ān: 35-37
- [278] Ma'alim al-Tanzīl (1203)
- [279] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2848)
- [280] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6147) and Sahīh Muslim (3841)
- [281] Qur'ān: 28:88
- [282] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (2802) and Sahīh Muslim (1796)
- [283] See hadīth 243
- [284] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (2824) and Sahīh Muslim (1776)
- [285] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2847)
- [286] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2850)
- [287] See hadīth 242
- [288] Sahīh Muslim (2255)
- [289] Qur'ān: 7:175
- [290] Sunan Abū Dawūd (5015) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2846)
- [291] Musnad Ahmad (25244)
- [292] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5189) and Sahīh Muslim (2448)
- [293] Qur'ān: 30:23
- [294] Qur'ān: 28:73
- [295] Musnad Ahmad (18672)
- [296] Musnad Ahmad (3664)
- [297] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6312)
- [298] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5017)
- [299] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (138)
- [300] Musnad Ahmad (24171)
- [301] Sahīh Muslim (2715)
- [302] Sahīh Muslim (2715)
- [303] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1130) and Sahīh Muslim (2819)
- [304] See hadīth 261
- [305] See hadīth 261
- [306] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1146) and Sahīh Muslim (739)
- [307] See hadīth 258
- [308] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1138) and Sahīh Muslim (764)
- [309] Sahīh Muslim (746)

- [310] Sahīh Muslim (768)
- [311] Sahīh Muslim (765)
- [312] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1147) and Sahīh Muslim (738)
- [313] "The closest a servant comes to his Lord is in *Sujūd*; therefore make excessive du'a, for it is most likely to be answered." Collected in Sahīh Muslim.
- [314] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (994) and Sahīh Muslim (736)
- [315] Sunan Ibn Mājah (1360) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (443)
- [316] Sunan Abū Dawūd (874)
- [317] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (448)
- [318] Qur'ān: 5:118
- [319] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1135) and Sahīh Muslim (773)
- [320] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1119) and Sahīh Muslim (731)
- [321] Sahīh Muslim (730)
- [322] Sahīh Muslim (735)
- [323] Sahīh Muslim (733)
- [324] Musannaf Abdul Razzaq (3959)
- [325] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (937) and Sahīh Muslim (729)
- [326] Part of hadīth 283
- [327] See hadīth 283
- [328] See hadīth 280
- [329] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (599)
- [330] Sahīh Muslim (719)
- [331] Al-Mu'jam al-Awsat (1276)
- [332] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1103) and Sahīh Muslim (336)
- [333] Qur'ān: 38:18
- [334] Al-Mu'jam al-Awsat (4/296)
- [335] Sahīh Muslim (336)
- [336] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (477)
- [337] Musnad Ahmad (23532)
- [338] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (478)
- [339] Al-Targhīb fi Fada'il al-A'māl (82)
- [340] Sunan Abū Dawūd (311) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (651)
- [341] Sahīh Muslim (1156)
- [342] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1141)
- [343] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1780) and Sahīh Muslim (1949)
- [344] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1971) and Sahīh Muslim (1157)
- [345] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1969) and Sahīh Muslim (1156)
- [346] Sunan Abū Dawūd (2450) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (1725)
- [347] Sunan Ibn Mājah (1649) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (745)
- [348] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (747)
- [349] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (746)
- [350] See hadīth 302

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[351] Sahih Muslim (1160)

[352] Sahih al-Bukhari (1592) and Sahih Muslim (1125)

[353] Ibn Abbās narrated that the Prophet (peace be upon him) came to Madīnah and saw the Jews fasting on the day of 'Ashūra. He said, "What is this?" They said, "This is a good day, this is the day when Allāh saved the Children of Israel from their enemy and Mūsa fasted on this day." He (peace be upon him) said, "We are closer to Mūsa than you." So he fasted on this day and told the people to fast. (Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1865))

[354] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1987) and Sahih Muslim (783)

[355] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1090)

[356] Kuraib, the freed slave of Ibn Abbās stated: "Ibn Abbās, Abdur-Rahman ibn Azhar and Al-Miswar bin Makhrama sent me to Aisha saying, "Pay her our greetings and ask her about our offering of the two rakat after *Asr* Prayer, and tell her that we have been informed that you offer these two rak'at while we have heard that the Prophet (peace be upon him) had forbidden their offering." Ibn Abbas said, "I and 'Umar used to beat the people for their offering of them." I entered upon her and delivered their message to her. She said, "Ask Umm Salamah." So, I informed them [of Aisha's answer] and they sent me to Umm Salamah for the same purpose as they sent me to Aisha. Umm Salamah replied, "I heard the Prophet (peace be upon him) forbidding the offering of these two rak'at. Once the Prophet (peace be upon him) offered the *Asr* prayer, and then came to me. And at that time an Ansāri women from the tribe of Banū Haram was with me. Then [the Prophet (peace be upon him)] offered those two rak'at, and I sent my [lady] servant to him, saying, "Stand beside him and say [to him]: "Umm Salamah says, "O Allāh's Apostle! Didn't I hear you forbidding the offering of these two rak'at [after the *Asr* prayer] yet I see you offering them?" And if he beckons to you with his hand, then wait behind." So the lady slave did that and the Prophet (peace be upon him) beckoned to her with his hand, and she stayed behind. When the Prophet (peace be upon him) finished his prayer, he said, "O the daughter of Abu Umaiyah (i.e. Umm Salamah), you were asking me about these two rak'at after the *Asr* prayer. In fact, some people from the tribe of Abdul Qais came to me to embrace Islām and busied me so much that I did not offer the two rak'at that are offered after the *Dhuhr* compulsory prayer, and these two rak'at [you have seen me offering] make up for those." (Sahīh al-Bukhari)

Abū Salamah narrated that he asked Aisha about the two prostrations (rak'ahs) that the Messenger of Allah (peace be upon him) used to pray after *Asr*. She said, "He used to pray them before *Asr*, but if he got distracted or forgot them, he would pray them after *Asr*, and if he performed a prayer he would be consistent in it." (Sahih Muslim)

[357] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (43) and Sahih Muslim (785)

[358] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2856)

[359] Sunan Abū Dawūd (873)

[360] Sunan Abū Dawūd (1466) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2923)

[361] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (5045)

[362] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2927)

[363] Sunan Abū Dawūd (226)

[364] Sunan Ibn Mājah (1349)

[365] Qur'ān: 48:1-2

[366] Translator Note: The scholars differed on the actual meaning of “*tarjī*”, some said it refers to the coming and going of sound in the larynx, or technically speaking, rolling of the sound in it, and some said it means beautifying the voice, and some said it happens unwillingly due to joy, and some said it happened when he was riding his camel so it happened unwillingly due to the movement of the camel, and some said it means repeating the words in a lower tone.

[367] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (4281) and Sahīh Muslim (794)

[368] Tabaqat Ibn Sa'd (879)

[369] Sunan Abu Dawūd (1327)

[370] Sunan Abū Dawūd (904)

[371] Qur'ān: 4:41

[372] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (4582) and Sahīh Muslim (800)

[373] Qur'ān: 5:83

[374] Qur'ān: 29:23

[375] Musnad Ahmad (6483)

[376] Musnad Ahmad (2412)

[377] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3163) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (1456)

[378] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (1285)

[379] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6456) and Sahīh Muslim (2082)

[380] Al-Mu'jam al-Awsat (6195)

[381] Akhlāq al-Nabi (454)

[382] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (2462) and Sahīh Muslim (1691)

[383] Sunan Abū Dawūd (4818)

[384] Sunan Ibn Mājah (2296) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1017)

[385] Musnad Ahmad (11993)

[386] Sunan Ibn Mājah (2890)

[387] Sunan al-Tirmidhi (2754)

[388] See hadīth 8

[389] Qur'ān 23:3

[390] Qur'ān 33:40

[391] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1338)

[392] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (194) and Sahīh Muslim (1616)

[393] Musnad Ahmad (16404)

[394] See hadīth 334

[395] Sahīh Muslim (2041)

[396] Al-Adab al-Mufrad (541)

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[397] Qur'ān 25:7

[398] Al-Sunan al-Kubrah (12345)

[399] Tahdhīb al-Kamāl (939)

[400] Qur'ān 3:159

[401] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6041) and Sahīh Muslim (2330)

[402] Sunan Abū Dawūd (4182)

[403] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2016)

[404] Sahīh Muslim (2328)

[405] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3560) and Sahīh Muslim (2327)

[406] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6032) and Sahīh Muslim (2591)

[407] See hadīth 8

[408] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6034) and Sahīh Muslim (2311)

[409] Qur'ān 64:15

[410] Sahīh al-Bukhari (1902) and Sahīh Muslim (2308)

[411] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2362)

[412] Al-Ahadīth al-Mukhtarah (78)

[413] See hadīth 203

[414] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (2585)

[415] Qur'ān 11:51

[416] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3562) and Sahīh Muslim (2320)

[417] Sunan Ibn Mājah (662)

[418] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3436)

[419] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (2102) and Sahīh Muslim (1577)

[420] Sunan Ibn Mājah (2163)

[421] See Sahīh al-Bukhārī (2103) and Sahīh Muslim (1202)

[422] See al-Mu'jam al-Kabīr (12427)

[423] Sunan Abū Dawūd (3860) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (3483)

[424] Sunan Abū Dawūd (1837)

[425] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3532) and Sahīh Muslim (2354)

[426] Musnad Ahmad (23445)

[427] See hadīth 152

[428] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (6458) and Sahīh Muslim (2971)

[429] Qur'ān 102:8

[430] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3356)

[431] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2371)

[432] Sunan Abū Dawūd (5128) and Sunan Ibn Mājah (2745)

[433] Sahīh al-Bukhārī (3728) and Sahīh Muslim (2966)

[434] Al-Mu'jam al-Awsat (4/243)

[435] Sahīh Muslim (2967)

[436] Sunan Ibn Mājah (151) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2372)

- [437] Sahih al-Bukhārī (3010) and Sahih Muslim (3358)
- [438] Musnad Ahmad (13859)
- [439] Musnad 'Abd ibn Hamīd (161)
- [440] Sahih al-Bukhārī (3903) and Sahih Muslim (2351)
- [441] Sahih Muslim (2352)
- [442] Sahih al-Bukhārī (3536) and Sahih Muslim (2349)
- [443] Sahih Muslim (2353)
- [444] See hadīth 381
- [445] See hadīth 1
- [446] Sahih al-Bukhārī (680) and Sahih Muslim (419)
- [447] Sunan ibn Mājah [585]
- [448] Sahih al-Bukhārī (741) and Sahih Muslim (1636)
- [449] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (978)
- [450] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (979)
- [451] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1018)
- [452] Sahih al-Bukhārī (4451)
- [453] Sunan Abū Dawūd (2137)
- [454] Sunan Ibn Mājah (1631) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (3618)
- [455] Sunan al-Tirmidhi (996)
- [456] Musannaf 'Abdul Razzaq (6209)
- [457] Sunan al-Bayhaqi (6216)
- [458] Muwatta Mālik (539)
- [459] Qur'ān 39:30
- [460] Sunan Ibn Mājah (1234)
- [461] Qur'ān 39:30
- [462] Qur'ān 3:144
- [463] Sunan Ibn Mājah (1629)
- [464] Sunan al-Tirmidhi (1062)
- [465] Sahih al-Bukhārī (2739)
- [466] Sunan al-Tirmidhī (1608)
- [467] Sunan Abū Dawūd (2963)
- [468] Qur'ān 27:16
- [469] Qur'ān 19:6
- [470] Qur'ān 59:6
- [471] Sahih al-Bukhārī (4035) and Sahih Muslim (1758)
- [472] Sahih al-Bukhārī (2776) and Sahih Muslim (1760)
- [473] Qur'ān 33:53
- [474] See hadīth 401
- [475] Al-Mu'jam al-Kabīr (402)
- [476] Sunan Ibn Mājah (3900) and Sunan al-Tirmidhī (2276)
- [477] Sahih al-Bukhārī (110) and Sahih Muslim (6056)

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[478] Musnad Ahmad (15880)

[479] Musnad Ahmad (7168)

[480] Musnad Ahmad (2410)

[481] Sahih al-Bukhārī (6996) and Sahih Muslim (2267)

[482] Sahih al-Bukhārī (6994)